CENTERLINE

PILATES

VOLUME 1

Beginner Exercises

170 illustrated exercises

THE PILATES INSTRUCTOR'S LIBRARY

How to use this volume

> *Every exercise has its own sheet: position diagram, steps, focus, target muscles, dosage, breathing, common faults, progression and regression, the exact cue to say, and an adaptation.*

1. Find the exercise in the index at the end of this section (numbers like V1-001).
2. Read the steps and the cue. Say the cue out loud once before you teach it.
3. Check the adaptation box before you teach a client with a condition (pregnancy, older adults, back, knee or shoulder).
4. Use the progression and regression to match the level of the room.

Important

This library is an educational resource for trained Pilates instructors. It is not medical advice. The diagrams are simplified to show positions: follow the written steps and your training. Ask clients to consult their healthcare provider when you are unsure.

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VOLUME 1 · BEGINNER

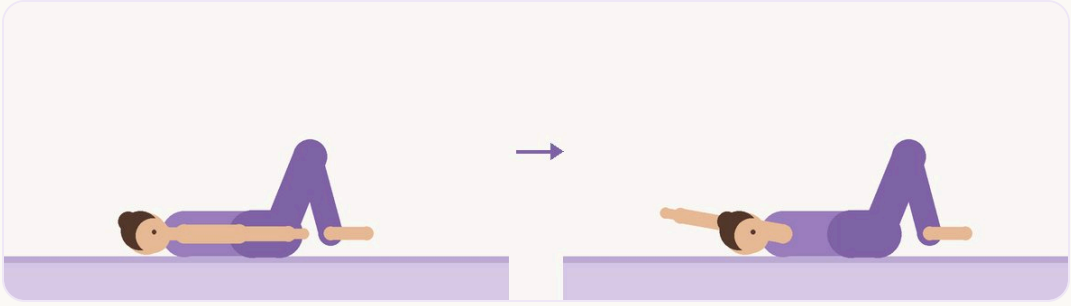
Mat

40 exercises

Diaphragmatic Breathing

belly and ribs expand

Beginner | Mat | V1-001



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back, knees bent, feet hip-width, hands on the lower ribs.
2. Inhale and feel the ribs widen into your hands.
3. Exhale slowly and feel the ribs soften and draw together.
4. Keep the neck and jaw relaxed throughout.

Focus
Teaches full, three-dimensional breath and a calm start to class. Sets the rhythm every other exercise builds on.

Target muscles
Diaphragm, intercostals, transversus abdominis

Dosage
8-10 breaths · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale through the nose into the ribs; exhale through pursed lips as the abdomen gently draws in.

Common faults
Lifting the shoulders, belly-only breathing, forcing the exhale, gripping the neck.

Progression / Regression
Easier: place both hands on the belly. Harder: add a gentle pelvic floor lift on each exhale.

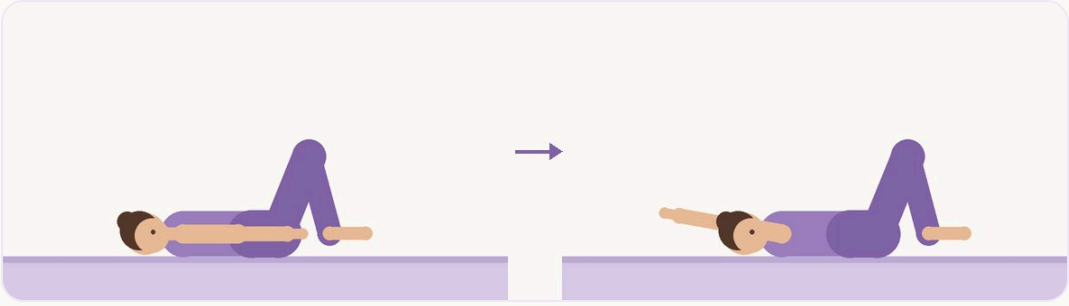
Cue
“Breathe into your back ribs, then let the air leave slowly.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: prop the upper body on a wedge after the first trimester. Stop if dizzy.

Lateral Thoracic Breathing

hands on the ribs

Beginner | Mat | V1-002



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit or lie with knees bent, hands wrapped around the lower ribs.
2. Inhale and widen the ribs sideways into your fingers.
3. Exhale and close the ribs while the lower abdomen draws in.
4. Keep the pelvis still and the shoulders quiet.

Focus
Builds rib mobility and awareness of lateral expansion while keeping the abdominals engaged during movement.

Target muscles
Intercostals, diaphragm, transversus abdominis, serratus anterior

Dosage
8 breaths · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to widen the ribs sideways; exhale to close the ribs and lift the deep abdominals.

Common faults
Letting the ribs flare, tucking the pelvis, raising the chin, holding the breath.

Progression / Regression
Easier: practice seated in a chair. Harder: add arm reaches overhead on the inhale.

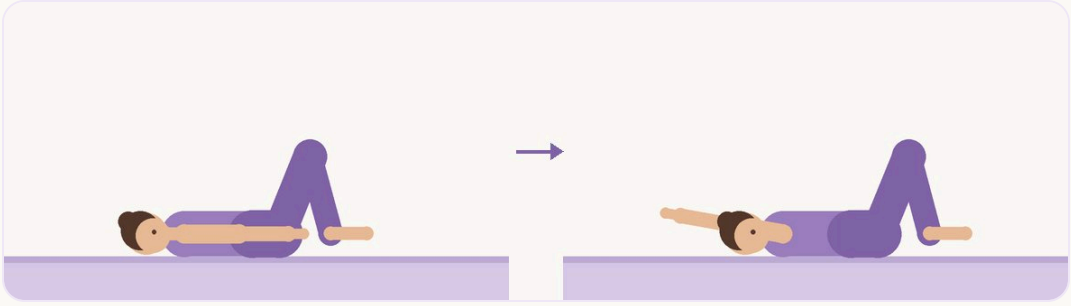
Cue
“Breathe into your hands, then zip the ribs closed.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: use a seated position. Older adults: practice in a chair with back support.

Imprint and Release

finding neutral spine

Beginner | Mat | V1-003



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back, knees bent, feet flat and hip-width.
2. Exhale and gently flatten the lower back toward the mat.
3. Inhale and release to a natural curve in the lumbar spine.
4. Repeat with slow, smooth control.

Focus
Introduces pelvic position and lumbar awareness. It is the foundation for abdominal control in every supine exercise.

Target muscles
Transversus abdominis, rectus abdominis, lumbar multifidus

Dosage
8-10 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale to imprint the lower back; inhale to release back to neutral.

Common faults
Pushing with the feet, squeezing the glutes, over-tucking the pelvis, tensing the neck.

Progression / Regression
Easier: reduce the range to a small tilt. Harder: hold the imprint for 3 breaths.

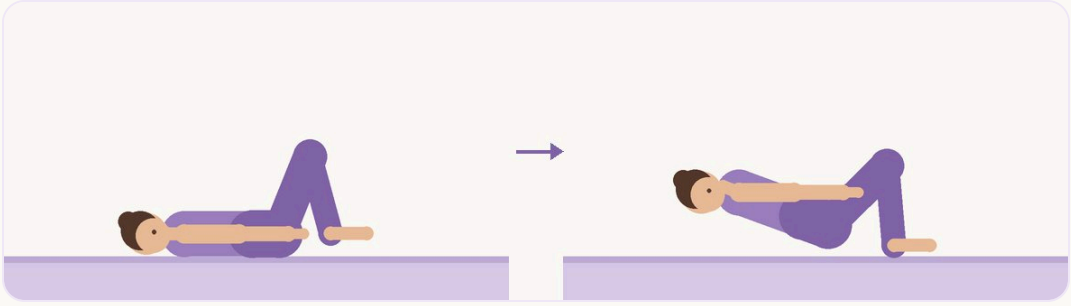
Cue
“Melt your lower back toward the mat as you exhale.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: skip supine work after the first trimester; practice seated pelvic tilts instead.

Pelvic Curl

rolling up the spine

Beginner | Mat | V1-004



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back, knees bent, feet hip-width, arms long.
2. Exhale and tilt the pelvis, then peel the spine up bone by bone.
3. Stop at the base of the shoulder blades with the knees over the toes.
4. Inhale to hold; exhale to roll down from the upper back to the tailbone.

Focus
Teaches articulation of the spine and glute-hamstring support. A key warm-up for spinal mobility.

Target muscles
Hamstrings, gluteus maximus, rectus abdominis, spinal extensors

Dosage
6-8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare; exhale to curl up; inhale at the top; exhale to roll down.

Common faults
Lifting too high, flaring the ribs, knees splaying, rolling as one piece.

Progression / Regression
Easier: lift only to the base of the ribs. Harder: add a 3-breath hold at the top.

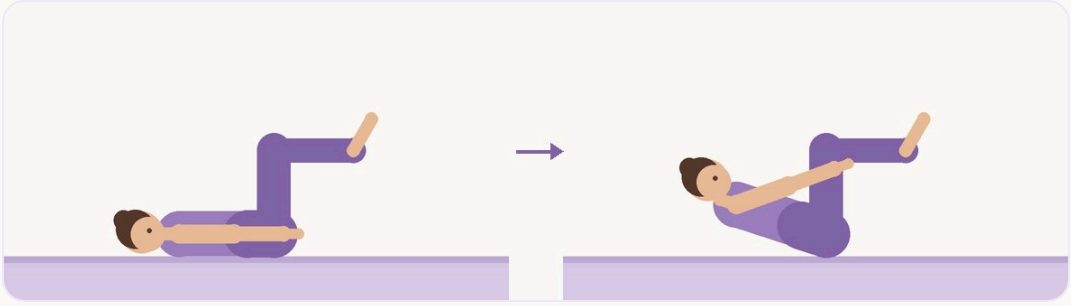
Cue
“Peel your spine off the mat one bone at a time.”

Adaptation
Lumbar injury: keep the lift small. Pregnancy: only in the first trimester or with a wedge.

Knee Folds

table-top lowering

Beginner | Mat | V1-005



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back in neutral spine, knees bent, feet flat.
2. Exhale and lift one knee to table-top without tilting the pelvis.
3. Inhale and lower the foot to the mat with control.
4. Alternate legs, keeping the abdominals drawn in.

Focus
Develops lumbo-pelvic stability while the legs move. A building block for all single-leg abdominal work.

Target muscles
Transversus abdominis, hip flexors, obliques

Dosage
6-8 reps each leg · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale as the leg lifts; inhale as the leg lowers.

Common faults
Rocking the pelvis, arching the back, gripping the hip flexors, holding the breath.

Progression / Regression
Easier: slide the heel along the mat. Harder: lift both legs to table-top and lower one at a time.

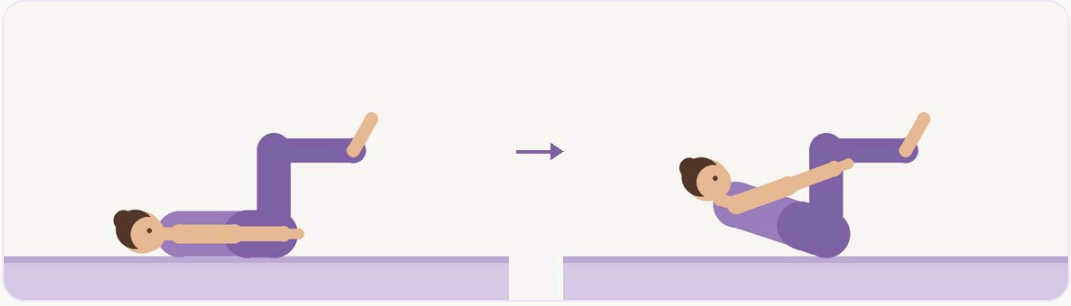
Cue
“Lift your knee without letting your pelvis move.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: use a wedge after the first trimester. Lumbar issues: keep the range small.

Toe Taps

lowering the feet

Beginner | Mat | V1-006



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back with legs in table-top, arms by your sides.
2. Exhale and lower one foot to tap the mat lightly.
3. Inhale to return the leg to table-top.
4. Alternate sides without moving the pelvis.

Focus
Trains control of the pelvis and lower abdominals while the legs lower. A safe step toward double-leg work.

Target muscles
Transversus abdominis, obliques, hip flexors

Dosage
6-8 reps each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare; exhale as the toe taps; inhale back to table-top.

Common faults
Letting the back arch, speeding up, dropping the ribs, tapping too far.

Progression / Regression
Easier: tap only the heel. Harder: tap both legs alternately with arms overhead.

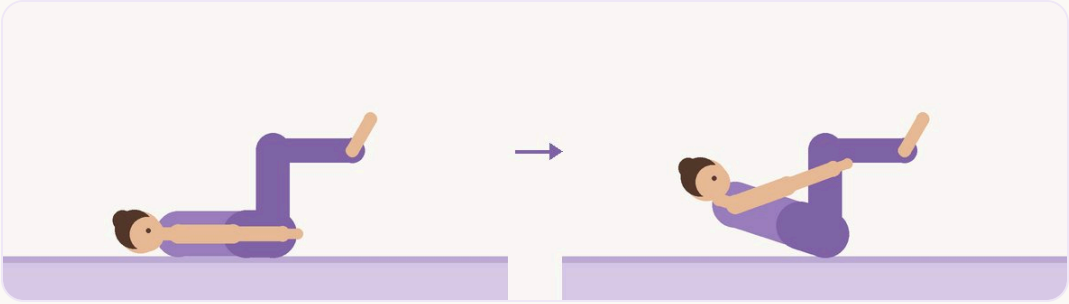
Cue
“Keep your pelvis still while your foot floats down.”

Adaptation
Lumbar issues: limit the lowering range. Pregnancy: avoid supine after the first trimester.

The Hundred Prep

head down, legs in table-top

Beginner | Mat | V1-007



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back, legs in table-top, arms long by your sides.
2. Exhale and lift the arms an inch off the mat.
3. Pump the arms in small beats while breathing in for 5, out for 5.
4. Rest the legs down after the set.

Focus
Builds abdominal endurance and breath coordination for the full Hundred. Strengthens the deep core.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, transversus abdominis, hip flexors, shoulder stabilizers

Dosage
5 sets of 10 pumps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale for 5 arm pumps; exhale for 5 arm pumps.

Common faults
Gripping the neck, arching the back, pumping the shoulders, holding the breath.

Progression / Regression
Easier: keep the head down and feet on the floor. Harder: lift the head and extend the legs higher.

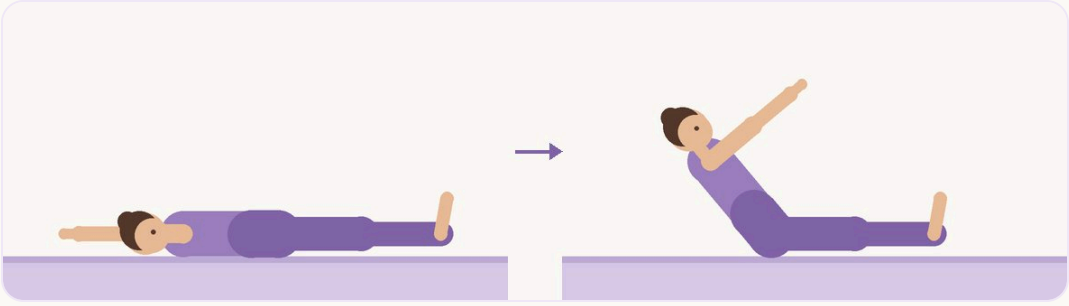
Cue
“Pump your arms and keep your belly scooped.”

Adaptation
Neck strain: keep the head down. Pregnancy: only the first trimester; avoid later.

Roll Up Prep

half roll back

Beginner | Mat | V1-008



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit with knees bent, feet flat, hands behind the thighs.
2. Exhale and curl the tailbone under, rolling halfway back.
3. Inhale to hold with the belly scooped.
4. Exhale and curl forward to sitting.

Focus
Develops sequential abdominal control and spinal articulation. A gentle introduction to the Roll Up.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, hip flexors, transversus abdominis

Dosage
6-8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare; exhale to curl up; inhale to hold; exhale to lower.

Common faults
Using momentum, pulling on the neck, collapsing the chest, lifting the feet.

Progression / Regression
Easier: keep hands behind the thighs. Harder: hold the arms forward and roll lower.

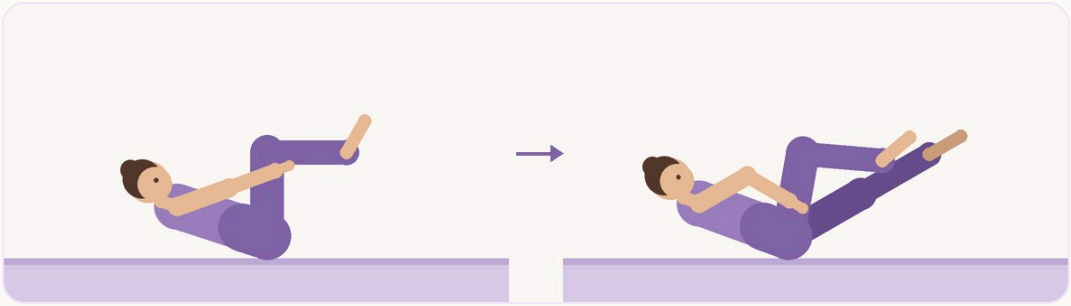
Cue
“Curl forward as if rolling over a ball.”

Adaptation
Neck or lumbar pain: reduce range. Pregnancy: avoid after the first trimester.

Single Leg Stretch

head and shoulders curled

Beginner | Mat | V1-009



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back, head and shoulders curled, one knee at the chest.
2. Hold the shin with the same-side hand, the other hand on the ankle.
3. Extend the other leg to about 45 degrees.
4. Switch legs smoothly with the abdominals drawn in.

Focus
Builds core endurance and coordination while one leg extends. A classic mat abdominal exercise.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, obliques, hip flexors

Dosage
8-10 reps each leg · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale for each leg change; inhale at the pass.

Common faults
Letting the pelvis rock, pulling too hard on the knee, dropping the head, rushing.

Progression / Regression
Easier: keep the head down and the foot on the floor. Harder: extend the leg lower.

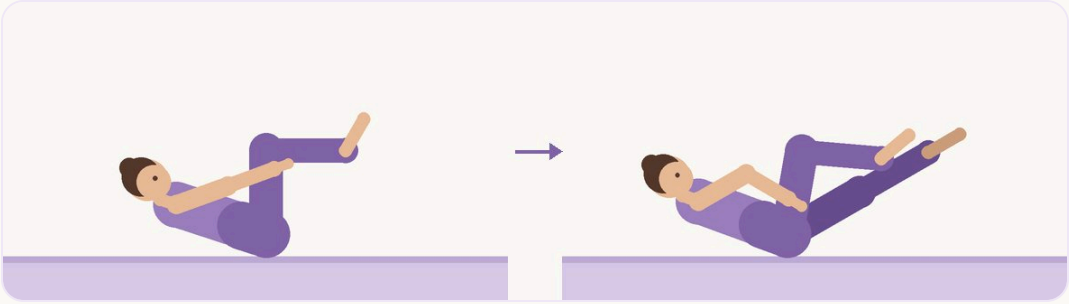
Cue
“Switch legs without letting your belly pop up.”

Adaptation
Neck pain: keep the head down. Pregnancy: only before the second trimester.

Double Leg Stretch Prep

reaching arms with knees folded

Beginner | Mat | V1-010



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back with knees folded and head curled.
2. Hold the shins with your hands.
3. Exhale and reach the arms overhead while extending the legs slightly.
4. Inhale and circle the arms back to the shins.

Focus
Teaches arm and leg coordination with a stable core. Progresses toward the full Double Leg Stretch.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, transversus abdominis, hip flexors, shoulder flexors

Dosage
6-8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale as the arms reach and the legs extend; inhale as they circle in.

Common faults
Dropping the chest, hyperextending the arms, arching the back, jerky movement.

Progression / Regression
Easier: extend the legs less. Harder: extend both legs lower with full arms.

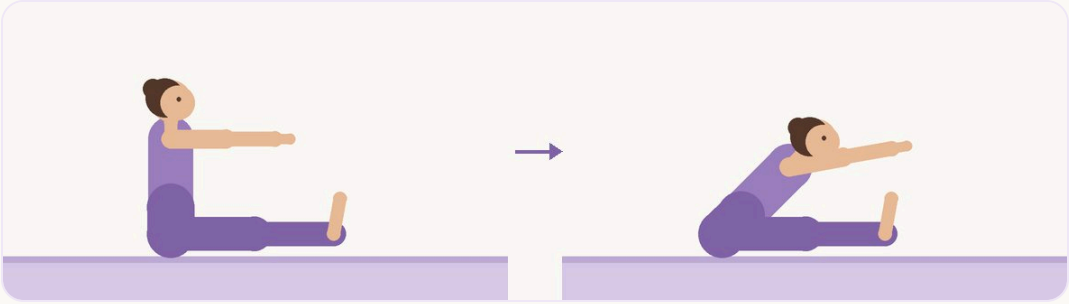
Cue
“Reach long, then draw everything back to center.”

Adaptation
Neck issues: keep the head down. Lumbar issues: keep the legs higher.

Spine Twist

seated rotation

Beginner | Mat | V1-011



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall with legs extended and arms at shoulder height.
2. Inhale and lengthen the spine.
3. Exhale and rotate the ribcage to one side, keeping the hips down.
4. Inhale to center, then repeat on the other side.

Focus
Mobilizes the thoracic spine while keeping the pelvis stable. Teaches rotation from the ribs, not the neck.

Target muscles
Obliques, erector spinae, transversus abdominis

Dosage
6-8 reps each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lengthen; exhale to rotate; inhale to return to center.

Common faults
Collapsing the spine, shifting the hips, rotating only the head, lifting the shoulders.

Progression / Regression
Easier: sit on a folded towel with knees bent. Harder: add a double pulse at the end of the twist.

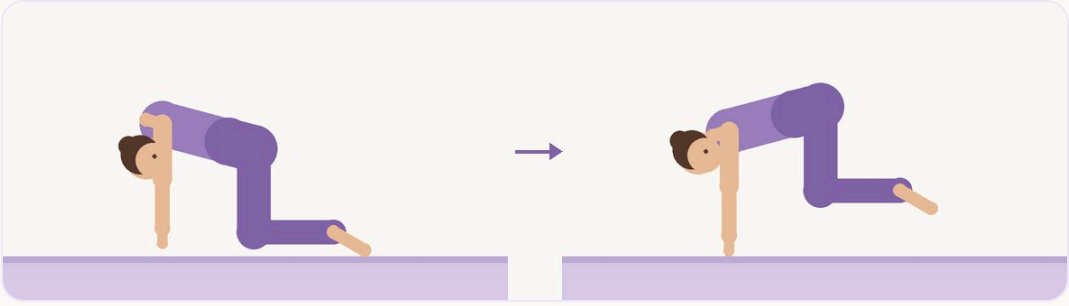
Cue
“Grow tall, then twist around a central pole.”

Adaptation
Lumbar issues: sit on a cushion. Pregnancy: widen the legs and avoid deep twisting.

Cat-Cow

spinal flexion and extension

Beginner | Mat | V1-012



HOW TO DO IT

1. Come to hands and knees, wrists under shoulders, knees under hips.
2. Inhale and lift the tailbone and chest while the belly softens.
3. Exhale and round the spine, tucking the tailbone and chin.
4. Move slowly, one vertebra at a time.

Focus
Warms the spine through its full range and links breath to movement. Safe for nearly everyone.

Target muscles
Spinal flexors and extensors, transversus abdominis, multifidus

Dosage
8-10 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to extend (cow); exhale to round (cat).

Common faults
Collapsing the shoulders, moving only the neck, sinking into the wrists, rushing.

Progression / Regression
Easier: reduce range. Harder: add a hip-width weight shift between rounds.

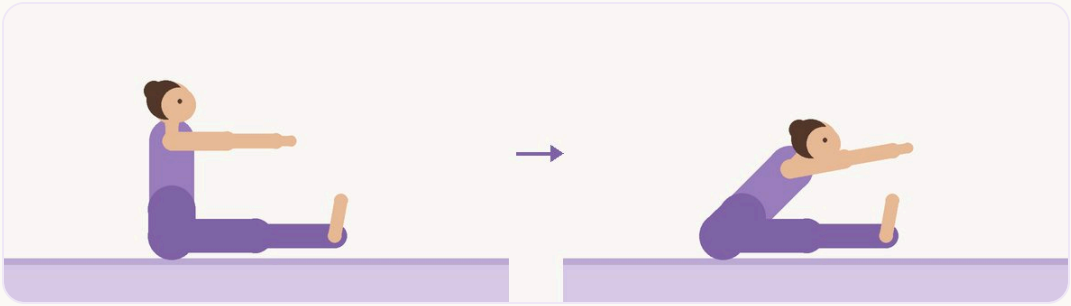
Cue
“Round your back like a cat, then open your chest.”

Adaptation
Wrist pain: use fists. Pregnancy: excellent; keep the range comfortable.

Spine Stretch Forward

seated roll-forward

Beginner | Mat | V1-013



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall with legs hip-width apart, feet flexed, arms forward.
2. Inhale and lengthen up through the crown.
3. Exhale and round the spine forward, scooping the belly.
4. Inhale to hold; exhale to stack up bone by bone.

Focus
Lengthens the spine and hamstrings while training deep abdominal control. A classic warm-up.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, erector spinae, hamstrings

Dosage
6-8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to sit tall; exhale to roll forward; inhale to hold; exhale to stack up.

Common faults
Slumping, pulling with the arms, rolling the pelvis back, straining the neck.

Progression / Regression
Easier: bend the knees slightly. Harder: reach the arms farther and add a pulse.

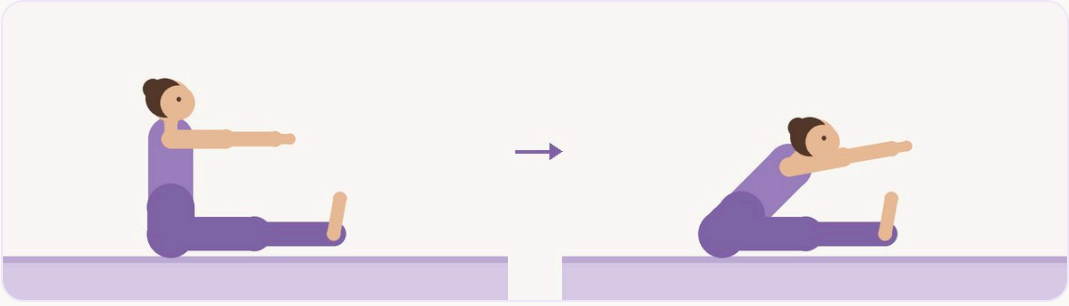
Cue
“Round over a big beach ball.”

Adaptation
Lumbar issues: sit on a cushion and keep knees bent. Pregnancy: widen the legs.

Saw

seated rotation with reach

Beginner | Mat | V1-014



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall with legs wide, feet flexed, arms at shoulder height.
2. Inhale and rotate the torso to one side.
3. Exhale and reach the opposite hand toward the little toe.
4. Inhale to return to center, then repeat on the other side.

Focus
Combines rotation and spinal flexion to stretch the back and hamstrings. Great for tight hips.

Target muscles
Obliques, hamstrings, erector spinae, rhomboids

Dosage
4-6 reps each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to rotate; exhale to reach forward; inhale to return.

Common faults
Collapsing the chest, shifting the hips, forcing the stretch, holding the breath.

Progression / Regression
Easier: bend the knees. Harder: widen the legs and deepen the reach.

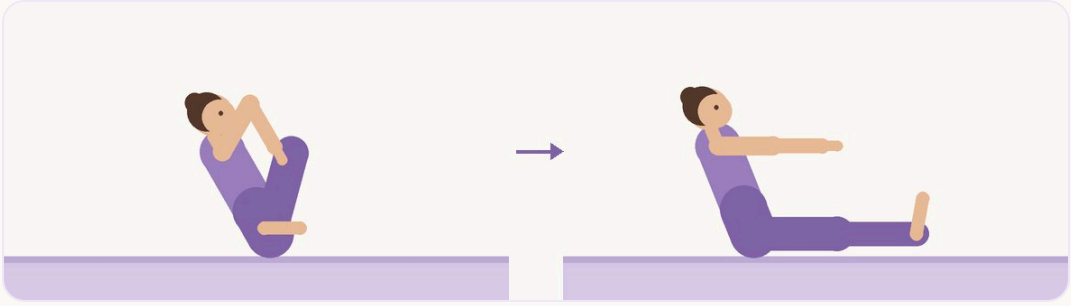
Cue
“Reach for the outside of your little toe.”

Adaptation
Lumbar issues: bend the knees. Pregnancy: keep legs wide and the twist gentle.

Rolling Like a Ball Prep

balance on the sit bones

Beginner | Mat | V1-015



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit with knees bent, hands on the shins, feet on the mat.
2. Round the back and tuck the chin.
3. Inhale and rock back on the tailbone, then exhale to rock up.
4. Keep the abdominals drawn in.

Focus
Develops core control and spinal massage. Teaches balance on the sit bones with a rounded back.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, hip flexors, spinal flexors

Dosage
6-8 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to rock back; exhale to rock forward.

Common faults
Rolling onto the neck, using momentum, flattening the spine, dropping the head.

Progression / Regression
Easier: keep the feet on the mat and rock slightly. Harder: lift the feet and balance.

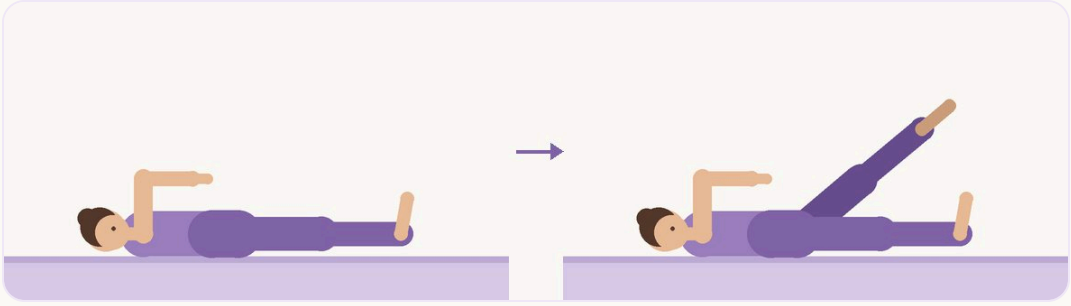
Cue
“Keep your spine round and your belly scooped.”

Adaptation
Neck issues: do not roll past the shoulder blades. Pregnancy: skip.

Side-Lying Leg Lifts

lateral hip series

Beginner | Mat | V1-016



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your side, legs stacked, hips and shoulders aligned, head on the lower arm.
2. Place the top hand on the mat for support.
3. Lift the top leg to hip height, keeping the pelvis still.
4. Lower with control and repeat.

Focus
Strengthens the hip abductors while the torso stays stable. Core of the side-lying series.

Target muscles
Gluteus medius, tensor fasciae latae, obliques

Dosage
10-12 reps each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to lift; inhale to lower.

Common faults
Rolling the hips, lifting too high, losing neutral spine, gripping the neck.

Progression / Regression
Easier: slide the top foot along the mat. Harder: add a small pulse at the top.

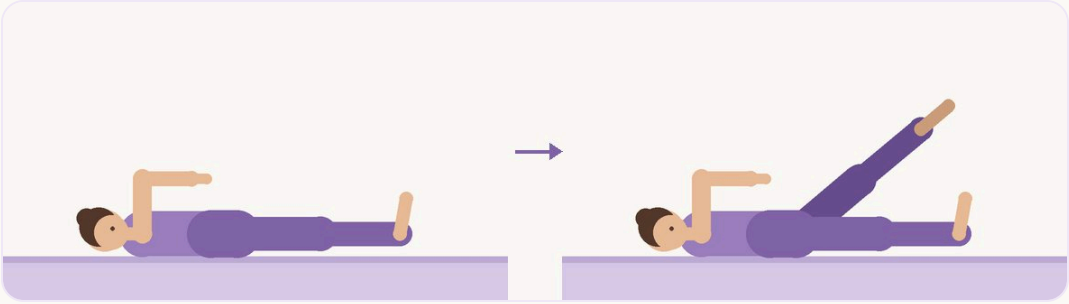
Cue
“Lift from your outer hip while your waist stays long.”

Adaptation
Knee issues: keep the leg slightly bent. Pregnancy: use a pillow under the head.

Side-Lying Leg Circles

small circles

Beginner | Mat | V1-017



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your side, legs stacked, top leg lifted to hip height.
2. Circle the leg slowly forward 6-8 times.
3. Reverse the direction.
4. Keep the waist long and the pelvis still.

Focus
Mobilizes the hip joint and trains pelvic stability. Improves hip control for walking and standing work.

Target muscles
Hip rotators, gluteals, obliques, transversus abdominis

Dosage
6-8 circles each direction · about 3 min

Breathing
Breathe naturally; exhale for the first half of each circle.

Common faults
Moving the pelvis, making circles too large, bending the knee, holding the breath.

Progression / Regression
Easier: make smaller circles. Harder: lift the leg higher.

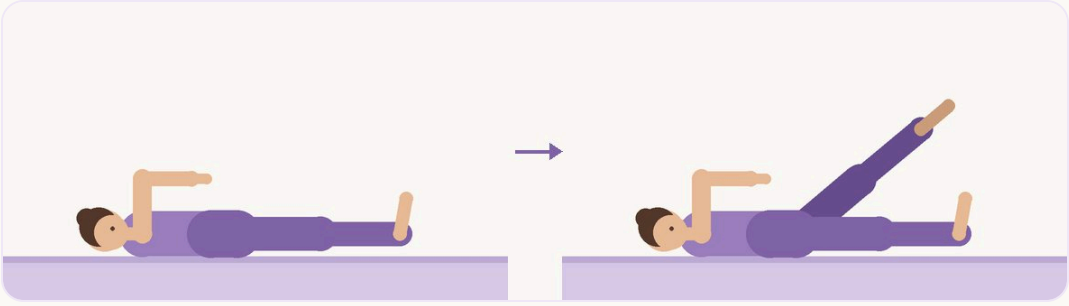
Cue
“Draw small circles without moving your hips.”

Adaptation
Hip issues: reduce range. Pregnancy: support the head with a pillow.

Side Kick Front and Back

leg swings

Beginner | Mat | V1-018



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your side, legs slightly forward, top leg lifted to hip height.
2. Inhale and kick the top leg forward twice.
3. Exhale and sweep the leg back to the line of the body.
4. Keep the torso stable throughout.

Focus
Trains hip flexion and extension with a stable torso. A classic of the side-lying series.

Target muscles
Hip flexors, gluteus maximus, hamstrings, obliques

Dosage
8-10 reps each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to swing forward; exhale to swing back.

Common faults
Arching the lower back, collapsing the waist, swinging too fast, rolling the pelvis.

Progression / Regression
Easier: reduce range. Harder: add a flexed foot and a longer reach.

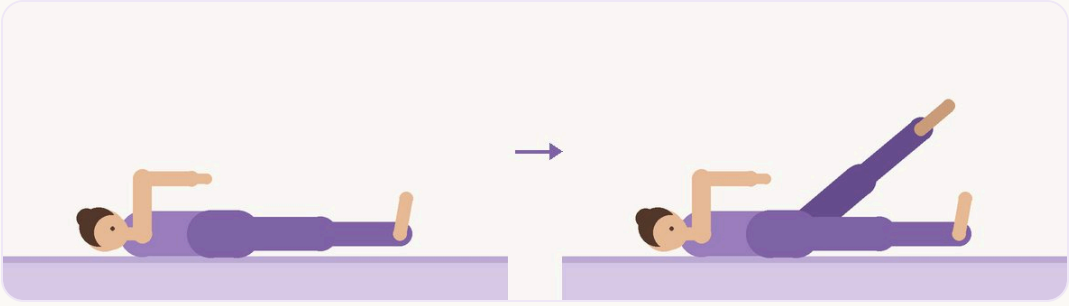
Cue
“Swing forward twice, then sweep back long.”

Adaptation
Lumbar issues: keep the back swing small. Pregnancy: use a pillow under the head.

Inner Thigh Lifts

bottom leg lifts

Beginner | Mat | V1-019



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your side, top leg bent in front on a cushion, bottom leg straight.
2. Flex the bottom foot and rest the leg on the mat.
3. Exhale and lift the bottom leg a few inches.
4. Inhale and lower with control.

Focus
Targets the adductors that are often underworked and stabilizes the pelvis. Safe and low impact.

Target muscles
Adductors, obliques, transversus abdominis

Dosage
10-12 reps each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to lift; inhale to lower.

Common faults
Rolling the top hip back, lifting from the foot, collapsing the waist, rushing.

Progression / Regression
Easier: support the top leg on a cushion. Harder: add a small pulse at the top.

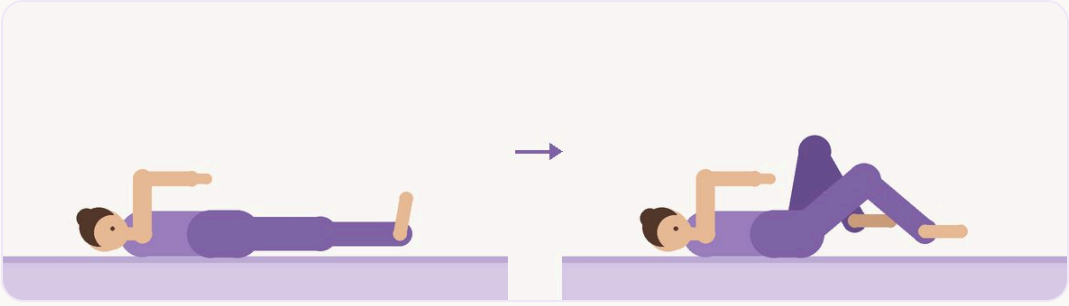
Cue
“Lift from your inner thigh, not your foot.”

Adaptation
Hip or groin issues: use a small range. Pregnancy: support the head with a pillow.

Clam

hip external rotation

Beginner | Mat | V1-020



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your side, knees bent 45 degrees, feet together, hips stacked.
2. Keep the feet touching and the pelvis still.
3. Exhale and open the top knee like a clam.
4. Inhale to close with control.

Focus
Strengthens the deep hip rotators and glutes while teaching pelvic control. Helpful for knee and low back support.

Target muscles
Gluteus medius, deep hip rotators, obliques

Dosage
12-15 reps each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to open the knee; inhale to close.

Common faults
Rolling the pelvis back, lifting the feet, rushing, holding the breath.

Progression / Regression
Easier: shallow lift. Harder: raise the feet slightly or hold 3 seconds.

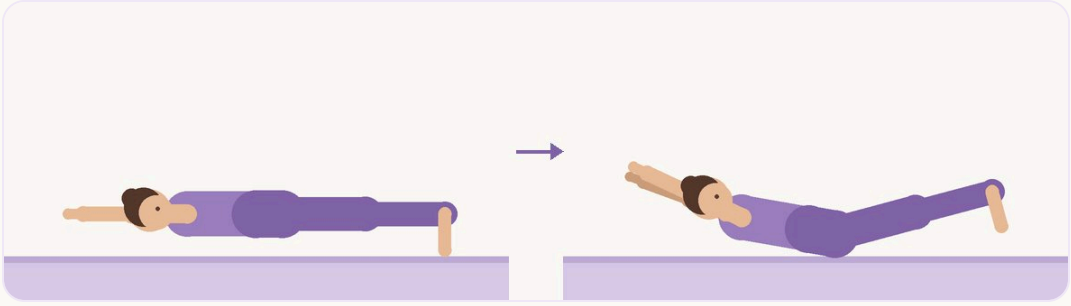
Cue
“Open your knee like a clam, keep your pelvis steady.”

Adaptation
Knee issues: reduce range. Pregnancy: place a pillow between the knees if needed.

Swimming Prep

prone arm and leg lifts

Beginner | Mat | V1-021



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie face down, legs hip-width, arms long overhead, forehead on the mat.
2. Draw the navel lightly off the floor.
3. Lift one arm and the opposite leg a few inches.
4. Lower and switch sides with control.

Focus
Strengthens the back extensors and glutes with minimal strain. Lays groundwork for Swimming and Swan.

Target muscles
Erector spinae, gluteus maximus, rhomboids, lower trapezius

Dosage
6-8 reps each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lift; exhale to lower.

Common faults
Overarching the lower back, lifting the head too high, shrugging, jerky motion.

Progression / Regression
Easier: lift only the arms. Harder: lift opposite arm and leg together.

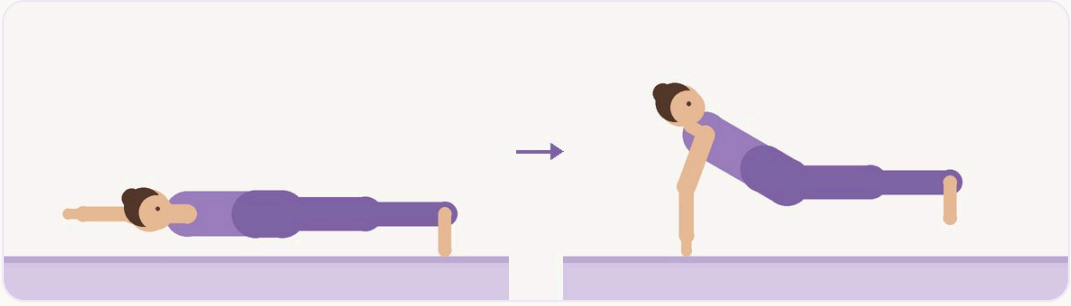
Cue
“Reach long through the fingers and the toes.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: avoid prone work; use quadruped. Lumbar issues: keep the lift low.

Swan Prep

prone extension on forearms

Beginner | Mat | V1-022



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie face down with forearms on the mat, elbows under shoulders.
2. Draw the navel up and lengthen the legs behind you.
3. Inhale and lift the chest, keeping the neck long.
4. Exhale and lower with control.

Focus
Strengthens spinal extensors and stretches the front body. Counters long periods of sitting.

Target muscles
Erector spinae, rhomboids, rectus abdominis, hip flexors

Dosage
5-6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lift the chest; exhale to lower.

Common faults
Crunching the neck, hyperextending the lower back, shrugging, locking the elbows.

Progression / Regression
Easier: lift only the head and upper chest. Harder: lengthen the arms.

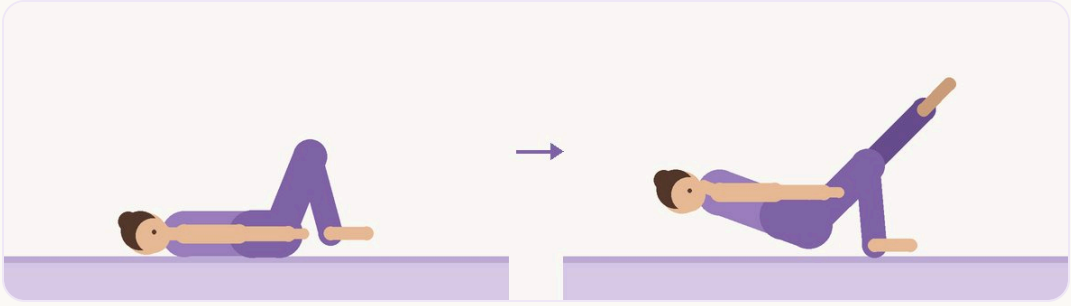
Cue
“Lengthen forward before you lift your chest.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: skip prone work. Lumbar issues: keep the lift small and avoid pain.

Bridge with Marching

single-leg lifts in bridge

Beginner | Mat | V1-023



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back, knees bent, and lift into a bridge.
2. Keep the hips level and the belly drawn in.
3. Exhale and lift one foot a few inches.
4. Lower and switch sides.

Focus
Challenges hip and pelvic stability while the legs alternate. Builds glute strength safely.

Target muscles
Gluteus maximus, hamstrings, transversus abdominis, obliques

Dosage
6-8 reps each leg · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to lift a foot; inhale to lower.

Common faults
Dropping a hip, arching the lower back, lifting the foot too high, holding the breath.

Progression / Regression
Easier: hold the bridge without marching. Harder: extend the lifted leg.

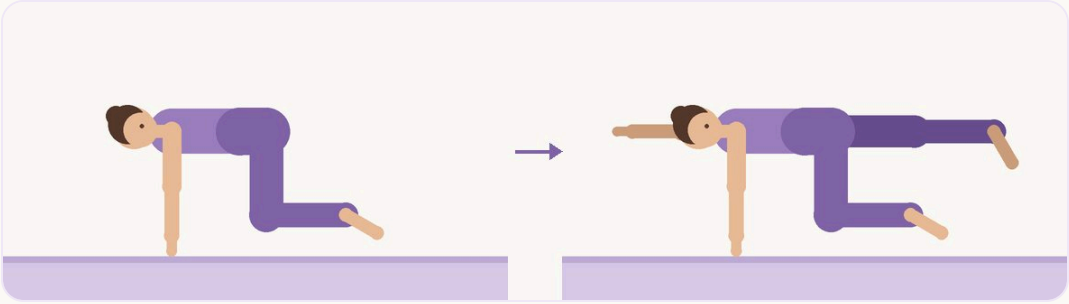
Cue
“Keep your hips level as you march.”

Adaptation
Knee issues: keep the range small. Pregnancy: only in the first trimester.

Bird Dog

quadruped opposite reach

Beginner | Mat | V1-024



HOW TO DO IT

1. Come to hands and knees, wrists under shoulders, knees under hips.
2. Reach one arm forward and the opposite leg back.
3. Hold for one breath, keeping the hips level.
4. Return and switch sides.

Focus
Trains core stability and balance with opposite arm and leg reaching. Excellent for low back support.

Target muscles
Erector spinae, gluteus maximus, deltoids, transversus abdominis

Dosage
6-8 reps each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare; exhale to reach; inhale to return.

Common faults
Rotating the pelvis, arching the back, shrugging, reaching too high.

Progression / Regression
Easier: lift only the leg or only the arm. Harder: add an elbow-to-knee crunch.

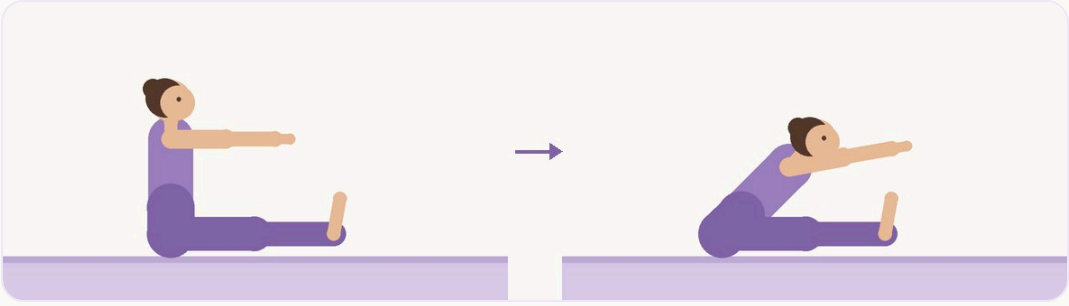
Cue
“Reach long, stay square, and keep your hips level.”

Adaptation
Wrist pain: use fists. Pregnancy: great option; keep the belly gently lifted.

Mermaid

seated side bend

Beginner | Mat | V1-025



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit cross-legged or in a mermaid position, one hand on the mat.
2. Inhale and reach the opposite arm up.
3. Exhale and bend sideways over the supporting arm.
4. Inhale to return and switch sides.

Focus
Opens the side body and teaches lateral flexion with a long spine. Excellent for desk workers.

Target muscles
Obliques, quadratus lumborum, latissimus dorsi, intercostals

Dosage
4-6 reps each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to reach up; exhale to bend sideways.

Common faults
Collapsing forward, tilting the pelvis, shrugging, rotating the ribs.

Progression / Regression
Easier: keep the hand on the hip. Harder: reach the top arm farther overhead.

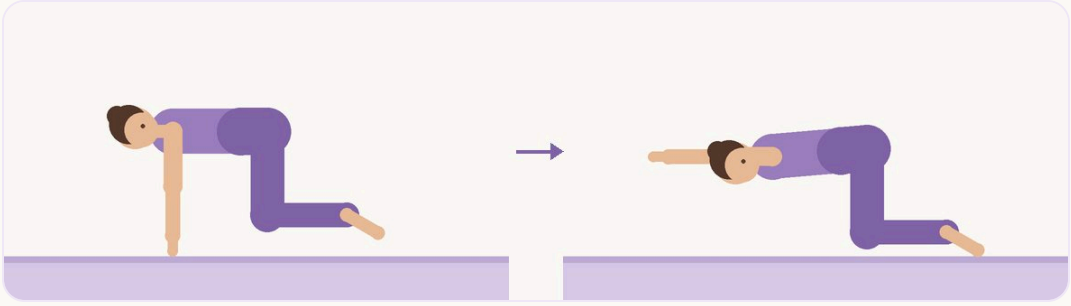
Cue
“Reach up and out over a big rainbow.”

Adaptation
Shoulder issues: lower the arm. Pregnancy: sit on a cushion.

Child's Pose

resting stretch

Beginner | Mat | V1-026



HOW TO DO IT

1. Kneel with big toes together and knees apart.
2. Sit the hips back toward the heels.
3. Extend the arms forward and rest the forehead on the mat.
4. Breathe slowly for the full hold.

Focus
Gently stretches the back and hips and calms the nervous system. A restful reset at the end of class.

Target muscles
Spinal extensors, lats, glutes, hip rotators

Dosage
60 sec hold · about 2 min

Breathing
Breathe slowly into the back ribs and let the exhale lengthen.

Common faults
Forcing the hips down, tensing the shoulders, holding the breath.

Progression / Regression
Easier: place a pillow under the hips. Harder: walk the hands to one side.

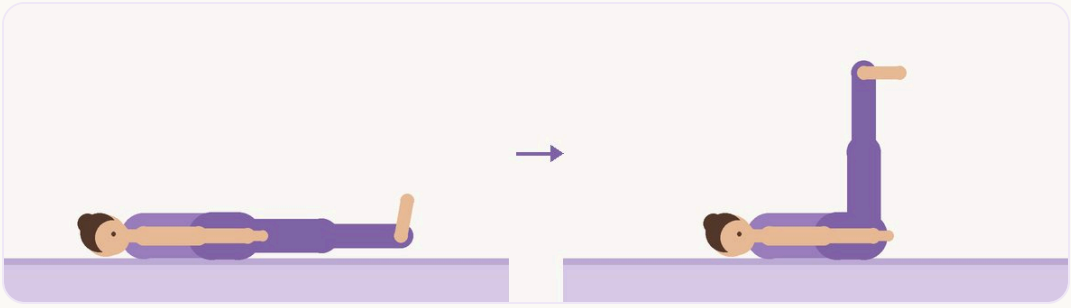
Cue
“Let your hips sink back and your back widen.”

Adaptation
Knee issues: pad under the knees. Pregnancy: widen the knees to make space for the belly.

Supine Hamstring Stretch

leg raised with strap

Beginner | Mat | V1-027



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back with one leg extended on the mat.
2. Lift the other leg toward the ceiling, holding the calf or a strap.
3. Keep the pelvis heavy and the back long.
4. Hold, then switch legs.

Focus
Lengthens the hamstrings with a stable pelvis, improving seated posture and forward folds.

Target muscles
Hamstrings, calves, gluteus maximus

Dosage
30 sec hold each side · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare; exhale to deepen the stretch.

Common faults
Lifting the hips, bending the knee too much, tensing the neck.

Progression / Regression
Easier: bend the knee slightly. Harder: use a strap and straighten the leg.

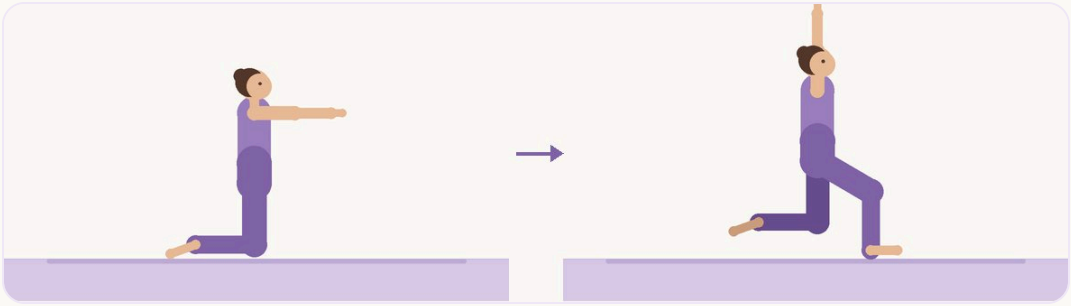
Cue
“Keep your pelvis heavy and your leg long.”

Adaptation
Lumbar issues: keep the opposite knee bent. Pregnancy: use a wedge after the first trimester.

Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch

low lunge

Beginner | Mat | V1-028



HOW TO DO IT

1. Kneel on one knee with the other foot forward, knees at 90 degrees.
2. Tuck the tailbone slightly and press the hips forward.
3. Keep the torso upright and the ribs stacked.
4. Hold, then switch sides.

Focus
Opens the front of the hip, which is often tight from sitting. Improves pelvic alignment.

Target muscles
Iliopsoas, rectus femoris, quadriceps

Dosage
30 sec hold each side · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to lengthen; exhale to sink into the stretch.

Common faults
Arching the lower back, leaning forward, letting the knee drift inward.

Progression / Regression
Easier: pad the knee. Harder: lift the back arm overhead.

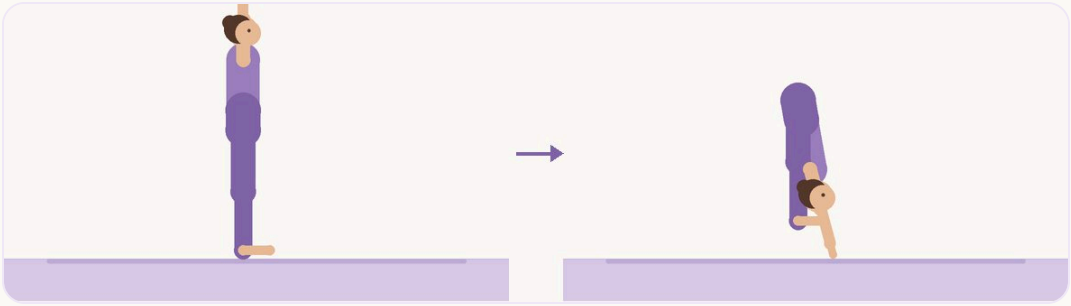
Cue
“Tuck your tailbone and press the hips forward.”

Adaptation
Knee issues: pad the knee. Pregnancy: widen the stance and use a chair for support.

Standing Roll Down

articulating forward

Beginner | Mat | V1-029



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand tall with feet hip-width, arms by your sides.
2. Exhale and nod the chin, then roll down vertebra by vertebra.
3. Hang for one breath with the knees soft.
4. Exhale and stack back up to standing.

Focus
Warms the spine and hamstrings and teaches peeling down through the vertebrae. A standard class opener.

Target muscles
Hamstrings, spinal flexors, transversus abdominis

Dosage
5-6 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare; exhale to roll down; inhale to hang; exhale to roll up.

Common faults
Locking the knees, collapsing the chest, rolling too fast, tensing the neck.

Progression / Regression
Easier: bend the knees. Harder: roll up one vertebra at a time with hands overhead.

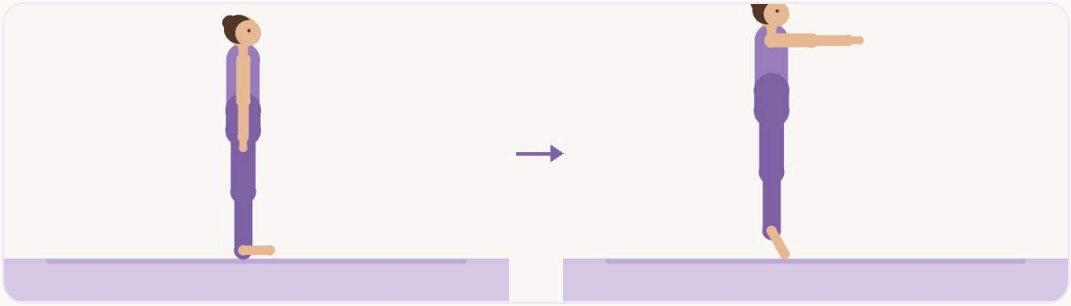
Cue
“Peel forward one vertebra at a time.”

Adaptation
Lumbar issues: bend the knees. Pregnancy: widen the feet and keep the roll shallow.

Standing Heel Raises

Pilates stance

Beginner | Mat | V1-030



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand in Pilates stance: heels together, toes slightly turned out.
2. Draw the navel in and lengthen the spine.
3. Exhale and rise onto the balls of the feet.
4. Inhale and lower the heels with control.

Focus
Builds ankle strength and balance with a lifted pelvic floor. Develops alignment for standing exercises.

Target muscles
Gastrocnemius, soleus, tibialis anterior, deep stabilizers

Dosage
10-12 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare; exhale to rise; inhale to lower.

Common faults
Rolling the ankles outward, locking the knees, leaning forward, rushing.

Progression / Regression
Easier: hold a wall or chair. Harder: close the eyes or lift one foot.

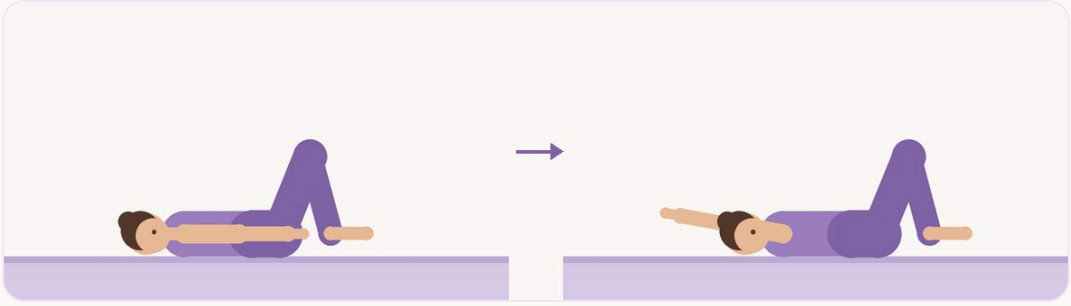
Cue
“Rise tall, lift your arches, and balance.”

Adaptation
Older adults: hold a chair. Knee or ankle issues: reduce range.

Supine Arm Circles

arms to the ceiling

Beginner | Mat | V1-031



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back, knees bent, arms reaching to the ceiling.
2. Keep the ribs down and the shoulders relaxed.
3. Circle the arms outward and down, then back up.
4. Reverse the direction.

Focus
Mobilizes the shoulder girdle while the core holds the spine still. A gentle shoulder warm-up.

Target muscles
Deltoids, serratus anterior, rotator cuff, transversus abdominis

Dosage
6-8 circles each direction · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to lift the arms; exhale to circle down; inhale to return.

Common faults
Arching the back, lifting the ribs, hunching the shoulders, going too fast.

Progression / Regression
Easier: smaller circles. Harder: add light weights or hold the legs in table-top.

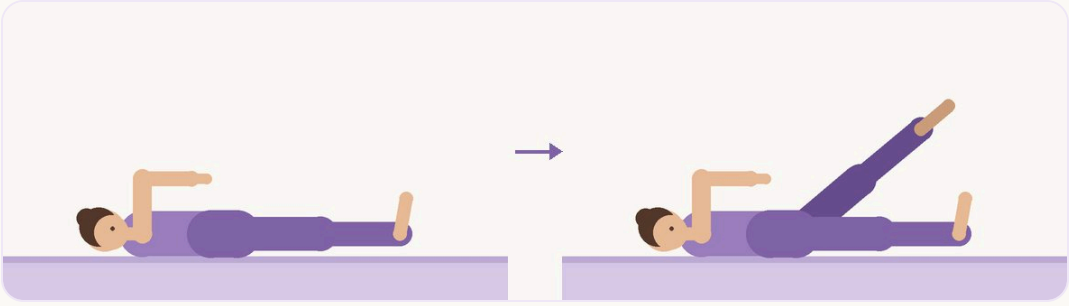
Cue
“Circle your arms without moving your ribs.”

Adaptation
Shoulder issues: reduce range. Pregnancy: use a wedge after the first trimester.

Side-Lying Arm Openings

thoracic rotation

Beginner | Mat | V1-032



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your side with the knees bent and arms stretched forward.
2. Lift the top hand and open it to the other side.
3. Follow the hand with the gaze if comfortable.
4. Return the hand to the starting position.

Focus
Opens the chest and mobilizes the thoracic spine. Releases tension in the upper back and shoulders.

Target muscles
Rhomboids, pectoralis, obliques, thoracic spinal rotators

Dosage
6-8 reps each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to open the arm; exhale to return.

Common faults
Letting the knees slide apart, forcing the range, tensing the neck.

Progression / Regression
Easier: use a pillow under the head. Harder: follow the hand with the gaze.

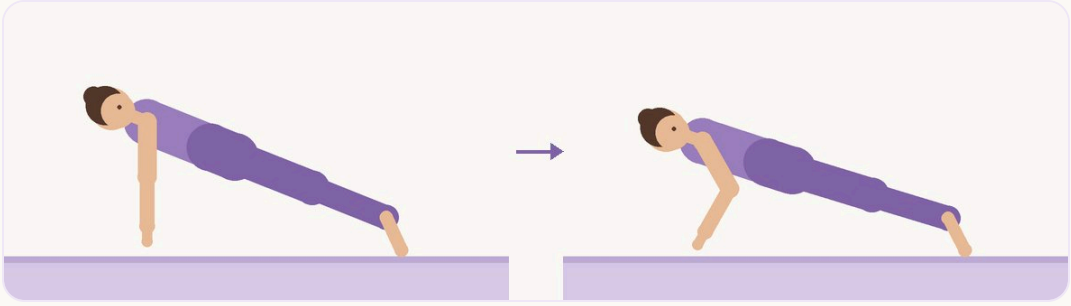
Cue
“Open your chest like a book.”

Adaptation
Shoulder issues: keep the range small. Pregnancy: use pillows to support the knees.

Modified Push-Up

on the knees

Beginner | Mat | V1-033



HOW TO DO IT

1. Come to hands and knees, then walk the hands forward.
2. Set a long line from the head to the knees.
3. Inhale and bend the elbows, lowering the chest.
4. Exhale and press away from the floor.

Focus
Builds upper body strength and shoulder stability with a long spine. A step toward full push-ups.

Target muscles
Pectoralis, triceps, serratus anterior, transversus abdominis

Dosage
6-8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lower; exhale to press up.

Common faults
Sagging hips, flared elbows, shrugging, dropping the head.

Progression / Regression
Easier: do wall push-ups. Harder: lift the knees into a full push-up.

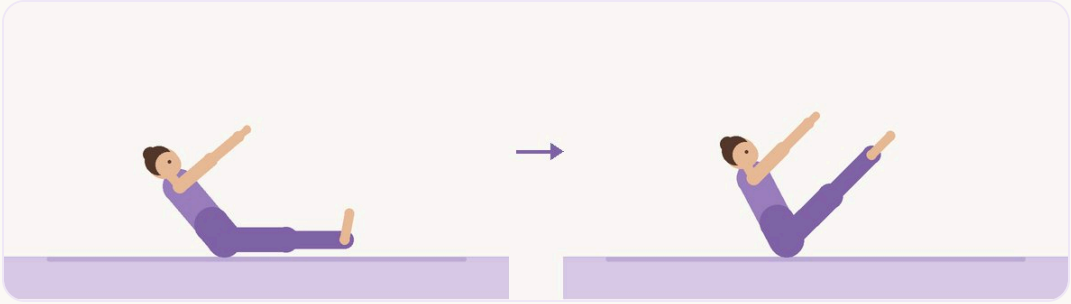
Cue
“Lower as one long plank and press away from the floor.”

Adaptation
Wrist or shoulder issues: use a wall. Pregnancy: use an incline.

Teaser Prep

bent knees

Beginner | Mat | V1-034



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit with knees bent and feet on the floor, arms forward.
2. Exhale and roll back to the base of the shoulder blades.
3. Inhale to hold, lifting one leg to table-top.
4. Exhale and roll up, placing the foot down.

Focus
Develops abdominal strength and balance on the sit bones. The first step toward the Teaser.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, hip flexors, transversus abdominis

Dosage
5-6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare; exhale to roll back; inhale to hold; exhale to return.

Common faults
Using momentum, collapsing the chest, gripping the knees, holding the breath.

Progression / Regression
Easier: keep feet on the floor. Harder: lift the legs to table-top.

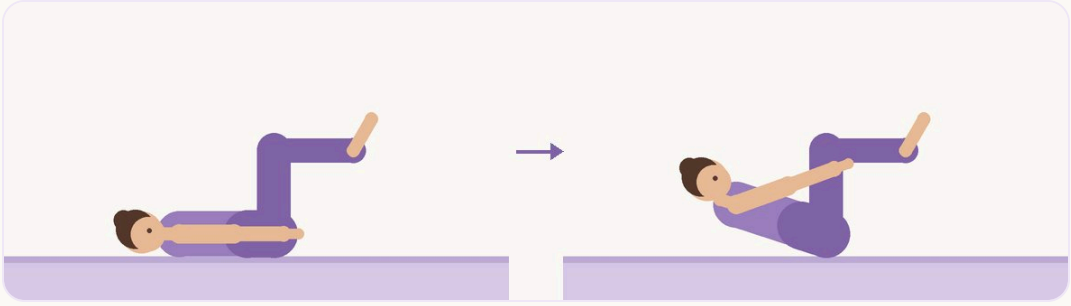
Cue
“Roll back with control and find your balance.”

Adaptation
Lumbar or neck issues: limit range. Pregnancy: avoid.

Leg Lowers

single-leg lowers

Beginner | Mat | V1-035



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back with both legs lifted straight to the ceiling.
2. Keep the pelvis neutral.
3. Exhale and lower one leg partway.
4. Inhale and lift it back up, then switch.

Focus
Challenges the abdominals to resist back arching while one leg lowers. Builds control for advanced work.

Target muscles
Transversus abdominis, hip flexors, rectus abdominis

Dosage
6-8 reps each leg · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to lower; inhale to lift.

Common faults
Arching the lower back, lowering too far, tensing the neck, holding the breath.

Progression / Regression
Easier: lower only to the knee. Harder: lower both legs together.

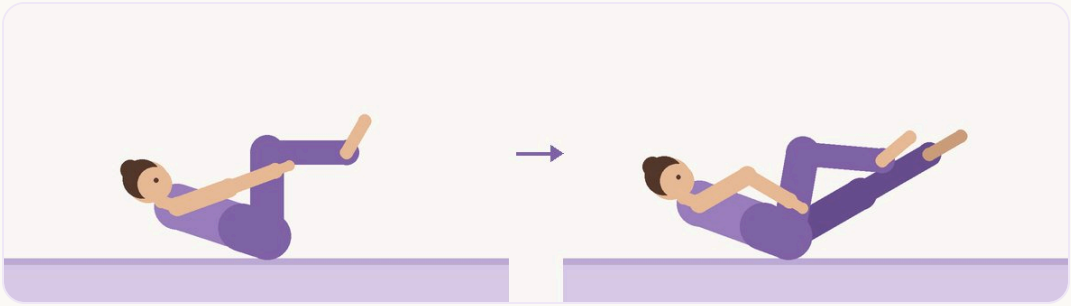
Cue
“Lower your leg only as far as your back stays still.”

Adaptation
Lumbar issues: keep the range small. Pregnancy: avoid after the first trimester.

Criss-Cross Prep

small rotations

Beginner | Mat | V1-036



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back with knees in table-top and hands behind the head.
2. Curl the head and shoulders up.
3. Exhale and rotate toward one knee.
4. Inhale to center and switch sides.

Focus
Introduces oblique work with a stable pelvis. Builds rotational strength for sports and daily life.

Target muscles
Obliques, rectus abdominis, hip flexors

Dosage
8-10 reps each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to rotate; inhale to return to center.

Common faults
Pulling the neck, swinging the elbows, letting the knees wobble, rushing.

Progression / Regression
Easier: keep the feet on the floor. Harder: extend the opposite leg.

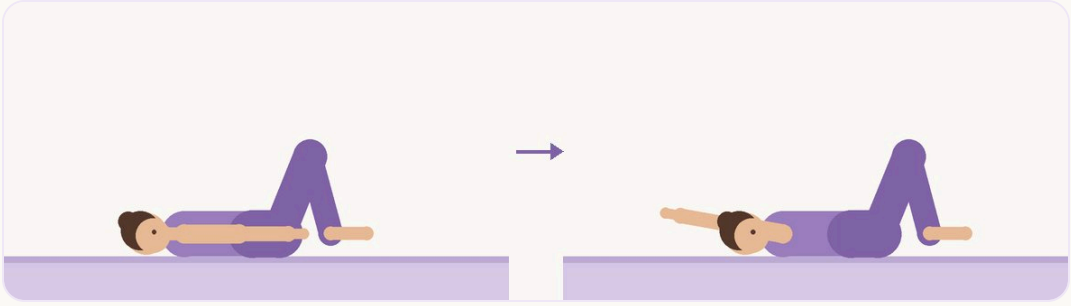
Cue
“Rotate your ribcage, not your elbows.”

Adaptation
Neck issues: keep the head down. Pregnancy: avoid after the first trimester.

Chin Nods

neck warm-up

Beginner | Mat | V1-037



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back with knees bent and the neck long.
2. Inhale to prepare.
3. Exhale and gently nod the chin toward the chest.
4. Inhale to release back to neutral.

Focus
Gently releases the neck and teaches deep cervical flexor activation. A safe warm-up for the head and neck.

Target muscles
Deep neck flexors, longus colli

Dosage
6-8 reps · about 1 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare; exhale as the chin nods.

Common faults
Pressing the head into the mat, lifting the head, tensing the jaw.

Progression / Regression
Easier: place a small towel under the head. Harder: hold the nod for 5 seconds.

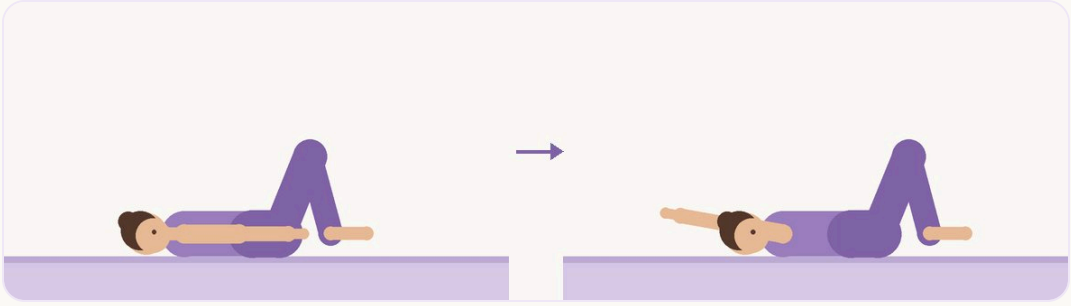
Cue
“Nod as if saying a small yes.”

Adaptation
Neck issues: use a small range. Pregnancy: use a wedge for comfort.

Pelvic Clock

tilting around the dial

Beginner | Mat | V1-038



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back with knees bent and feet flat.
2. Imagine a clock on your lower abdomen.
3. Tilt the pelvis toward 12, then 3, 6, and 9.
4. Reverse the direction.

Focus
Improves lumbar mobility and awareness of pelvic position. Helps find neutral and relieve stiffness.

Target muscles
Transversus abdominis, obliques, lumbar multifidus

Dosage
4-6 circles each direction · about 2 min

Breathing
Breathe naturally and exhale on each shift.

Common faults
Moving the legs, squeezing the glutes, rushing, holding the breath.

Progression / Regression
Easier: use only 12 and 6 o'clock. Harder: do slow full circles.

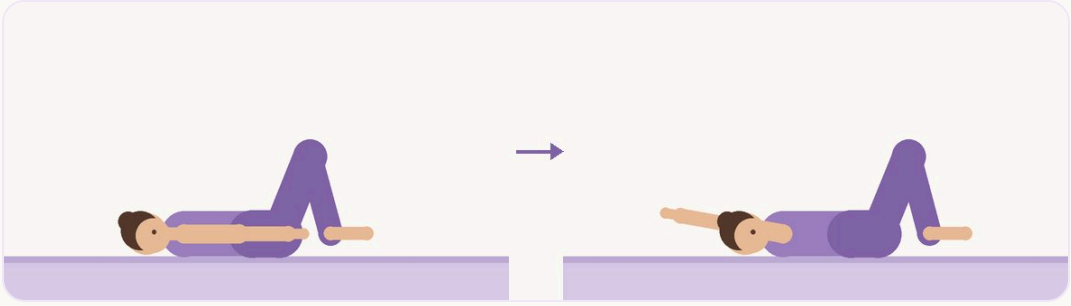
Cue
“Imagine a clock under your pelvis and trace it slowly.”

Adaptation
Lumbar issues: keep the range small. Pregnancy: practice seated on a ball or chair.

Scapular Isolations

shoulder blade glides

Beginner | Mat | V1-039



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall with arms by your sides.
2. Inhale and lift the shoulders toward the ears.
3. Exhale and glide the shoulder blades down the back.
4. Move slowly and keep the neck long.

Focus
Teaches control of the shoulder blades, reducing neck and shoulder tension. Prepares for arm work.

Target muscles
Serratus anterior, lower trapezius, rhomboids

Dosage
8-10 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to lift; exhale to draw down.

Common faults
Shrugging, arching the back, moving the ribs, overdoing the range.

Progression / Regression
Easier: practice with hands on the thighs. Harder: add arm lifts.

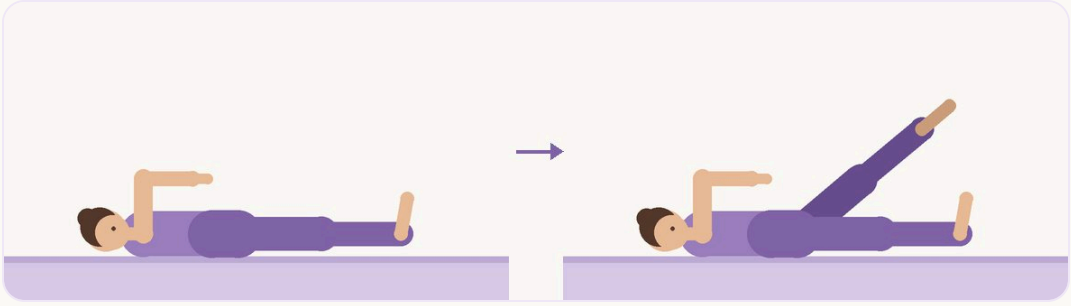
Cue
“Slide your shoulder blades down your back.”

Adaptation
Shoulder issues: use a small range. Pregnancy: practice seated.

Supine Spinal Twist

knees to the side

Beginner | Mat | V1-040



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back with knees bent and arms in a T shape.
2. Let both knees fall slowly to one side.
3. Keep both shoulders heavy on the mat.
4. Breathe, then return to center and switch sides.

Focus
Releases the lower back and hips with gentle rotation. A calming way to end class.

Target muscles
Obliques, erector spinae, glutes, hip rotators

Dosage
30 sec hold each side · about 2 min

Breathing
Breathe slowly into the ribs and exhale to deepen the twist.

Common faults
Lifting the shoulders, forcing the knees down, holding the breath.

Progression / Regression
Easier: place a pillow between the knees. Harder: extend the top arm and gaze over it.

Cue
“Let your knees fall and your back soften.”

Adaptation
Lumbar issues: keep the range small. Pregnancy: avoid after the first trimester or use pillows.

VOLUME 1 · BEGINNER

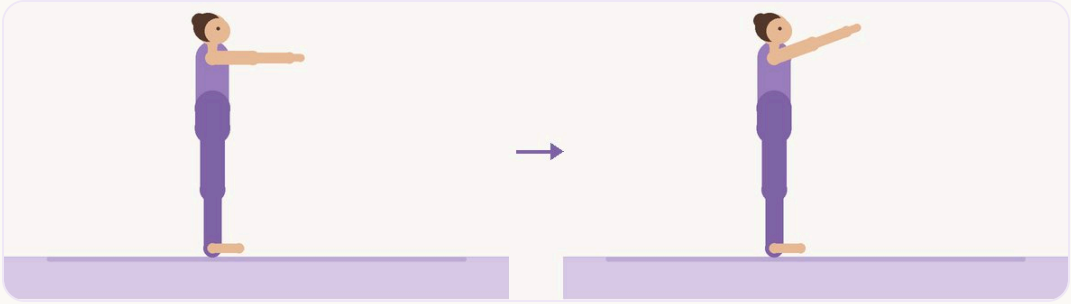
Band

14 exercises

Band Arm Openings

standing warm-up

Beginner | Band | V1-041



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand tall, feet hip-width, holding the band at shoulder width in front of your chest.
2. Soften your knees and draw your lower ribs toward your hips.
3. Exhale and open the arms wide until the band touches your chest line.
4. Inhale and return with control.

Focus
Wakes up the upper back and shoulders and teaches ribs-down posture before heavier work.

Target muscles
Rhomboids, rear deltoids, middle trapezius, deep abdominals

Dosage
8–10 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare, exhale as you open the arms, inhale to return.

Common faults
Flaring the ribs, shrugging the shoulders, letting the band pull the wrists out of line.

Progression / Regression
Easier: lighter band, smaller range. Harder: slow the return over four counts.

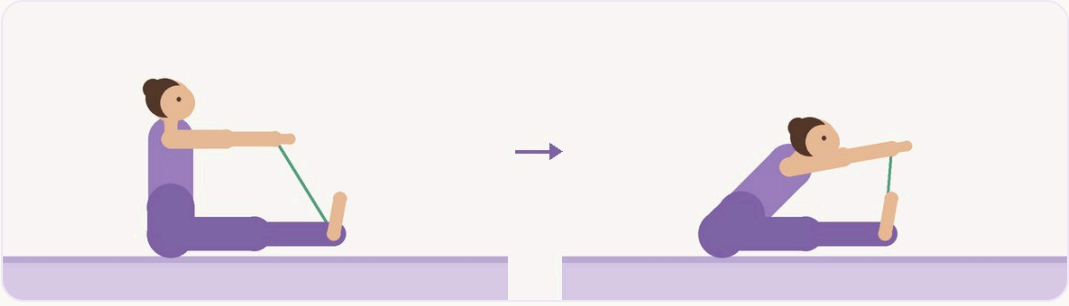
Cue
“Draw your shoulder blades gently down your back as you open.”

Adaptation
Safe in all trimesters while standing; keep the stance wide and skip any shoulder pinch.

Seated Band Row

long sit

Beginner | Band | V1-042



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall with legs extended, band looped around the arches of your feet.
2. Hold the ends with arms reaching forward at chest height.
3. Exhale and draw elbows back along your ribs.
4. Inhale and reach the arms forward with control.

Focus
Strengthens the back muscles that hold the spine upright while teaching a stable pelvis.

Target muscles
Latissimus dorsi, rhomboids, rear deltoids, biceps

Dosage
10 reps, 2 sets · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lengthen tall, exhale to pull the elbows back.

Common faults
Rounding the back, hiking the shoulders, pulling with the hands instead of the back.

Progression / Regression
Easier: sit on a folded towel with bent knees. Harder: add a slow three-count return.

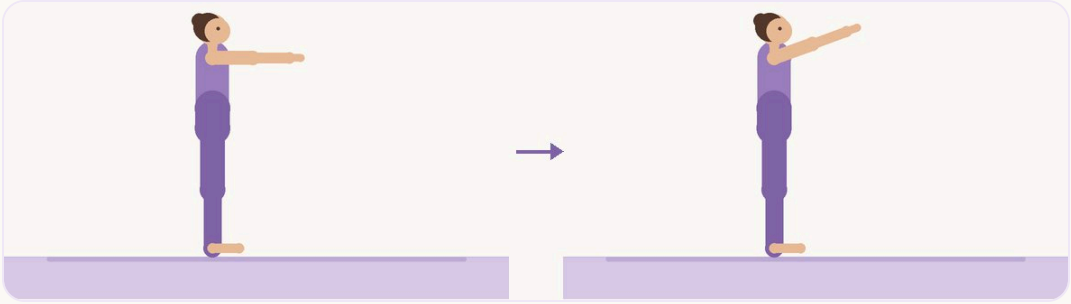
Cue
“Pull your elbows back like you are tucking them into your back pockets.”

Adaptation
Bend the knees for tight hamstrings or low back sensitivity; use a light band for shoulder injuries.

Band Chest Expansion

standing

Beginner | Band | V1-043



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand tall holding the band in both hands, arms by your thighs.
2. Gently lift your chest and lengthen through the crown of your head.
3. Exhale and draw the band behind you with straight arms.
4. Inhale and return slowly without losing posture.

Focus
Opens the chest and strengthens the upper back for better posture in daily life.

Target muscles
Posterior deltoids, triceps, rhomboids, deep core

Dosage
8 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to set the stance, exhale as you press the band back.

Common faults
Leaning backward, flaring the ribs, bending the elbows as you pull.

Progression / Regression
Easier: smaller range with a light band. Harder: add a gentle head turn each side.

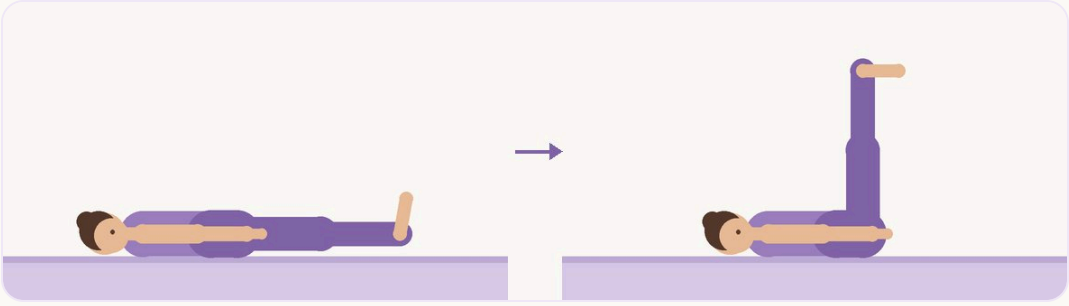
Cue
“Press the band back while your ribs stay softly knitted.”

Adaptation
Stand near a wall for balance if needed; reduce range with any shoulder discomfort.

Supine Band Footwork

feet in the band

Beginner | Band | V1-044



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back, knees bent, band around the arches of both feet.
2. Hold the band ends with elbows resting at your sides.
3. Exhale and extend the legs to a comfortable angle.
4. Inhale and bend the knees back to start.

Focus
Builds leg strength and hip control while the spine stays quiet and supported.

Target muscles
Quadriceps, glutes, hamstrings, calves

Dosage
10 reps each position · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to bend the knees, exhale to extend the legs.

Common faults
Tucking the tailbone, letting the knees fall inward, gripping the thighs.

Progression / Regression
Easier: small range with a lighter band. Harder: lift the head and shoulders slightly.

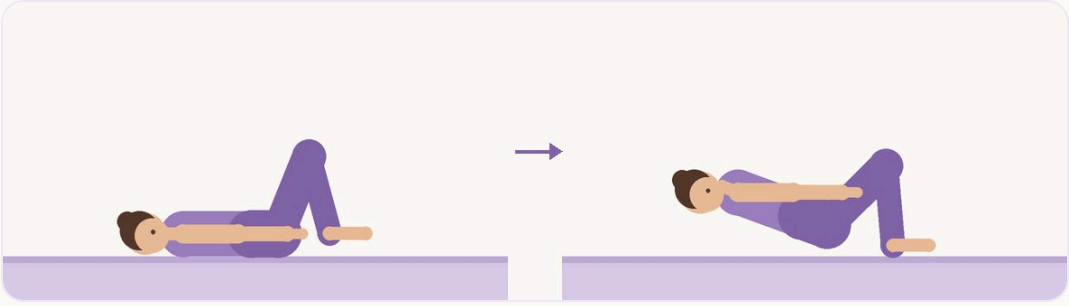
Cue
“Press through your heels and keep your knees tracking over your toes.”

Adaptation
After the first trimester, prop the torso on a wedge instead of lying flat; bend the knees more with knee pain.

Bridge with Band Abduction

hip-level band

Beginner | Band | V1-045



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back, knees bent, band looped above the knees.
2. Press the knees gently out against the band.
3. Exhale and roll up to a long line from shoulders to knees.
4. Inhale to hold, then exhale to roll down slowly.

Focus
Strengthens the glutes and outer hips to support the pelvis in walking and standing.

Target muscles
Gluteus medius, gluteus maximus, hamstrings

Dosage
10 reps, 2 sets · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare, exhale as you lift the hips and press the knees out.

Common faults
Overarching the low back, letting the knees collapse in, lifting too high.

Progression / Regression
Easier: hips only, no band. Harder: hold the top for three breaths.

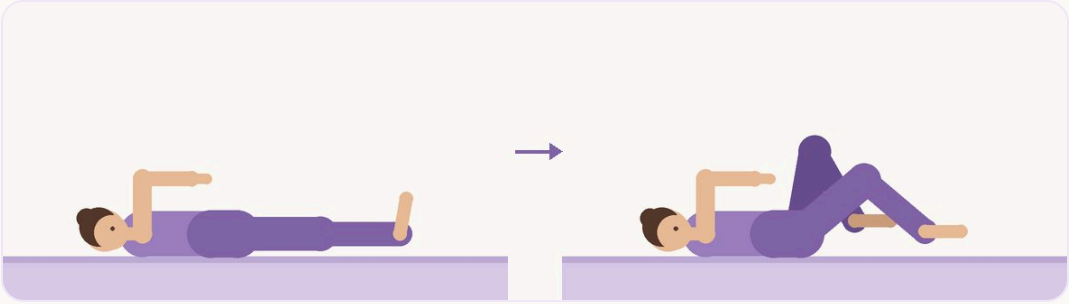
Cue
“Lift one vertebra at a time and keep pressing your knees apart.”

Adaptation
Skip or use a wedge under the back in later pregnancy; keep the lift small with back sensitivity.

Band Clamshell

side-lying

Beginner | Band | V1-046



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your side, knees bent, hips stacked, band around the thighs.
2. Rest your head on your arm and draw the lower ribs in.
3. Exhale and open the top knee while the heels stay together.
4. Inhale and close slowly.

Focus
Targets the deep hip rotators and glutes that stabilize the pelvis.

Target muscles
Gluteus medius, deep hip rotators

Dosage
12 reps each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare, exhale as the top knee opens.

Common faults
Rolling the pelvis back, lifting the feet apart, rushing the return.

Progression / Regression
Easier: no band. Harder: lift the bottom knee slightly off the floor.

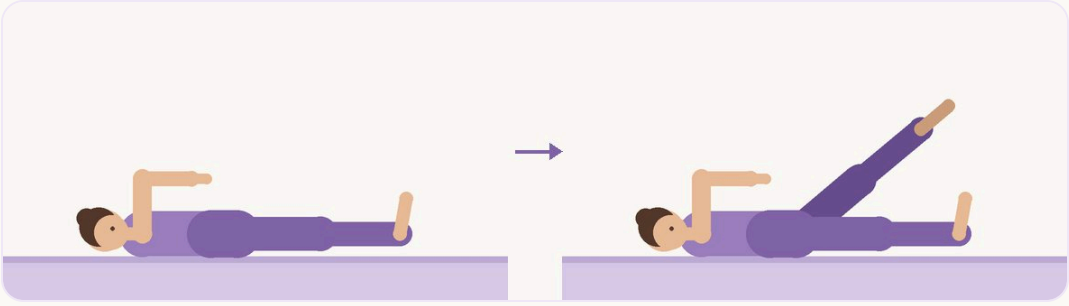
Cue
“Open the top knee like a book without moving your pelvis.”

Adaptation
Place a pillow under the head and between the knees in pregnancy; keep range small with hip pain.

Band External Rotation

elbows at sides

Beginner | Band | V1-047



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand holding the band at waist height with elbows bent to ninety degrees.
2. Keep elbows tucked against your ribs.
3. Exhale and rotate the forearms outward, keeping the wrists straight.
4. Inhale and return slowly.

Focus
Builds shoulder stability using small, controlled rotations that protect the joint.

Target muscles
Infraspinatus, teres minor, rear deltoids

Dosage
10 reps, 2 sets · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare, exhale as the hands rotate outward.

Common faults
Letting the elbows drift away, shrugging, rotating from the wrists.

Progression / Regression
Easier: lighter band or a towel under the elbow. Harder: slow the return over four counts.

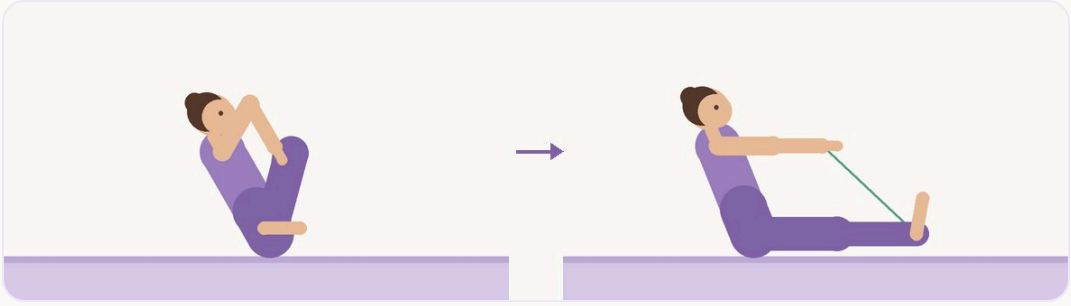
Cue
“Keep your elbows glued to your sides and rotate from the shoulder.”

Adaptation
With shoulder injury, use a very light band and stop at any pain; consult the client's provider.

Band Roll Back

seated

Beginner | Band | V1-048



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall with knees bent, feet flat, holding the band looped around your feet.
2. Soften the elbows and draw your belly in.
3. Exhale and roll back into a small C-curve.
4. Inhale to hold, exhale to roll up tall.

Focus
Introduces the C-curve and abdominal control used in the classical Roll Up.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, transverse abdominis, hip flexors

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to sit tall, exhale as you roll back.

Common faults
Collapsing the chest, gripping the band hard, rolling back too far.

Progression / Regression
Easier: roll back only a few inches. Harder: roll to a full C-curve with the arms reaching forward.

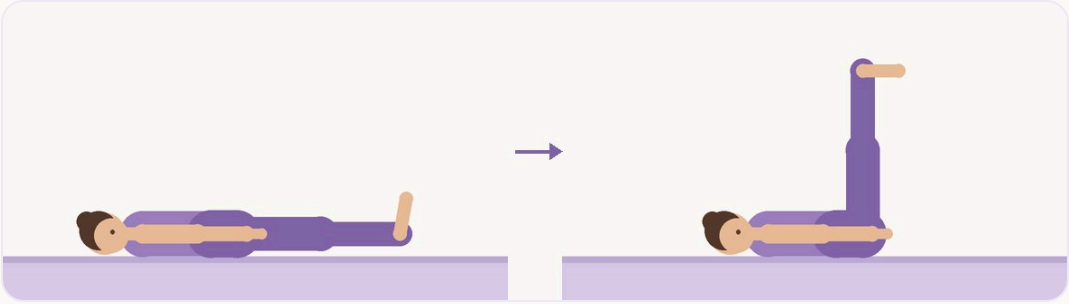
Cue
“Scoop your belly in and roll back one vertebra at a time.”

Adaptation
Skip in pregnancy after the first trimester; keep range small with back pain or osteoporosis.

Supine Hamstring Stretch

band around the foot

Beginner | Band | V1-049



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back with the band looped around one foot.
2. Extend that leg toward the ceiling, holding the band ends.
3. Keep the other leg long or knee bent on the floor.
4. Hold gently while breathing, then switch sides.

Focus
Lengthens the hamstrings gently, easing pelvic tension that affects posture.

Target muscles
Hamstrings, calves

Dosage
30 sec each side · about 2 min

Breathing
Breathe slowly and evenly; let each exhale soften the stretch.

Common faults
Pulling the leg too far, lifting the pelvis, bending the supporting leg.

Progression / Regression
Easier: bend the top knee slightly. Harder: draw the leg closer while keeping the pelvis still.

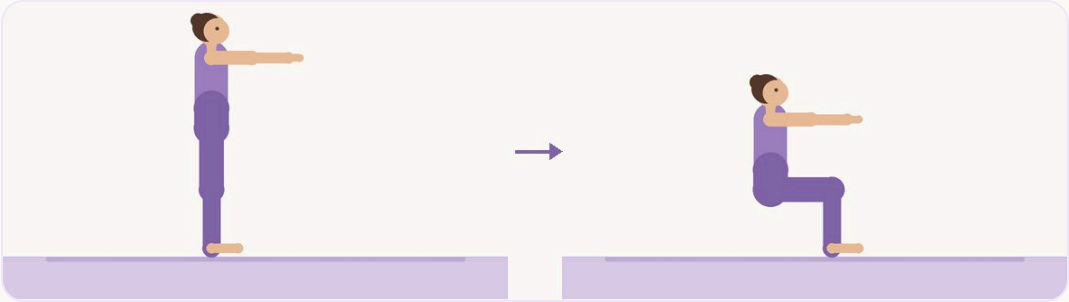
Cue
“Reach through your heel and let the leg grow longer.”

Adaptation
Use a bent knee with sciatic sensitivity; in later pregnancy do this seated or on an incline.

Band Mini Squat

standing

Beginner | Band | V1-050



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand with feet hip-width, band around the thighs just above the knees.
2. Press the knees lightly outward against the band.
3. Inhale and bend the knees, hips back.
4. Exhale and rise through your heels.

Focus
Builds the foundation for sitting and standing with strong, aligned hips and knees.

Target muscles
Quadriceps, glutes, hamstrings

Dosage
10 reps, 2 sets · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale as you lower, exhale as you stand.

Common faults
Knees caving in, heels lifting, rounding the back.

Progression / Regression
Easier: squat only a few inches. Harder: pause at the bottom for two breaths.

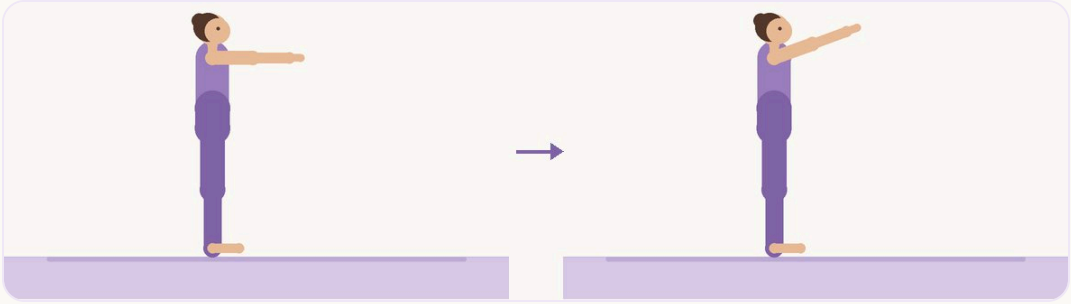
Cue
“Sit your hips back and press the floor away.”

Adaptation
Use a chair behind you for support; stay in a pain-free range with knee issues.

Band Pull-Apart

standing

Beginner | Band | V1-051



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand tall holding the band at shoulder width, arms straight in front at chest height.
2. Draw your ribs down and soften the knees.
3. Exhale and pull the band apart until it touches the chest.
4. Inhale and return with control.

Focus
Strengthens the upper back to counteract desk posture and rounded shoulders.

Target muscles
Rhomboids, middle trapezius, rear deltoids

Dosage
10–12 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare, exhale as you pull the band apart.

Common faults
Shrugging, arching the back, letting the arms drop below shoulder height.

Progression / Regression
Easier: lighter band, narrower grip. Harder: hold the end position for three breaths.

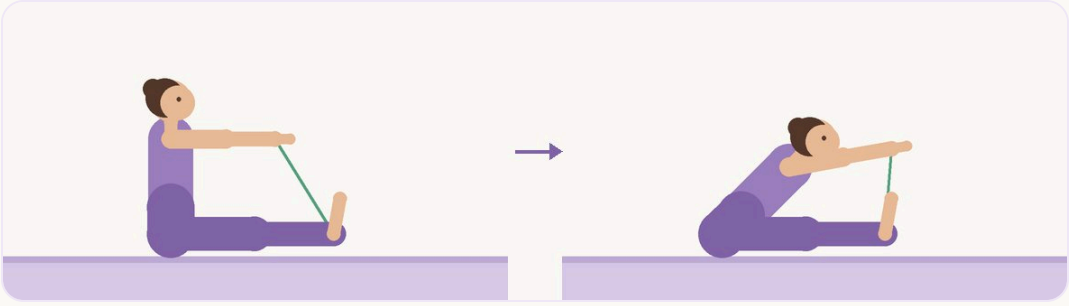
Cue
“Spread the band wide and keep your shoulders away from your ears.”

Adaptation
Keep the movement small and slow with shoulder injury; fine in all stages of pregnancy.

Seated Band Spine Twist

long sit

Beginner | Band | V1-052



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall with legs extended, band around the feet, ends in both hands.
2. Lift your arms to shoulder height with elbows soft.
3. Exhale and rotate your ribs to one side.
4. Inhale to return to center, then switch sides.

Focus
Teaches rotation through the spine while the pelvis stays steady and tall.

Target muscles
Obliques, spinal rotators, deep abdominals

Dosage
5 twists each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lengthen, exhale to twist, inhale to return to center.

Common faults
Collapsing the chest, twisting from the neck, rotating the hips.

Progression / Regression
Easier: sit on a cushion with bent knees. Harder: add small double pulses at the end.

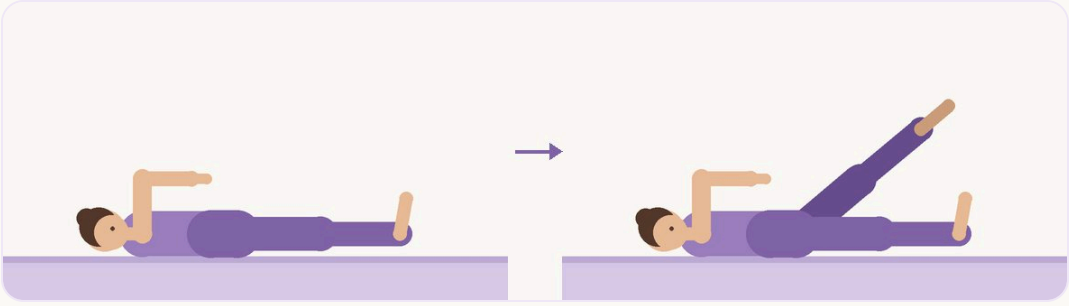
Cue
“Grow tall and rotate around the center of your spine.”

Adaptation
Keep the twist gentle in pregnancy and open the knees to avoid pressing the belly.

Lateral Band Walk

small side steps

Beginner | Band | V1-053



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand with feet hip-width and a band around the ankles or thighs.
2. Bend the knees slightly and keep the chest tall.
3. Step the right foot out to the side, keeping tension.
4. Bring the left foot in without letting the band go slack.

Focus
Strengthens the outer hips and improves balance while walking and climbing stairs.

Target muscles
Gluteus medius, gluteus minimus, quadriceps

Dosage
8 steps each direction · about 3 min

Breathing
Breathe naturally; exhale on each step.

Common faults
Leaning the torso, dragging the foot, letting the knees collapse inward.

Progression / Regression
Easier: place the band at the thighs. Harder: lower into a shallow squat while stepping.

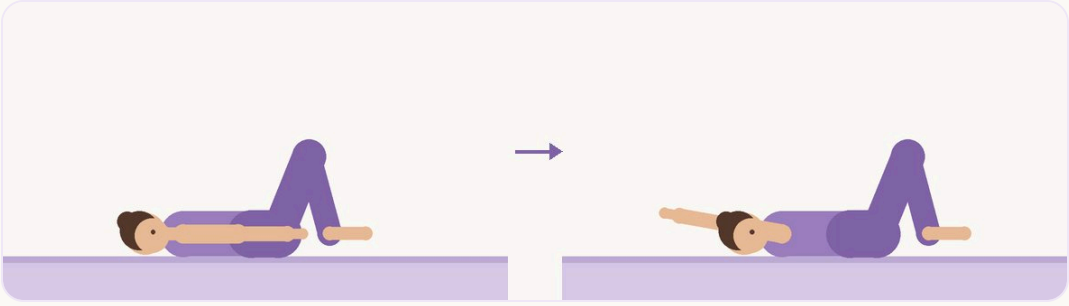
Cue
“Step wide and keep your toes pointing forward.”

Adaptation
Hold a wall or chair for balance; shorten the steps with hip or knee pain.

Band Rib Expansion Breathing

seated

Beginner | Band | V1-054



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall on a chair or the floor with a band wrapped around the lower ribs.
2. Hold the ends in front, with the band snug but not tight.
3. Inhale and expand the ribs sideways against the band.
4. Exhale and let the ribs soften closed.

Focus
Teaches lateral breathing into the ribs, the foundation of Pilates breath control.

Target muscles
Intercostals, diaphragm, transverse abdominis

Dosage
6–8 breaths · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to widen the ribs against the band, exhale to close them.

Common faults
Lifting the shoulders, breathing into the belly only, pulling the band too tight.

Progression / Regression
Easier: use your hands instead of a band. Harder: add a slow pelvic floor lift on each exhale.

Cue
“Breathe into the sides of your ribs and widen the band.”

Adaptation
Safe for everyone, including pregnancy; stay relaxed and stop if you feel light-headed.

VOLUME 1 · BEGINNER

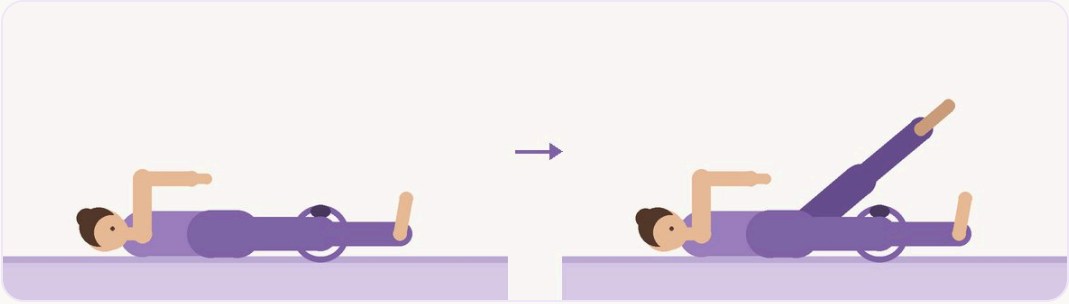
Magic Circle

14 exercises

Inner Thigh Squeeze

lying on the back

Beginner | Magic Circle | V1-055



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back, knees bent, feet flat, circle between the knees.
2. Soften your ribs and lengthen your neck.
3. Exhale and squeeze the circle without moving the pelvis.
4. Inhale and release halfway.

Focus
Awakens the inner thighs and pelvic floor to support the hips and low back.

Target muscles
Adductors, pelvic floor, deep abdominals

Dosage
12 squeezes · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare, exhale to squeeze the circle.

Common faults
Gripping with the glutes, tilting the pelvis, holding the breath.

Progression / Regression
Easier: squeeze gently at half effort. Harder: add a bridge hold.

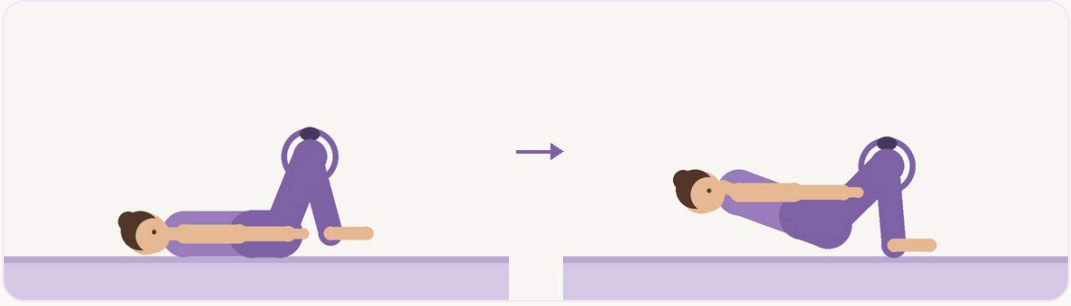
Cue
“Hug the circle with your inner thighs and keep your pelvis steady.”

Adaptation
After the first trimester, lie on a wedge or incline; avoid if there is pubic pain.

Pelvic Curl with Circle

bridge

Beginner | Magic Circle | V1-056



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back, knees bent, circle between the thighs.
2. Press your arms lightly into the floor.
3. Exhale and curl the tailbone up, then each vertebra.
4. Inhale to hold, then roll down slowly.

Focus
Teaches articulation of the spine and glute use while the thighs stay engaged.

Target muscles
Hamstrings, glutes, spinal extensors, adductors

Dosage
8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare, exhale to curl up, inhale to hold, exhale to roll down.

Common faults
Lifting too high, flaring the ribs, losing the thigh squeeze.

Progression / Regression
Easier: lift only the hips a few inches. Harder: hold the top and lift one heel.

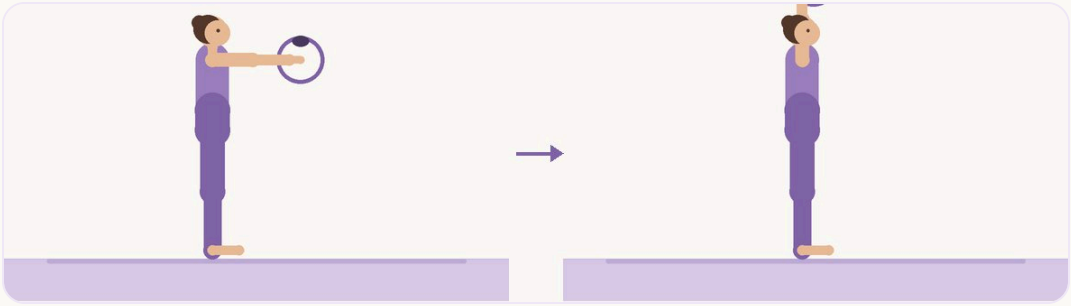
Cue
“Peel your spine off the mat one vertebra at a time.”

Adaptation
Skip after the first trimester or use a wedge; reduce range with disc injury.

Standing Palm Press

circle in front of chest

Beginner | Magic Circle | V1-057



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand tall, feet hip-width, circle held between the palms at chest height.
2. Keep elbows slightly lowered.
3. Exhale and press the palms together evenly.
4. Inhale and release halfway.

Focus
Builds chest and arm strength while the shoulders stay stable and relaxed.

Target muscles
Pectorals, anterior deltoids, serratus anterior

Dosage
10 presses · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare, exhale to press the palms into the circle.

Common faults
Lifting the shoulders, locking the elbows, leaning backward.

Progression / Regression
Easier: press gently. Harder: hold the squeeze for five seconds.

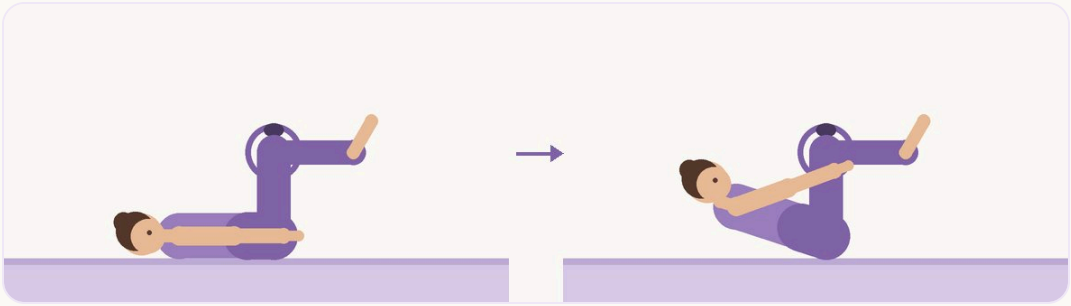
Cue
“Press into the circle and keep your shoulders down.”

Adaptation
Fine at any trimester; keep the effort light with shoulder discomfort.

Hundred Prep with Circle

knees bent

Beginner | Magic Circle | V1-058



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back, knees bent, feet on the floor, circle held in both hands.
2. Lift the head and shoulders slightly.
3. Pump the arms in small beats toward the thighs.
4. Lower down when your core fatigues.

Focus
Builds abdominal endurance and breath rhythm to prepare for the classical Hundred.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, transverse abdominis, obliques

Dosage
5 sets of 10 pumps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale for five pumps, exhale for five pumps.

Common faults
Straining the neck, flaring the ribs, locking the knees.

Progression / Regression
Easier: keep the head down. Harder: extend the legs to a higher diagonal.

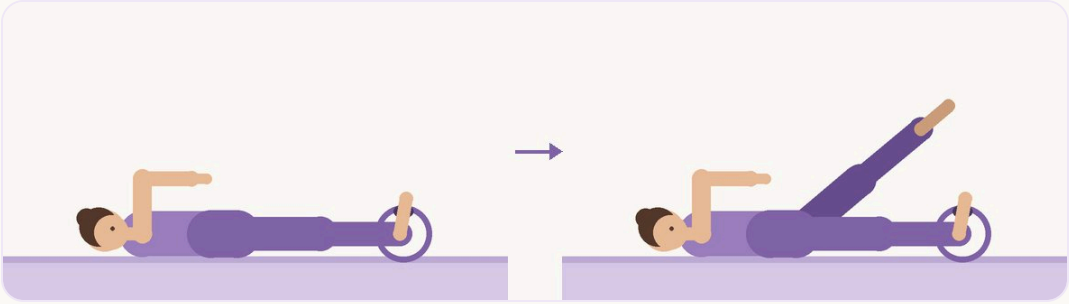
Cue
“Pump your arms and keep your belly scooped flat.”

Adaptation
Skip after the first trimester; keep the head supported with neck or low back strain.

Side-Lying Outer Thigh Press

circle at ankles

Beginner | Magic Circle | V1-059



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your side with legs together, circle between the ankles.
2. Stack the hips and draw the lower ribs in.
3. Exhale and lift the top leg against the resistance.
4. Inhale and lower with control.

Focus
Strengthens the outer hip to stabilize the pelvis during walking.

Target muscles
Gluteus medius, tensor fasciae latae

Dosage
12 reps each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare, exhale to lift the top leg.

Common faults
Rolling the pelvis back, lifting too high, bending the waist.

Progression / Regression
Easier: smaller lift. Harder: add small circles at the top.

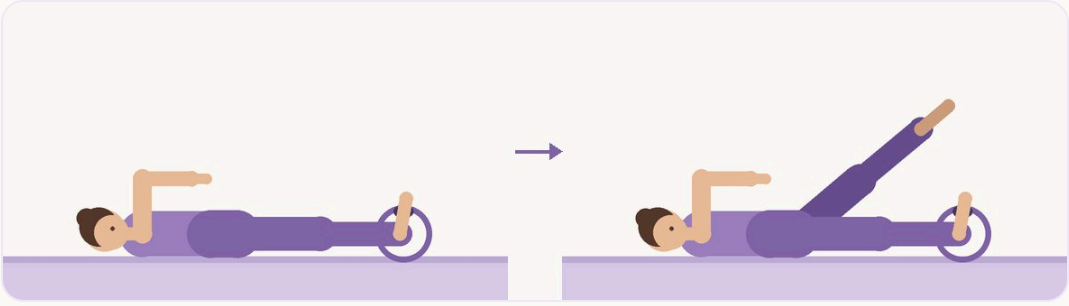
Cue
“Lift the top leg without letting your pelvis rock.”

Adaptation
Place a pillow under the head in pregnancy; lower the lift with hip pain.

Side-Lying Inner Thigh Lift

circle on the ankle

Beginner | Magic Circle | V1-060



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your side, top foot on the floor in front, circle around the bottom ankle.
2. Press the circle gently against the top leg.
3. Exhale and lift the bottom leg.
4. Inhale and lower slowly.

Focus
Strengthens the inner thigh and supports the pelvis and low back.

Target muscles
Adductors, deep hip stabilizers

Dosage
10 reps each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare, exhale to lift the lower leg.

Common faults
Rolling the hips forward, lifting too high, swinging the leg.

Progression / Regression
Easier: smaller lift. Harder: hold the top for three breaths.

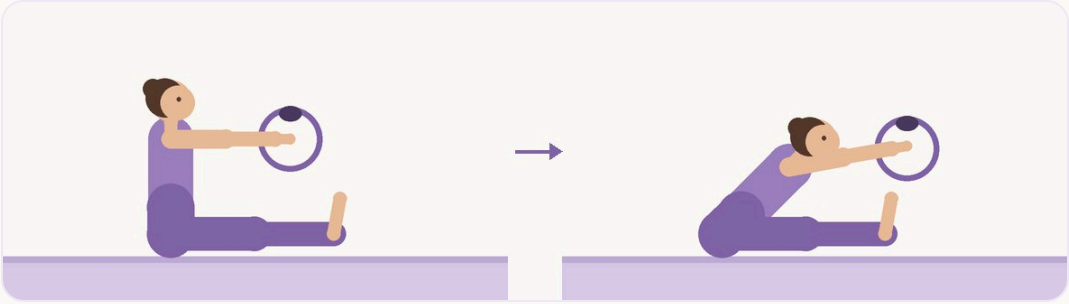
Cue
“Lift your bottom leg from the inner thigh and keep it long.”

Adaptation
Use a pillow for the head in pregnancy; reduce the range with groin sensitivity.

Seated Overhead Press

circle in hands

Beginner | Magic Circle | V1-061



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall on a chair or the floor, circle held at chest height.
2. Draw the lower ribs toward your hips.
3. Exhale and press the circle overhead.
4. Inhale and lower with control.

Focus
Strengthens the shoulders and teaches ribs-down posture while the arms reach overhead.

Target muscles
Deltoids, triceps, serratus anterior

Dosage
8–10 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare, exhale to press the circle overhead.

Common faults
Arching the low back, lifting the shoulders, locking the elbows.

Progression / Regression
Easier: press to forehead height. Harder: add a gentle side bend.

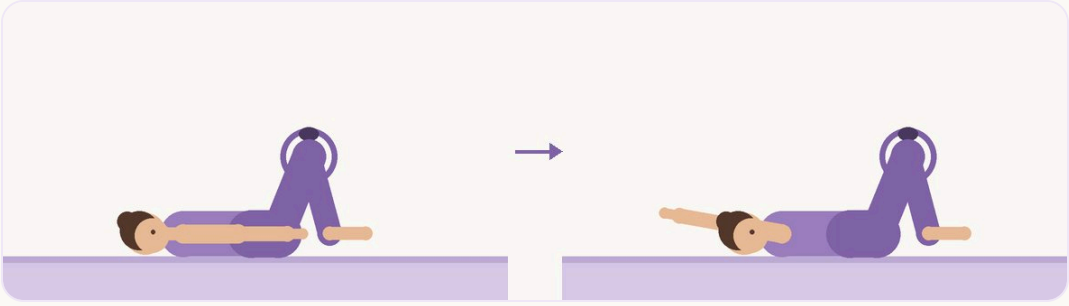
Cue
“Press overhead and keep your ribs gently drawn in.”

Adaptation
Fine at any trimester; stop short of full range with shoulder impingement.

Circle Chest Squeeze Breathing

seated

Beginner | Magic Circle | V1-062



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall, feet flat, circle held at chest height.
2. Inhale and let the ribs widen sideways.
3. Exhale and squeeze the circle with a light, even effort.
4. Inhale and release.

Focus
Links the breath with gentle upper-body activation to cue the deep core and ribs.

Target muscles
Pectorals, diaphragm, transverse abdominis

Dosage
8 breaths · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to widen the ribs, exhale to squeeze the circle.

Common faults
Lifting the shoulders, holding the breath, gripping the neck.

Progression / Regression
Easier: squeeze lightly. Harder: add a gentle pelvic floor lift on the exhale.

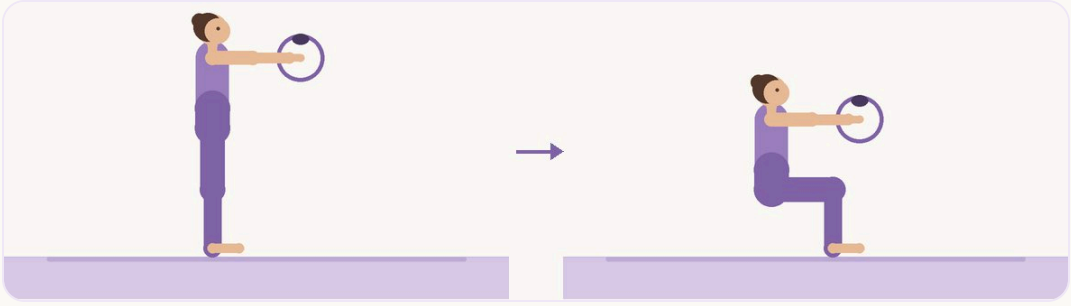
Cue
“Exhale and gently squeeze the circle while your ribs soften.”

Adaptation
Safe in pregnancy and for older adults; stay seated and relaxed.

Standing Circle Squat

circle between the knees

Beginner | Magic Circle | V1-063



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand with feet hip-width, circle between the lower thighs.
2. Lengthen your spine and soften the knees.
3. Inhale and bend the knees, hips back.
4. Exhale and press through the heels to stand.

Focus
Combines inner thigh work with a safe squat pattern for everyday lifting.

Target muscles
Quadriceps, adductors, glutes

Dosage
10 reps, 2 sets · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale as you lower, exhale as you stand.

Common faults
Knees caving in, heels lifting, leaning the torso forward.

Progression / Regression
Easier: squat to a half range. Harder: pause for two breaths at the bottom.

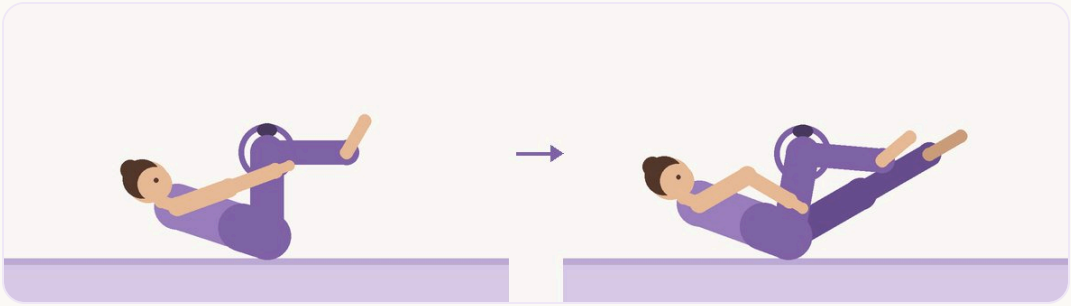
Cue
“Squeeze the circle and sit back as if reaching for a chair.”

Adaptation
Use a chair for support; limit depth with knee pain.

Single Leg Stretch Prep

tabletop

Beginner | Magic Circle | V1-064



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back in tabletop, circle held between the hands near the knees.
2. Lift the head and shoulders slightly.
3. Exhale and extend one leg diagonally.
4. Inhale and switch legs.

Focus
Builds abdominal stability and coordination between the arms and legs.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, transverse abdominis, hip flexors

Dosage
8 reps each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale for two counts, exhale for two counts.

Common faults
Straining the neck, rocking the pelvis, shooting the leg too low.

Progression / Regression
Easier: keep the head down. Harder: lift the head and extend the leg to a lower diagonal.

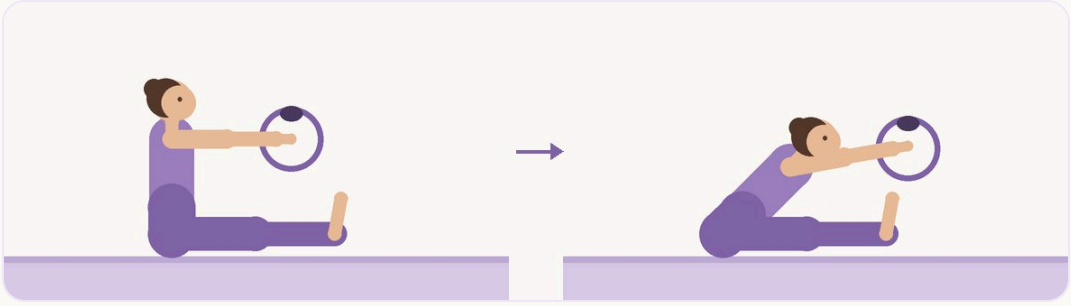
Cue
“Keep your belly flat as one leg reaches away.”

Adaptation
Skip after the first trimester; keep the head supported with neck or low back strain.

Seated Circle Spine Twist

circle at chest

Beginner | Magic Circle | V1-065



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall, legs crossed or extended, circle held at chest height.
2. Lengthen through the crown of your head.
3. Exhale and rotate the ribs to one side.
4. Inhale to center, then switch sides.

Focus
Teaches rotation through the mid-back while the hips stay anchored.

Target muscles
Obliques, spinal rotators, deep core

Dosage
5 twists each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lengthen, exhale to rotate.

Common faults
Collapsing the chest, twisting the neck, shifting the hips.

Progression / Regression
Easier: cross the legs and sit on a cushion. Harder: sit with legs extended.

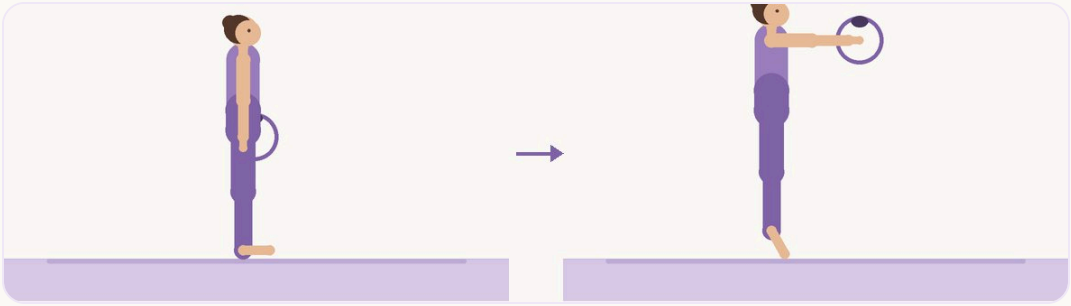
Cue
“Rotate from your ribs and keep your hips heavy.”

Adaptation
Keep the twist gentle in pregnancy and avoid forcing the range with disc issues.

Heel Raise Balance

circle held at chest

Beginner | Magic Circle | V1-066



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand tall with feet hip-width, circle held at chest height.
2. Gently squeeze the circle.
3. Exhale and rise onto the balls of your feet.
4. Inhale and lower slowly.

Focus
Improves ankle strength and balance, key for fall prevention in adults.

Target muscles
Calves, ankle stabilizers, deep core

Dosage
10 raises, 2 sets · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare, exhale as you rise onto the toes.

Common faults
Rolling onto the ankle edges, leaning forward, locking the knees.

Progression / Regression
Easier: hold a wall lightly. Harder: close your eyes or stand on one foot.

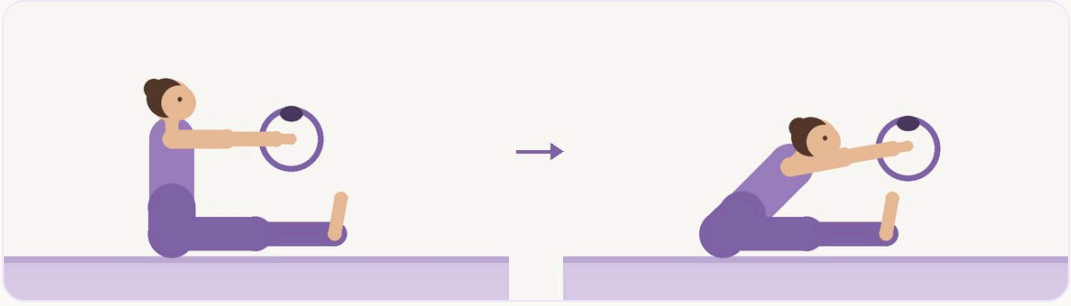
Cue
“Rise tall and keep your weight over the big toes.”

Adaptation
Stand beside a wall or chair; use support for balance issues or in pregnancy.

Circle Side Bend

standing

Beginner | Magic Circle | V1-067



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand tall, feet hip-width, circle held overhead.
2. Draw the lower ribs in and lengthen upward.
3. Exhale and bend to one side.
4. Inhale to return, then switch sides.

Focus
Opens the sides of the torso and ribs, easing tension after sitting or standing.

Target muscles
Obliques, quadratus lumborum, latissimus dorsi

Dosage
5 bends each side · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to lengthen, exhale to bend to the side.

Common faults
Leaning forward or back, collapsing the ribs, lifting the shoulders.

Progression / Regression
Easier: bend to a smaller range. Harder: hold the side bend for three breaths.

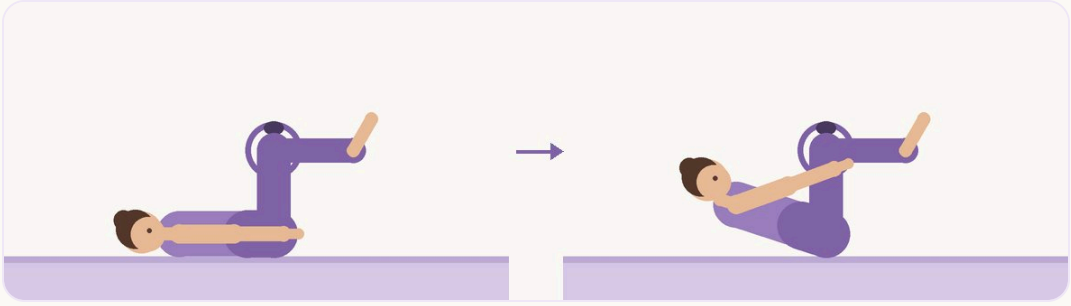
Cue
“Reach up and over without twisting your torso.”

Adaptation
Keep the bend gentle in pregnancy and stop short of discomfort with shoulder issues.

Tabletop Hold with Circle

knees at ninety degrees

Beginner | Magic Circle | V1-068



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back, circle between the knees.
2. Lift one leg at a time into tabletop.
3. Squeeze the circle gently and flatten your back.
4. Hold, then lower one foot at a time.

Focus
Trains the deep core to hold the pelvis steady while the legs are loaded.

Target muscles
Transverse abdominis, hip flexors, adductors

Dosage
3 holds of 5 breaths · about 3 min

Breathing
Breathe steadily; exhale deeply on each count.

Common faults
Arching the low back, gripping the thighs, letting the knees drift apart.

Progression / Regression
Easier: one foot at a time. Harder: lift the head and shoulders slightly.

Cue
“Hold your legs still and keep your lower back heavy.”

Adaptation
Skip after the first trimester; stop if the belly doming or back strain appears.

VOLUME 1 · BEGINNER

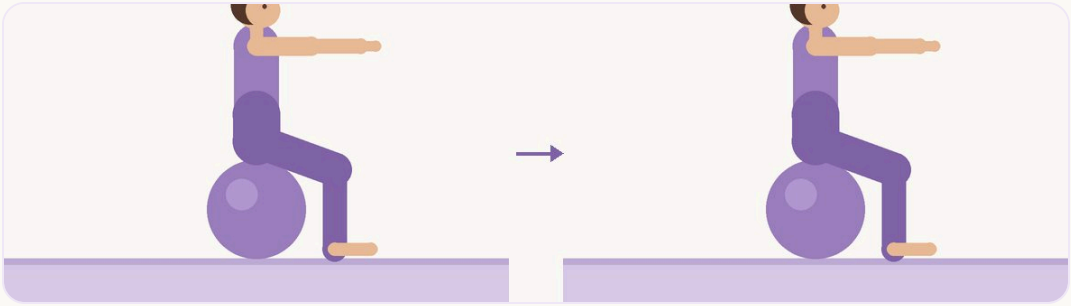
Stability Ball

16 exercises

Ball Pelvic Tilts

seated on the ball

Beginner | Stability Ball | V1-069



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall on the ball, feet flat, hands on your hips.
2. Inhale and tip the pelvis forward into a small arch.
3. Exhale and tuck the tailbone under.
4. Keep the shoulders still.

Focus
Warms up the low back and teaches pelvic mobility before any loaded work.

Target muscles
Deep abdominals, lumbar extensors, pelvic floor

Dosage
10 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to arch gently, exhale to tuck the pelvis.

Common faults
Moving the shoulders, rolling the ball, tilting too far.

Progression / Regression
Easier: smaller tilts. Harder: slow each tilt over four counts.

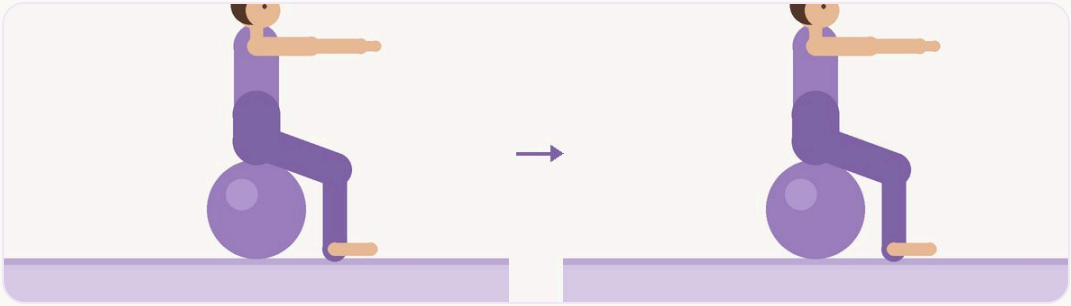
Cue
“Tuck your tailbone and feel your belly draw in.”

Adaptation
Safe in pregnancy; keep feet wide and use a wall for support if needed.

Ball Pelvic Circles

seated on the ball

Beginner | Stability Ball | V1-070



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall on the ball with feet wide.
2. Place your hands on your hips.
3. Move the pelvis in a slow circle.
4. Reverse direction after six.

Focus
Mobilizes the hips and lumbar spine and builds awareness of the pelvis in space.

Target muscles
Deep core, hip stabilizers, lumbar muscles

Dosage
6 circles each direction · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale on the first half of the circle, exhale on the second.

Common faults
Leaning the torso, making circles too big, holding the breath.

Progression / Regression
Easier: smaller circles. Harder: lift the heels slightly.

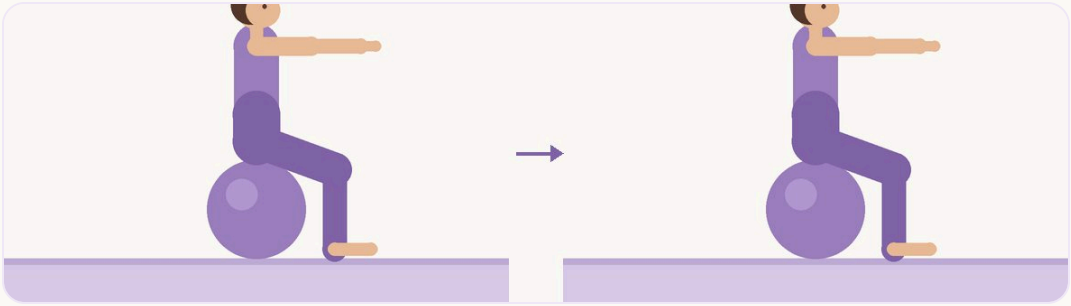
Cue
“Draw a smooth circle with your pelvis and keep your chest tall.”

Adaptation
Safe in pregnancy; widen the stance for balance.

Seated Ball March

alternating knee lifts

Beginner | Stability Ball | V1-071



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall on the ball, feet flat, hands on hips.
2. Draw your belly in and keep the pelvis level.
3. Exhale and lift one foot a few inches.
4. Inhale and lower, then alternate.

Focus
Challenges balance and pelvic stability while strengthening the hip flexors.

Target muscles
Hip flexors, transverse abdominis, obliques

Dosage
10 marches each side · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare, exhale to lift one knee.

Common faults
Leaning to the side, rocking the ball, lifting the shoulders.

Progression / Regression
Easier: lift the heel only. Harder: pause for two breaths at the top.

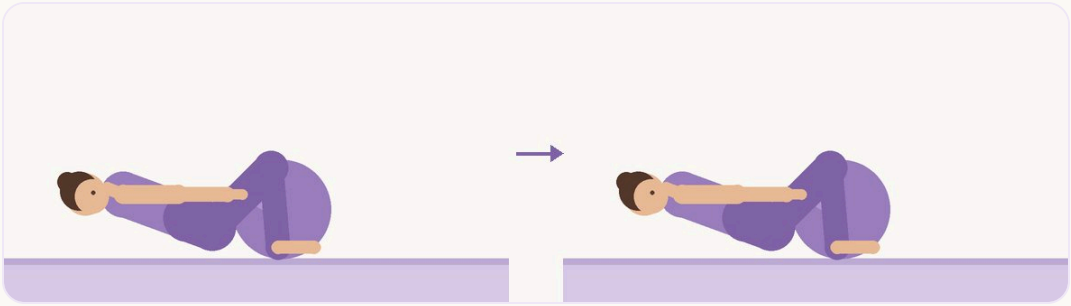
Cue
“Stay tall as one knee floats up.”

Adaptation
Sit near a wall in pregnancy or for balance issues.

Ball Bridge

feet on the ball

Beginner | Stability Ball | V1-072



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back, heels on the ball, knees bent.
2. Press your arms lightly into the floor.
3. Exhale and lift the hips into a bridge.
4. Inhale and lower slowly.

Focus
Strengthens the glutes and hamstrings while the unstable surface challenges core control.

Target muscles
Glutes, hamstrings, deep core

Dosage
8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare, exhale to lift the hips.

Common faults
Letting the ball roll away, arching the back, pushing with the toes.

Progression / Regression
Easier: rest calves on the ball. Harder: lift one leg at the top.

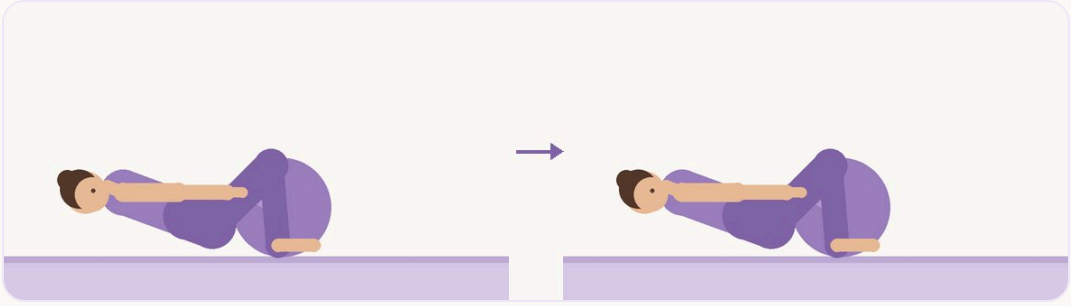
Cue
“Press your heels into the ball and lift your hips.”

Adaptation
Skip after the first trimester or use a wedge; keep the lift small with back sensitivity.

Ball Hamstring Curl

hips lifted

Beginner | Stability Ball | V1-073



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back with heels on the ball and hips lifted.
2. Press arms into the floor.
3. Exhale and bend the knees, rolling the ball toward you.
4. Inhale and extend the legs out.

Focus
Strengthens the hamstrings and glutes and challenges stability under motion.

Target muscles
Hamstrings, glutes, deep core

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to extend the legs, exhale to curl the ball in.

Common faults
Dropping the hips, rushing the roll, arching the back.

Progression / Regression
Easier: keep the hips on the floor. Harder: use one leg at a time.

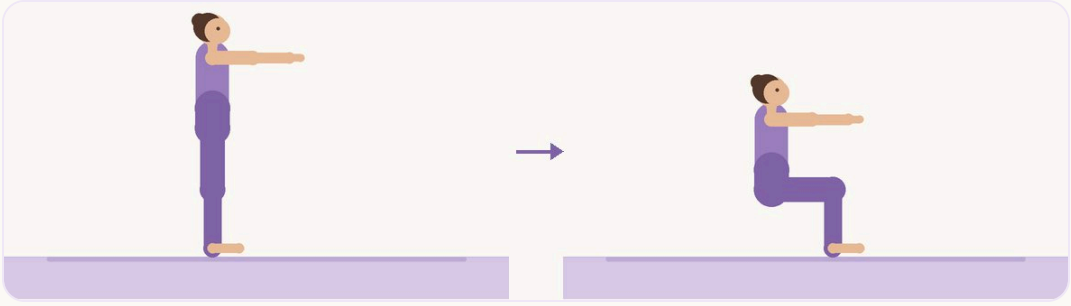
Cue
“Keep your hips lifted and roll the ball in.”

Adaptation
Skip after the first trimester; keep range small with hamstring strain.

Wall Squat with Ball

ball behind the back

Beginner | Stability Ball | V1-074



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand with the ball between your low back and the wall, feet forward.
2. Hip-width stance, knees soft.
3. Inhale and bend the knees, rolling the ball down.
4. Exhale and press through the heels to rise.

Focus
Teaches a safe squat pattern with the ball supporting the low back.

Target muscles
Quadriceps, glutes, hamstrings

Dosage
10 reps, 2 sets · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale as you lower, exhale as you rise.

Common faults
Knees past toes, heels lifting, leaning forward.

Progression / Regression
Easier: squat to a shallow depth. Harder: pause for three breaths at the bottom.

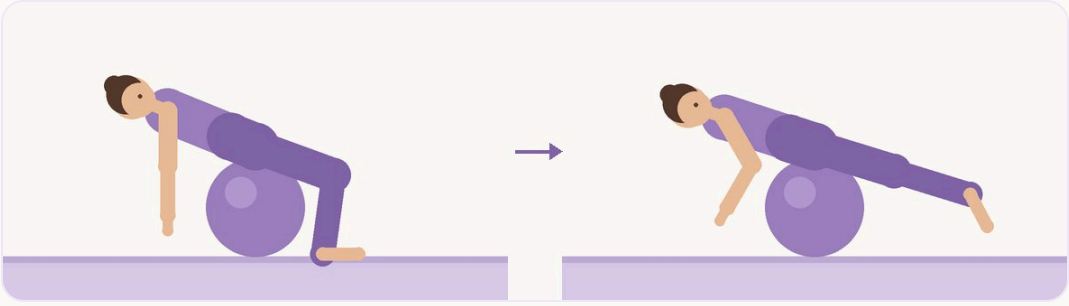
Cue
“Sit down the wall like you are lowering into a chair.”

Adaptation
Safe in pregnancy; limit depth with knee pain.

Ball Roll-Out

kneeling

Beginner | Stability Ball | V1-075



HOW TO DO IT

1. Kneel with forearms on the ball.
2. Tuck the tailbone and lift your belly.
3. Inhale and roll the forearms forward.
4. Exhale and draw back by pulling the ribs in.

Focus
Builds anterior core strength and shoulder stability in a supported way.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, transverse abdominis, shoulders, lats

Dosage
6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to roll out, exhale to roll back.

Common faults
Sagging the low back, shrugging, rolling too far.

Progression / Regression
Easier: roll out a small distance. Harder: extend the range toward the full arms-forward line.

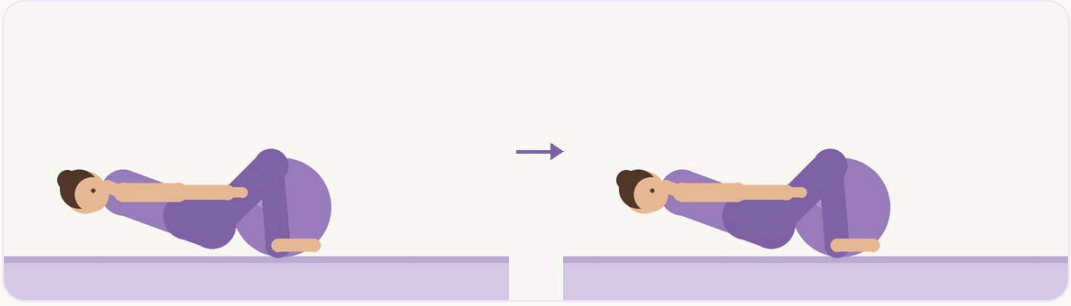
Cue
“Roll out in one long line and keep your belly lifted.”

Adaptation
Skip in pregnancy; reduce range with shoulder or lumbar issues.

Ball Curl-Up

lying over the ball

Beginner | Stability Ball | V1-076



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit on the ball and walk your feet forward until your low back is supported.
2. Hands behind the head, elbows wide.
3. Exhale and curl up, lifting the head and shoulders.
4. Inhale and lower over the ball.

Focus
Builds abdominal strength through a larger range of motion with spinal support.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, obliques, deep core

Dosage
8–10 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lengthen back over the ball, exhale to curl up.

Common faults
Pulling on the neck, rushing, letting the ball roll.

Progression / Regression
Easier: arms across the chest, smaller range. Harder: hold the top for two breaths.

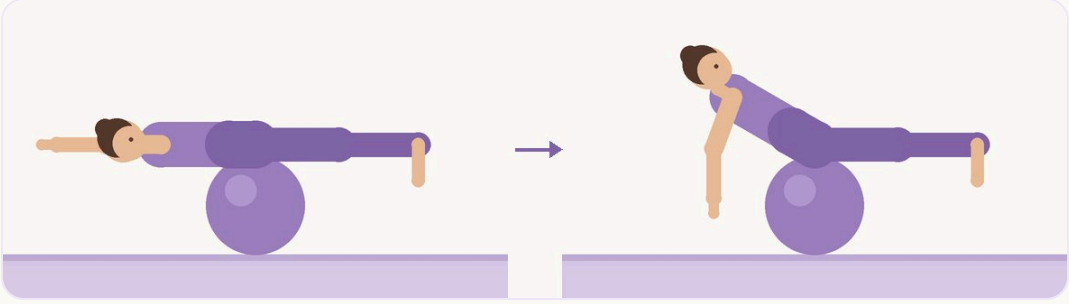
Cue
“Curl your ribs toward your hips and keep your chin soft.”

Adaptation
Skip after the first trimester; reduce the range with low back pain.

Ball Back Extension

over the ball

Beginner | Stability Ball | V1-077



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie face down over the ball with legs extended and toes on the floor.
2. Hands behind the head, forehead neutral.
3. Exhale and lift the chest slightly.
4. Inhale and lower with control.

Focus
Strengthens the back extensors to support upright posture throughout the day.

Target muscles
Erector spinae, glutes, hamstrings

Dosage
8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare, exhale to lift the chest.

Common faults
Lifting too high, straining the neck, gripping the glutes.

Progression / Regression
Easier: lift only slightly. Harder: arms by the ears.

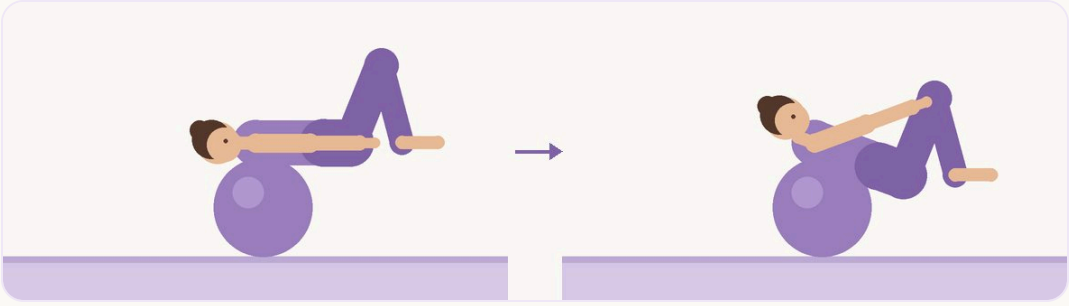
Cue
“Lengthen forward through your crown as you lift.”

Adaptation
Avoid in pregnancy; use a smaller lift with osteoporosis or lumbar disc injury.

Ball Side Stretch

kneeling

Beginner | Stability Ball | V1-078



HOW TO DO IT

1. Kneel beside the ball with one hip against it.
2. Drape your torso sideways over the ball.
3. Reach the top arm overhead and long.
4. Hold, then switch sides.

Focus
Lengthens the lateral trunk and shoulder, relieving side-body tension.

Target muscles
Obliques, latissimus dorsi, quadratus lumborum

Dosage
30 sec each side · about 2 min

Breathing
Breathe into the stretched ribs; slow, steady breaths.

Common faults
Rolling forward or back, shrugging, collapsing the hips.

Progression / Regression
Easier: lean over the ball gently. Harder: reach farther with the top arm.

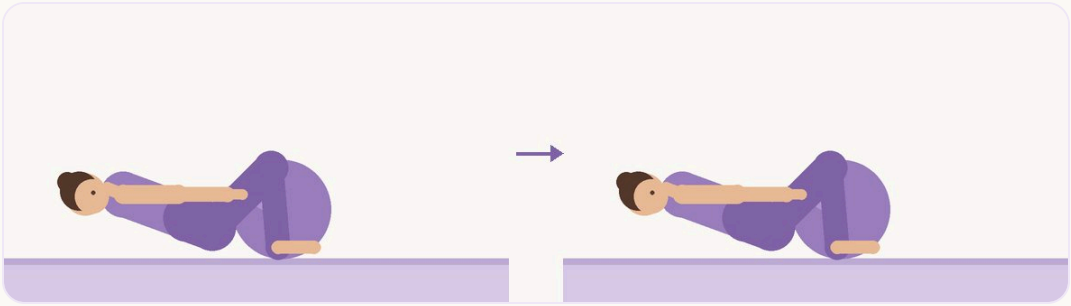
Cue
“Breathe into the side of your ribs and reach away.”

Adaptation
Use a gentle range in pregnancy; avoid forcing the stretch with shoulder pain.

Ball Hundred Prep

feet on the floor

Beginner | Stability Ball | V1-079



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit on the ball, walk forward until your low back is supported.
2. Hands reaching forward.
3. Lift the head and shoulders slightly.
4. Pump arms in short beats.

Focus
Builds abdominal endurance and breath control with support under the back.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, transverse abdominis

Dosage
5 sets of 10 pumps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale for five pumps, exhale for five pumps.

Common faults
Straining the neck, flaring the ribs, rolling the ball.

Progression / Regression
Easier: keep the head down. Harder: lift one foot at a time.

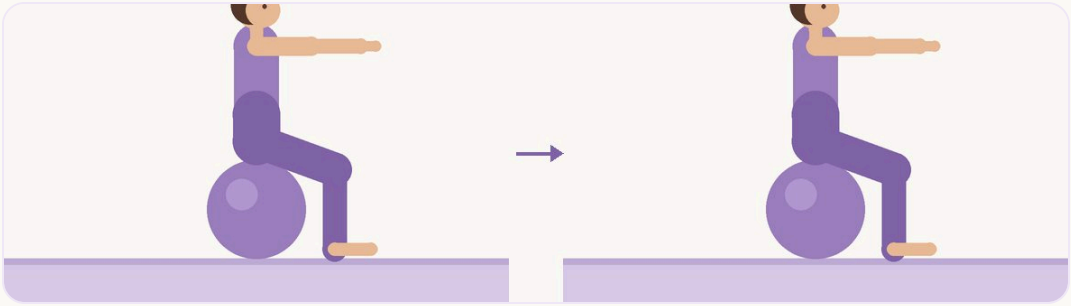
Cue
“Pump your arms and keep your belly flat.”

Adaptation
Skip after the first trimester; support the head with neck sensitivity.

Seated Ball Inner Thigh Squeeze

ball between the knees

Beginner | Stability Ball | V1-080



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall on a chair with a small ball between the knees.
2. Feet flat, hands resting on the thighs.
3. Exhale and squeeze the ball.
4. Inhale and release halfway.

Focus
Activates the inner thighs and pelvic floor while the spine stays tall.

Target muscles
Adductors, pelvic floor, deep abdominals

Dosage
12 squeezes · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare, exhale to squeeze.

Common faults
Gripping with the glutes, rounding the back, holding the breath.

Progression / Regression
Easier: squeeze lightly. Harder: lift the heels during the squeeze.

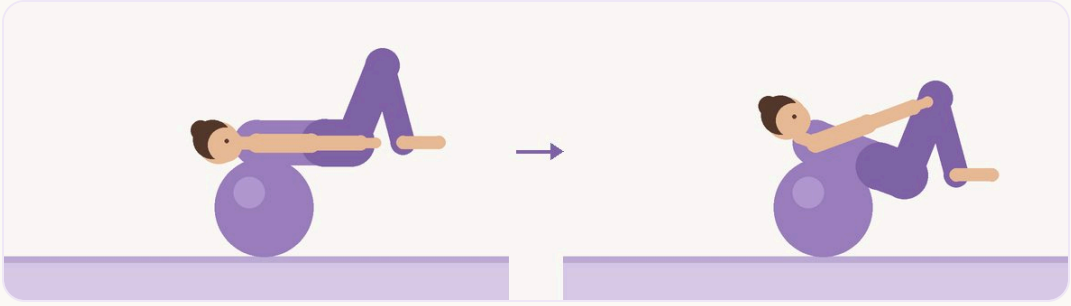
Cue
“Hug the ball with your inner thighs and keep your spine long.”

Adaptation
Safe in pregnancy; use a smaller ball if the hips feel strained.

Ball Chest Opener

lying over the ball

Beginner | Stability Ball | V1-081



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit on the ball and walk forward until the upper back rests on the ball.
2. Let the head relax over the ball.
3. Open the arms wide.
4. Hold and breathe.

Focus
Opens the chest and front shoulders to counteract rounded posture.

Target muscles
Pectorals, anterior deltoids, thoracic extensors

Dosage
30–45 sec hold · about 2 min

Breathing
Breathe slowly into the chest and let the arms relax.

Common faults
Arching the low back, forcing the arms too low, tensing the neck.

Progression / Regression
Easier: keep the arms low. Harder: reach arms overhead.

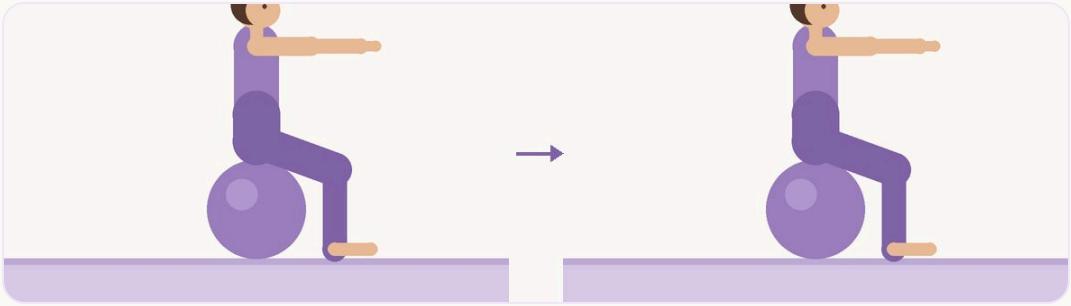
Cue
“Let your chest open as your arms float wide.”

Adaptation
Skip after the first trimester; avoid if there is shoulder instability.

Seated Ball Spine Twist

on the ball

Beginner | Stability Ball | V1-082



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall on the ball, feet wide, arms crossed over the chest.
2. Draw the belly in.
3. Exhale and rotate the ribs to one side.
4. Inhale to center, then switch.

Focus
Teaches rotation through the spine while the pelvis stays stable on the ball.

Target muscles
Obliques, spinal rotators, deep core

Dosage
5 twists each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lengthen, exhale to rotate.

Common faults
Collapsing the chest, twisting the head only, rolling the ball.

Progression / Regression
Easier: use smaller rotations. Harder: lift one foot.

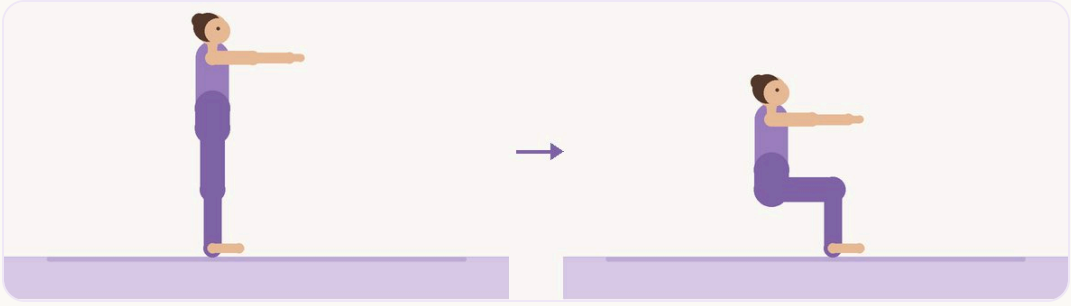
Cue
“Rotate your ribs and keep your hips level.”

Adaptation
Keep the twist gentle in pregnancy; widen the knees for comfort.

Ball Wall Push-Up

ball against the wall

Beginner | Stability Ball | V1-083



HOW TO DO IT

1. Place the ball against the wall and hands on the ball.
2. Step back into a slight plank angle.
3. Inhale and bend the elbows.
4. Exhale and press back.

Focus
Introduces push-up strength with the ball supporting the body at an incline.

Target muscles
Pectorals, triceps, serratus anterior

Dosage
8–10 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to lower, exhale to press away.

Common faults
Sagging the hips, flaring the elbows, shrugging.

Progression / Regression
Easier: stand closer to the wall. Harder: step the feet back farther.

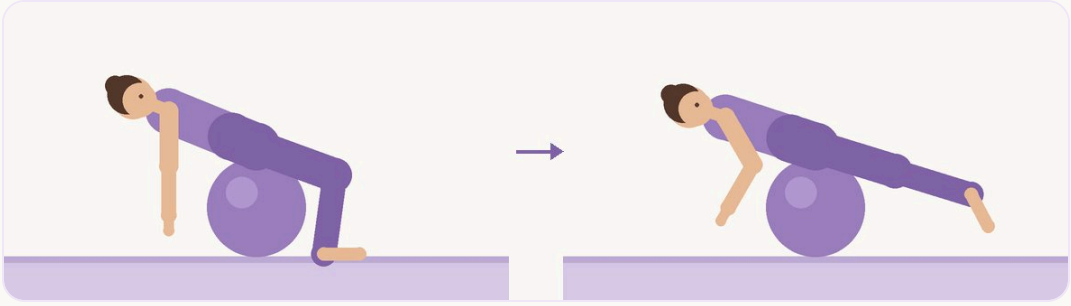
Cue
“Keep your body in one long line as you press.”

Adaptation
Safe in pregnancy; reduce range with shoulder pain.

Ball Child's Pose

rolling forward

Beginner | Stability Ball | V1-084



HOW TO DO IT

1. Kneel facing the ball with hands resting on it.
2. Sit the hips back toward your heels.
3. Roll the ball forward and lengthen your arms.
4. Hold and breathe.

Focus
Releases the back, shoulders, and hips at the end of class.

Target muscles
Latissimus dorsi, spinal extensors, hips

Dosage
30–60 sec hold · about 2 min

Breathing
Breathe slowly into the back of your ribs.

Common faults
Forcing the hips down, tensing the shoulders, holding the breath.

Progression / Regression
Easier: place a pillow under the knees. Harder: roll the ball a bit farther.

Cue
“Let your back soften as you breathe into your ribs.”

Adaptation
Open the knees wide in pregnancy; avoid deep knee flexion with knee pain.

VOLUME 1 · BEGINNER

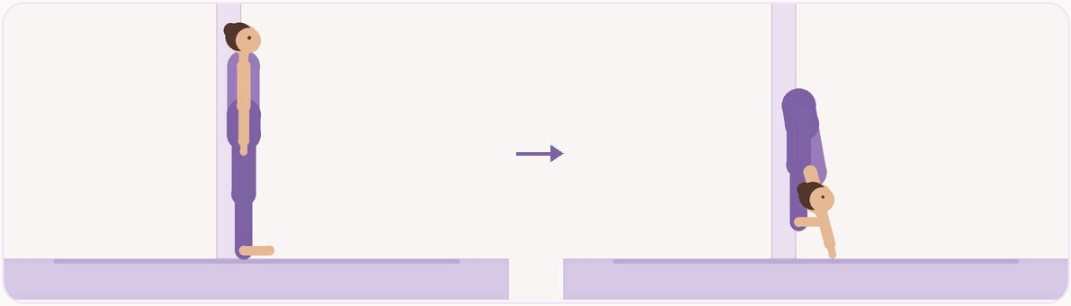
Wall

14 exercises

Wall Roll Down

back to the wall

Beginner | Wall | V1-085



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand with heels about 12 inches from the wall, back against it.
2. Nod the chin and slowly peel head, then shoulders away.
3. Roll down through the spine, arms hanging heavy.
4. Pause, then stack up bone by bone to finish.

Focus
Teaches articulating the spine one vertebra at a time, using the wall as feedback for control.

Target muscles
Abdominals, spinal flexors, hamstrings

Dosage
6 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare; exhale as you peel away and roll down.

Common faults
Leaning back on the wall, dropping the head first, locking the knees.

Progression / Regression
Easier: smaller range, knees softer. Harder: add arm reach or a slower tempo.

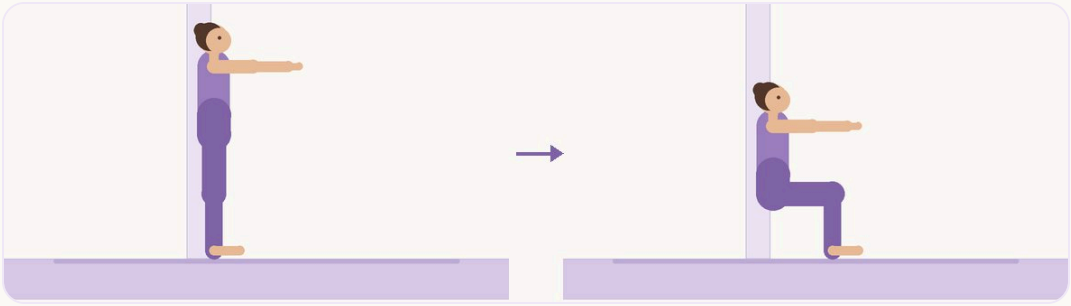
Cue
“Peel your spine off the wall one bone at a time.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: keep a wide stance. Lower back pain: stop at mid-range and avoid bouncing.

Wall Squat

back supported

Beginner | Wall | V1-086



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand with back to the wall, feet hip-width, a step away.
2. Slide down until knees reach about 90 degrees or less.
3. Keep ribs stacked over pelvis.
4. Press through the heels to slide back up.

Focus
Builds leg endurance and hip alignment with the back supported by the wall.

Target muscles
Quadriceps, glutes, hamstrings

Dosage
8–10 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale as you lower; exhale as you press up.

Common faults
Knees caving in, feet too close to the wall, heels lifting.

Progression / Regression
Easier: shallower depth. Harder: hold the bottom 5 seconds or lift the arms.

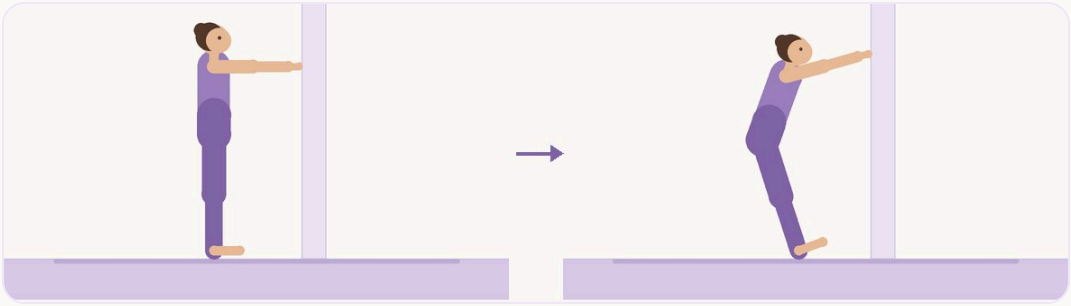
Cue
“Press through your heels and keep knees over your second toes.”

Adaptation
Knee pain: limit depth to a pain-free range. Pregnancy: widen the stance.

Wall Push-Up

standing at an incline

Beginner | Wall | V1-087



HOW TO DO IT

1. Face the wall, hands at shoulder height and slightly wider than shoulders.
2. Step back until the body is on a slight incline.
3. Bend elbows toward the ribs, bringing the chest to the wall.
4. Press away, spreading the shoulder blades.

Focus
Introduces the push-up pattern with scapular control at a low load.

Target muscles
Chest, triceps, serratus anterior, core

Dosage
8–10 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale as you bend the elbows; exhale as you press away.

Common faults
Sagging hips, flared elbows, shoulders shrugging to the ears.

Progression / Regression
Easier: stand closer. Harder: step the feet farther back or lift one heel.

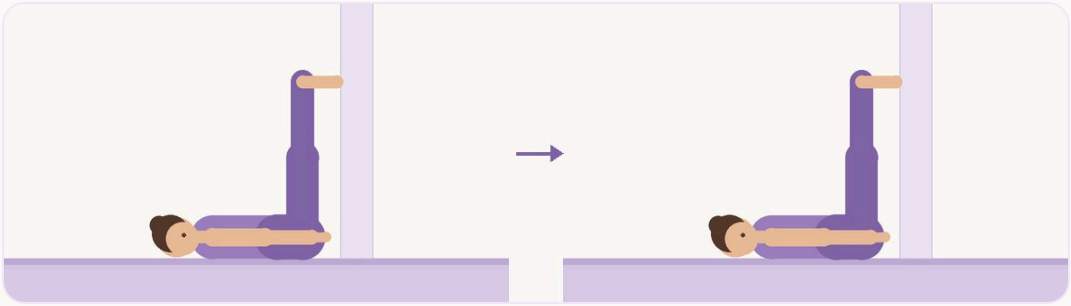
Cue
“Keep one long line from head to heels.”

Adaptation
Shoulder issues: reduce range and keep elbows close. Pregnancy: a good alternative to the floor.

Wall Bridge

feet on the wall

Beginner | Wall | V1-088



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back, feet hip-width on the wall, knees about 90 degrees.
2. Exhale, tilt the pelvis and peel the spine upward.
3. Hold briefly with knees over the ankles.
4. Roll down slowly, tailbone last.

Focus
Teaches pelvic curl mechanics and glute activation with the feet anchored on the wall.

Target muscles
Glutes, hamstrings, abdominals

Dosage
8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare; exhale to lift and roll down.

Common faults
Overarching the lower back, pushing through the toes, knees splaying.

Progression / Regression
Easier: lift only a few inches. Harder: march one foot off the wall.

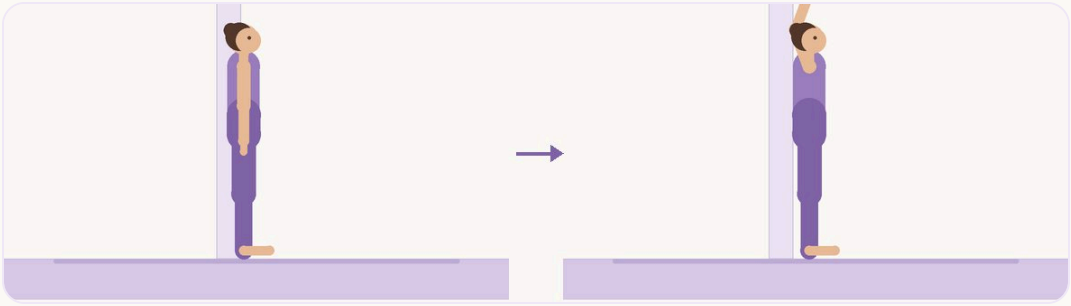
Cue
“Roll up one vertebra at a time, lengthening your knees away.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: skip after the first trimester if lying flat is uncomfortable. Lower back pain: smaller lift.

Wall Slide

arms like a goalpost

Beginner | Wall | V1-089



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand with back, head and elbows against the wall.
2. Bend the elbows to 90 degrees, backs of hands to the wall.
3. Slide the arms overhead as far as comfortable.
4. Lower with control, keeping the ribs down.

Focus
Improves shoulder mobility and scapular control while the back stays in contact with the wall.

Target muscles
Lower trapezius, serratus anterior, deltoids

Dosage
8–10 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale as the arms slide up; inhale as they lower.

Common faults
Ribs flaring, lower back arching off the wall, shrugging.

Progression / Regression
Easier: smaller range. Harder: add a light band or slow the tempo.

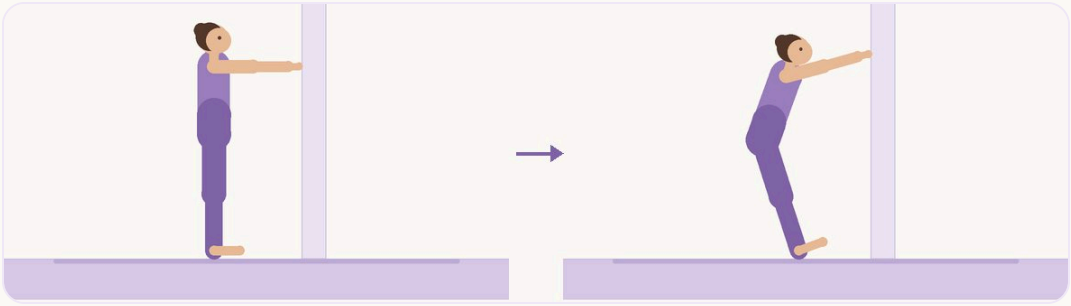
Cue
“Slide your arms up while your ribs stay soft.”

Adaptation
Shoulder injury: stay below the point of pinching. Older adults: use a chair nearby for balance.

Wall Plank

forearms on the wall

Beginner | Wall | V1-090



HOW TO DO IT

1. Face the wall, forearms against it at shoulder height.
2. Walk the feet back into a slanted line.
3. Draw the navel in and press the forearms into the wall.
4. Hold, then walk the feet in.

Focus
Builds trunk stability in a supported plank, ideal before moving to the floor.

Target muscles
Deep abdominals, shoulders, glutes

Dosage
20–30 sec hold · about 2 min

Breathing
Breathe steadily; exhale to deepen the abs.

Common faults
Hips piking back, neck tension, collapsing into the shoulders.

Progression / Regression
Easier: stand closer. Harder: step farther back or lift one heel.

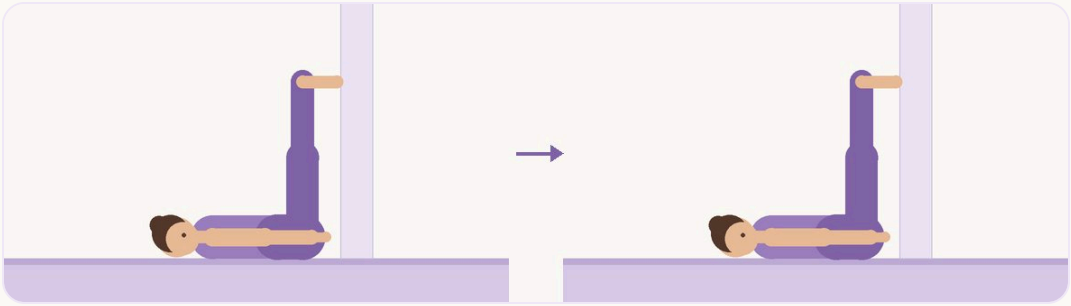
Cue
“Press the wall away and lengthen from head to heels.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: a gentle plank option. Shoulder pain: use open palms instead of forearms.

Wall Footwork

lying, feet on the wall

Beginner | Wall | V1-091



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back with feet on the wall, hip-width apart, knees bent.
2. Press the legs to straighten without locking.
3. Bend back slowly with the pelvis neutral.
4. Repeat with heels together and then on the balls of the feet.

Focus
Reformer-style footwork pattern that trains leg alignment and pelvic stability without equipment.

Target muscles
Quadriceps, hamstrings, calves, core

Dosage
10 reps per position · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to bend; exhale to extend.

Common faults
Tucking the pelvis, locking the knees, feet sliding.

Progression / Regression
Easier: shorter range. Harder: add a small pelvic lift hold.

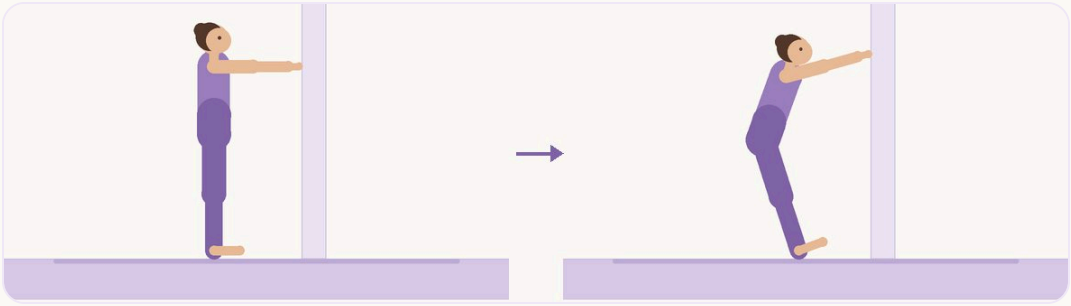
Cue
“Press away and keep your pelvis heavy and still.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: use a wedge or incline. Knee pain: bend only to a comfortable angle.

Wall Side Leg Lift

fingertips on the wall

Beginner | Wall | V1-092



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand side-on to the wall, fingertips touching it.
2. Shift weight into the inside leg, pelvis level.
3. Lift the outside leg to hip height with a flexed foot.
4. Lower slowly without leaning.

Focus
Trains hip abduction and lateral stability while the wall supports balance.

Target muscles
Gluteus medius, hip abductors, obliques

Dosage
10 reps each side · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale as the leg lifts; inhale as it lowers.

Common faults
Leaning away from the wall, hiking the hip, lifting too high.

Progression / Regression
Easier: hand flat on the wall. Harder: add a small pulse at the top.

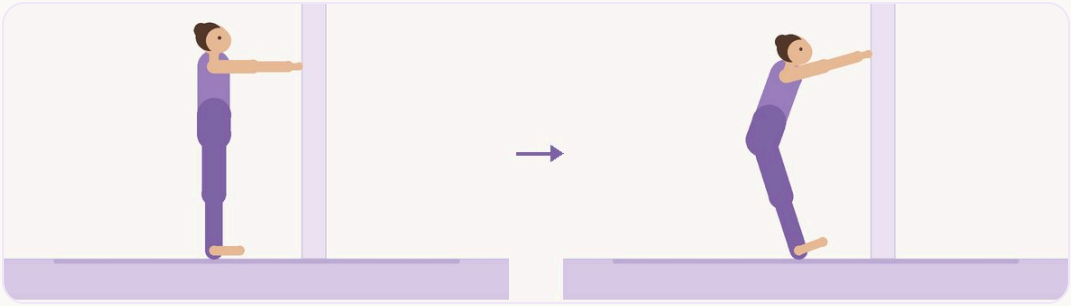
Cue
“Lift from the side of your hip, not your back.”

Adaptation
Hip or knee pain: keep the lift small. Older adults: hold the wall with one hand.

Wall Calf Raise

hands on the wall

Beginner | Wall | V1-093



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand facing the wall, hands lightly on it.
2. Feet parallel, hip-width.
3. Lift both heels as high as possible.
4. Lower with control through the ankles.

Focus
Strengthens the ankle and foot, improving balance and the foundation for footwork.

Target muscles
Gastrocnemius, soleus, foot intrinsics

Dosage
12 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale up; inhale down.

Common faults
Rolling onto the outer edges of the feet, locking the knees.

Progression / Regression
Easier: slow down, lighter hand pressure. Harder: single leg or add a pause.

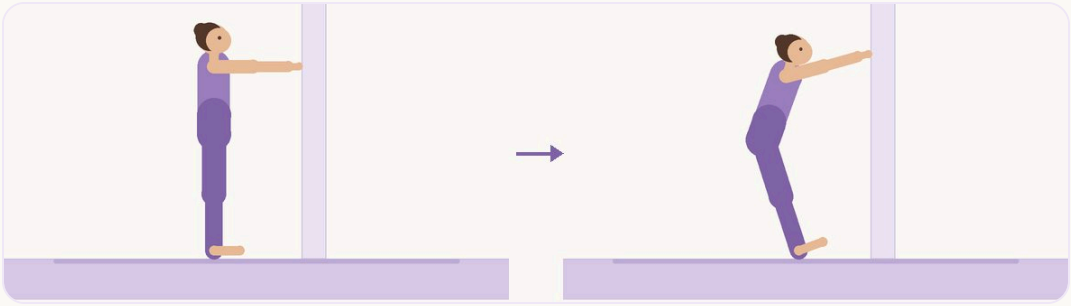
Cue
“Rise tall through the crown of your head.”

Adaptation
Ankle injury: reduce range. Older adults: keep both hands on the wall.

Wall Chest Stretch

forearm on the wall

Beginner | Wall | V1-094



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand beside the wall, forearm resting on it, elbow at shoulder height.
2. Step the feet forward slightly.
3. Gently rotate the torso away from the arm.
4. Hold, breathing evenly, then switch.

Focus
Opens the pectorals and front of the shoulder, common tight areas for desk workers.

Target muscles
Pectorals, anterior deltoid, biceps

Dosage
30 sec each side · about 1 min

Breathing
Inhale to lengthen; exhale to deepen gently.

Common faults
Twisting too far, rounding the lower back, forcing the stretch.

Progression / Regression
Easier: lower the arm. Harder: place the arm slightly higher.

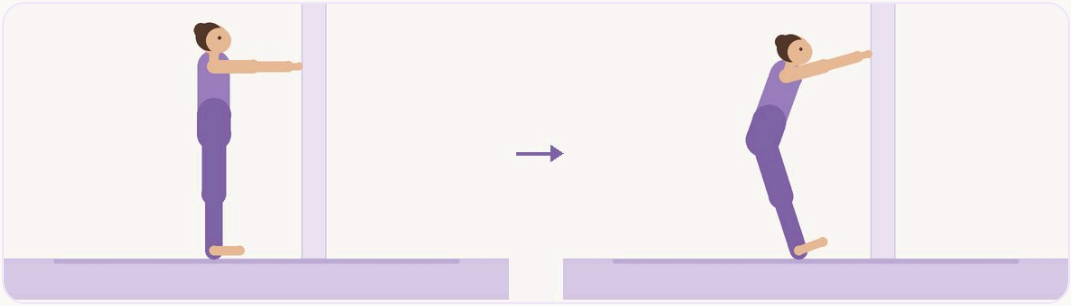
Cue
“Soften your chest and let your shoulder melt.”

Adaptation
Shoulder injury: do not force the end range. Pregnancy: safe and helpful.

Wall Single Leg Balance

fingertip support

Beginner | Wall | V1-095



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand beside the wall with one hand on it.
2. Shift weight onto the inside foot.
3. Lift the other knee to hip height.
4. Hold the balance, then switch.

Focus
Improves proprioception and the ability to center the pelvis on one leg.

Target muscles
Gluteus medius, deep hip stabilizers, core

Dosage
20 sec each side · about 2 min

Breathing
Breathe naturally; avoid holding the breath.

Common faults
Hiking the hip, locking the standing knee, gripping the wall.

Progression / Regression
Easier: toes touching the floor. Harder: lift arms or close the eyes.

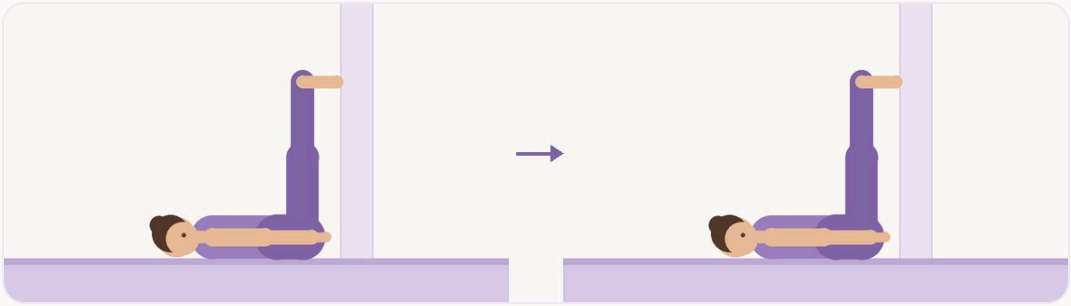
Cue
“Grow tall and keep your hips level.”

Adaptation
Older adults: keep both hands on the wall. Ankle injury: shorten the hold.

Wall Hundred Prep

legs up the wall

Beginner | Wall | V1-096



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back, legs resting on the wall at 90 degrees.
2. Arms by the sides, palms down.
3. Pump the arms in small beats.
4. Maintain a neutral pelvis.

Focus
Teaches the Hundred breath pattern with the pelvis and spine supported.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, transverse abdominis

Dosage
5 breath cycles · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale for 5 pumps; exhale for 5 pumps.

Common faults
Neck strain, ribs flaring, arms pumping too high.

Progression / Regression
Easier: head down. Harder: lift head and shoulders.

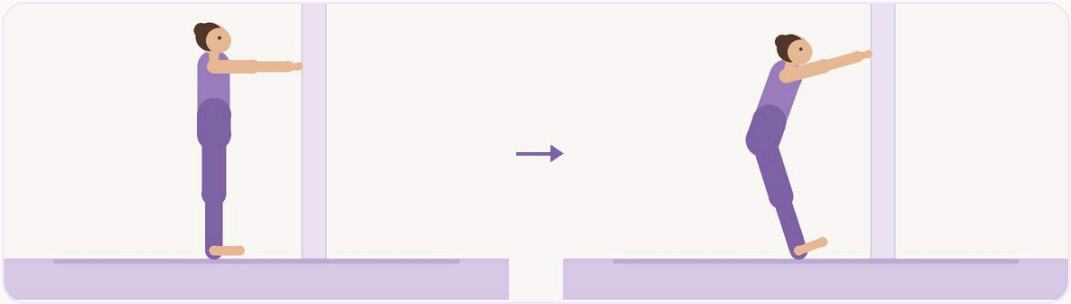
Cue
“Pump your arms while your belly stays flat.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: avoid after the first trimester. Neck pain: keep the head down.

Wall Arm Circles

standing tall

Beginner | Wall | V1-097



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand with back and head against the wall.
2. Arms down by your sides.
3. Circle the arms forward, up and around.
4. Reverse the direction.

Focus
Mobilizes the shoulders and improves posture awareness.

Target muscles
Deltoids, rotator cuff, upper back

Dosage
6 each direction · about 1 min

Breathing
Inhale on the upstroke; exhale on the downstroke.

Common faults
Arching the back, shrugging, circles too large.

Progression / Regression
Easier: smaller circles. Harder: add light weights.

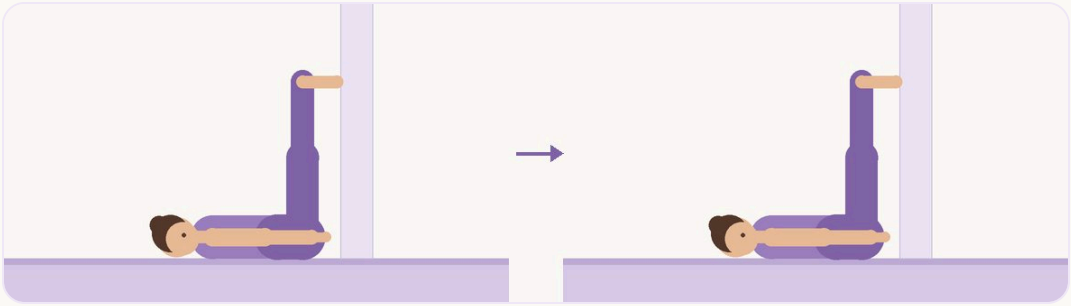
Cue
“Reach long and keep your shoulders away from your ears.”

Adaptation
Shoulder pain: use small circles below shoulder height. Neck tension: slow down.

Wall Hamstring Stretch

legs up the wall

Beginner | Wall | V1-098



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit sideways next to the wall.
2. Swing the legs up as you lie back.
3. Place the hips close to the wall, legs extended.
4. Relax and breathe slowly.

Focus
Passive stretch that lengthens the hamstrings and calms the lower back.

Target muscles
Hamstrings, calves

Dosage
45 sec hold · about 2 min

Breathing
Breathe slowly and deeply.

Common faults
Pulling on the knees, overarching, locking the knee.

Progression / Regression
Easier: bend the knees. Harder: move the hips closer to the wall.

Cue
“Let your legs relax and your pelvis feel heavy.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: use a wedge under the pelvis. Lower back pain: slide away from the wall.

VOLUME 1 · BEGINNER

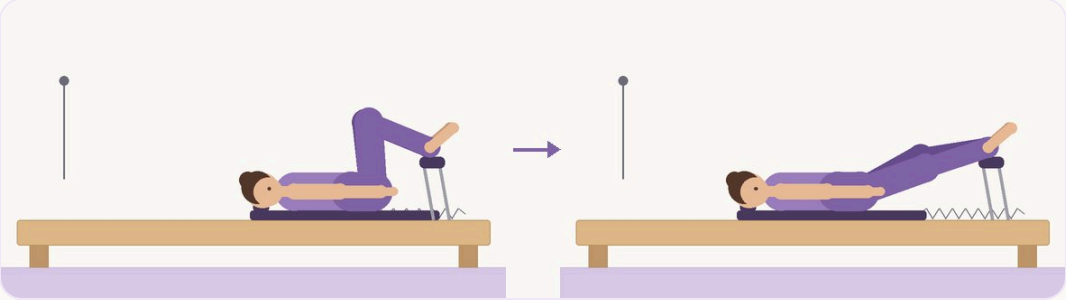
Reformer

38 exercises

Footwork: Toes

on the toes

Beginner | Reformer | V1-099



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back, head and shoulders down, feet on the bar in parallel on the balls of the feet.
2. Find a neutral pelvis and soften the ribs.
3. Exhale and extend the legs to a long, unlocked line.
4. Inhale and bend the knees slowly, keeping the carriage quiet.

Focus
Warms up the legs and teaches pelvic stability while the carriage moves. Builds control of hips, knees and ankles.

Target muscles
Quadriceps, gluteals, hamstrings, calves, deep abdominals

Springs
3–4 springs

Dosage
8–10 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare, exhale as you press out, inhale to return slowly.

Common faults
Gripping the toes, locking the knees, letting the pelvis tuck or the ribs flare.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Fewer reps, heavier springs for support. Harder: Lighter springs and a slower return.

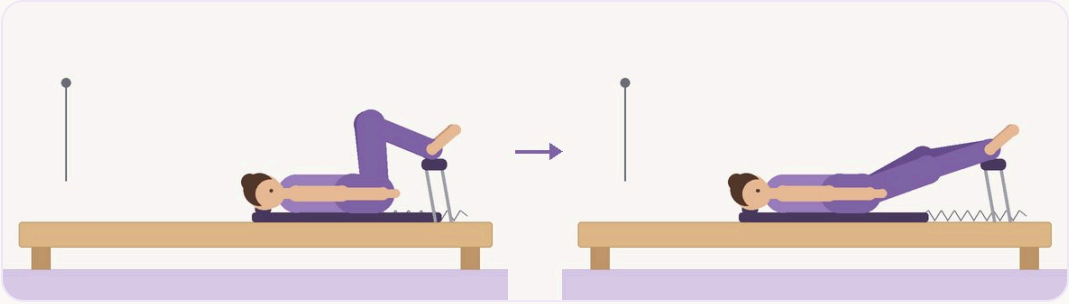
Cue
“Press away through the balls of your feet and return with control.”

Adaptation
After trimester one, incline the torso; follow the care provider. Keep knees soft.

Footwork: Arches

arches on the bar

Beginner | Reformer | V1-100



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie supine with the arches of both feet on the bar, legs parallel.
2. Keep a neutral spine and relaxed shoulders.
3. Exhale and press the carriage out without locking the knees.
4. Inhale and bend the knees to return slowly.

Focus
Trains the same leg press while the arch of the foot rests on the bar. Improves foot and ankle awareness.

Target muscles
Quadriceps, gluteals, hamstrings, intrinsic foot muscles

Springs
3–4 springs

Dosage
8–10 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale as you extend the legs, inhale as you return.

Common faults
Rolling to the outer edges of the feet, shifting the pelvis, snapping the knees straight.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep a smaller range of motion. Harder: Slow the return to a four-count.

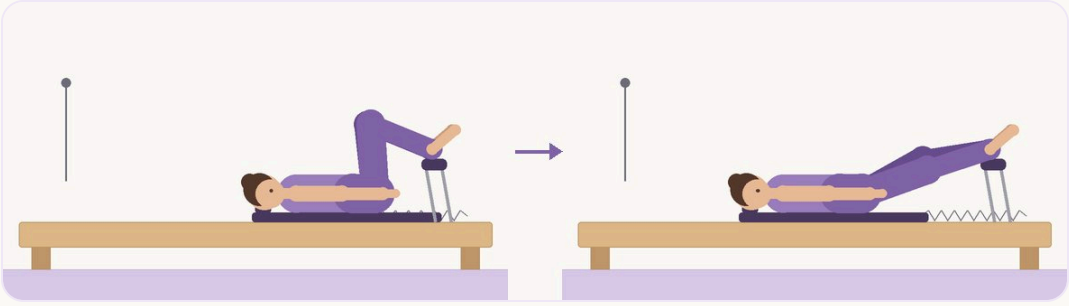
Cue
“Press through the arches and keep your hips level.”

Adaptation
After trimester one, incline the torso; follow the care provider. Limit knee bend with knee pain.

Footwork: Heels

heels on the bar

Beginner | Reformer | V1-101



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie supine with both heels on the bar, feet flexed gently.
2. Keep the knees in line with the hips.
3. Exhale and extend the legs to a long line.
4. Inhale and bend the knees, keeping the heels anchored.

Focus
Shifts the work toward the backs of the legs and lengthens the calves while the pelvis stays still.

Target muscles
Hamstrings, gluteals, quadriceps, calf stretch

Springs
3–4 springs

Dosage
8–10 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale to press out, inhale to return.

Common faults
Pushing with the toes, lifting the hips, hyperextending the knees.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the range slightly. Harder: Add a pause at full extension.

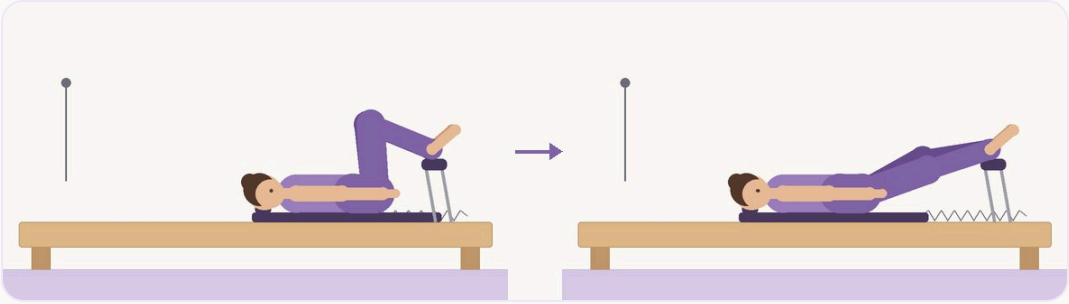
Cue
“Press through your heels and lengthen the backs of your legs.”

Adaptation
After trimester one, incline the torso; follow the care provider. Ease off if calves cramp.

Footwork: Prances

alternating heel lifts

Beginner | Reformer | V1-102



HOW TO DO IT

1. From extended legs with the balls of the feet on the bar, hold the carriage still.
2. Lower one heel below the bar and lift the other.
3. Alternate smoothly, keeping the pelvis level.
4. Finish by bending both knees to rest the carriage in.

Focus
Adds ankle mobility and alternating control while the pelvis stays level. A great rhythm builder.

Target muscles
Calves, quadriceps, hip stabilizers, deep abdominals

Springs
3–4 springs

Dosage
16 alternations · about 2 min

Breathing
Breathe naturally in a steady rhythm; exhale on every second lift.

Common faults
Rocking the pelvis, bouncing the carriage, moving the knees out of line.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Slow the pace and keep the carriage still. Harder: Hold the carriage further out.

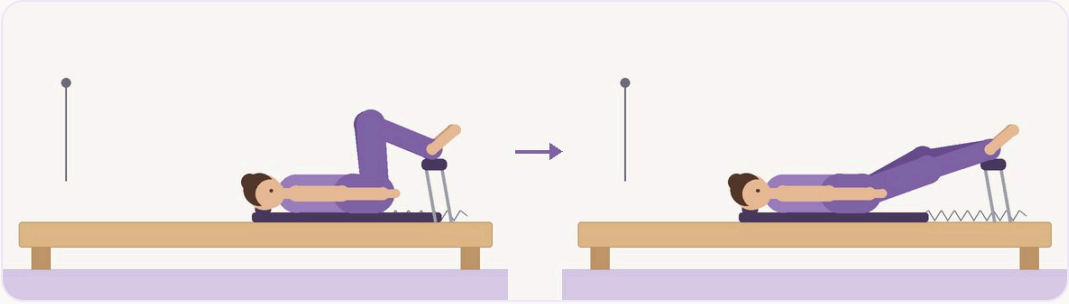
Cue
“Lift one heel at a time and keep your hips still.”

Adaptation
After trimester one, incline the torso; follow the care provider. Keep the movement small.

Footwork: Pilates V

heels together, toes apart

Beginner | Reformer | V1-103



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie supine with the heels together and the toes slightly apart on the bar.
2. Rotate from the hips, not the feet.
3. Exhale and extend the legs, squeezing the heels.
4. Inhale and bend the knees along the line of the toes.

Focus
Introduces turnout and inner-thigh engagement while the legs press the carriage out.

Target muscles
Inner thighs, deep hip rotators, gluteals, hamstrings

Springs
3–4 springs

Dosage
8–10 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale as you extend, inhale as you return.

Common faults
Forcing the turnout from the feet, collapsing the arches, tucking the pelvis.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the turnout. Harder: Slow the tempo and add a small heel lift.

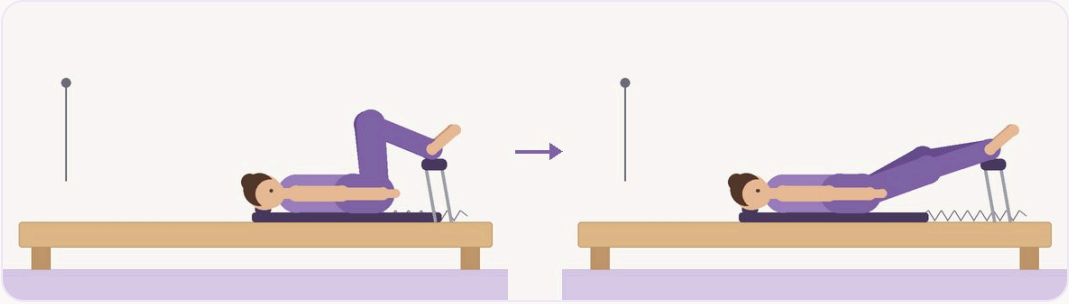
Cue
“Squeeze your heels together and open from the hips.”

Adaptation
After trimester one, incline the torso; follow the care provider. Reduce turnout with knee or hip discomfort.

Footwork: Wide Second

feet wide on the bar

Beginner | Reformer | V1-104



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie supine with the feet wide on the bar, toes turned slightly out.
2. Keep the pelvis neutral.
3. Exhale and extend the legs along the line of the feet.
4. Inhale and bend the knees while keeping them open.

Focus
Challenges the outer hips and inner thighs with the feet set wide, strengthening alignment.

Target muscles
Gluteals, adductors, hamstrings, quadriceps

Springs
3–4 springs

Dosage
8 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale to press away, inhale to return.

Common faults
Letting the knees fall in, shifting the pelvis side to side, locking out.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Place the feet closer together. Harder: Hold the extended position for two breaths.

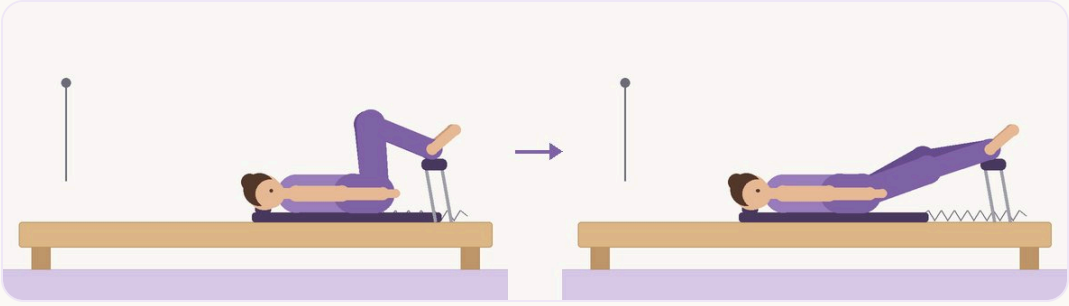
Cue
“Press wide and keep your knees tracking over your toes.”

Adaptation
After trimester one, incline the torso; follow the care provider. Narrow the stance with groin or hip pain.

Footwork: Single Leg

one foot on the bar

Beginner | Reformer | V1-105



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie supine with one foot on the bar and the other leg in tabletop.
2. Keep the pelvis level and the ribs soft.
3. Exhale and extend the working leg.
4. Inhale and bend it slowly, then switch legs.

Focus
Reveals strength differences between sides and challenges pelvic control with one leg working.

Target muscles
Quadriceps, gluteals, hamstrings, deep abdominals

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
6–8 reps each leg · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to extend, inhale to return.

Common faults
Rotating the pelvis, dropping the lifted knee, rushing the return.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep the other foot on the bar. Harder: Hold the free leg in tabletop.

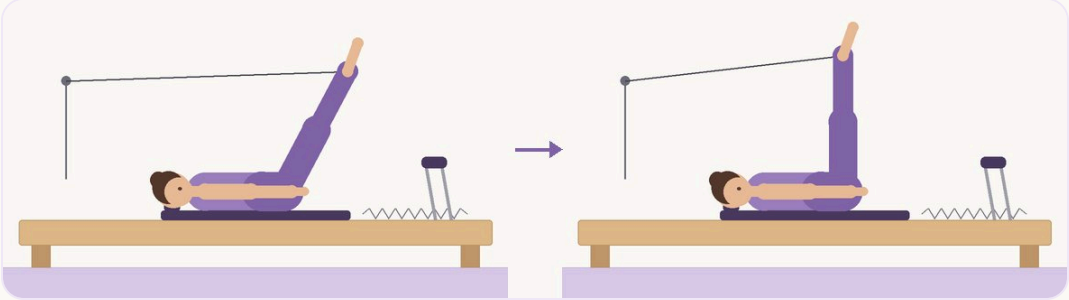
Cue
“Press through one foot and keep your pelvis level.”

Adaptation
After trimester one, incline the torso; follow the care provider. With low back sensitivity, keep the range small and stop if symptoms increase.

Supine Rib Breathing

lateral breath on the carriage

Beginner | Reformer | V1-106



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie supine on the carriage, knees bent, feet on the bar.
2. Place your hands on the lower ribs.
3. Inhale and feel the ribs widen into your hands.
4. Exhale and feel the ribs draw in and down.

Focus
Teaches 3D breathing and rib mobility before movement. Sets the tone for the whole class.

Target muscles
Diaphragm, intercostals, transversus abdominis, pelvic floor

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
6–8 breaths · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale wide into the sides of the ribs; exhale and draw the ribs together.

Common faults
Lifting the shoulders, arching the low back, breathing only into the chest.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Hands on the ribs for feedback. Harder: Add small arm reaches.

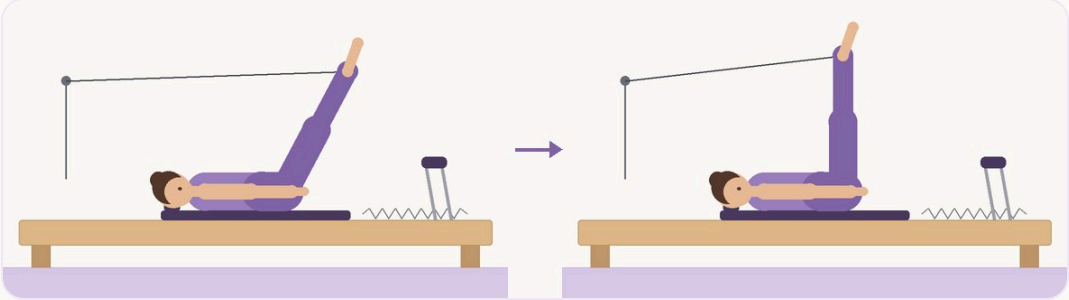
Cue
“Breathe into the sides of your ribs and let them close.”

Adaptation
After trimester one, incline the torso; follow the care provider. Sit inclined instead of flat.

Pelvic Tilts

spine warm-up on the carriage

Beginner | Reformer | V1-107



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie supine with the feet on the bar, knees bent.
2. Find neutral with the pelvis level.
3. Exhale and gently tuck the pelvis, flattening the low back.
4. Inhale and return to neutral.

Focus
Wakes up the lumbar spine and abdominals, finding the neutral and imprint positions.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, transversus abdominis, spinal extensors

Springs
2 springs

Dosage
8–10 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale to tilt the pelvis back, inhale to return to neutral.

Common faults
Pushing with the feet, tensing the neck, moving the carriage.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the range. Harder: Add a slow roll up into a small bridge.

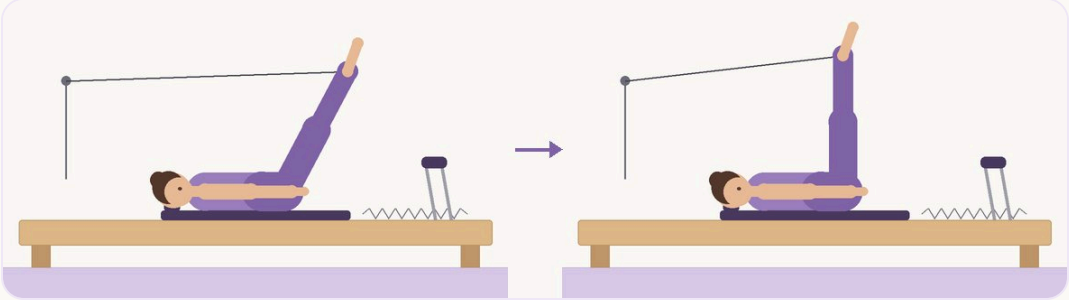
Cue
“Peel your low back toward the carriage, then release.”

Adaptation
After trimester one, incline the torso; follow the care provider. Keep the range small.

Hundred

knees in tabletop

Beginner | Reformer | V1-108



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie supine, hold the straps with arms extended toward the ceiling.
2. Lift the legs to tabletop, one at a time.
3. Exhale and curl the head and shoulders up.
4. Pump the straps down by the hips in small beats, breathing in a steady pattern.

Focus
Builds abdominal endurance and breath control. Pumps the arms in a steady rhythm with the legs supported.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, transversus abdominis, hip flexors, shoulders

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
50–100 pumps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale for five pumps, exhale for five pumps.

Common faults
Straining the neck, doming the abdomen, lifting the ribs, holding the breath.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep the head down, feet on the bar. Harder: Extend the legs to a diagonal.

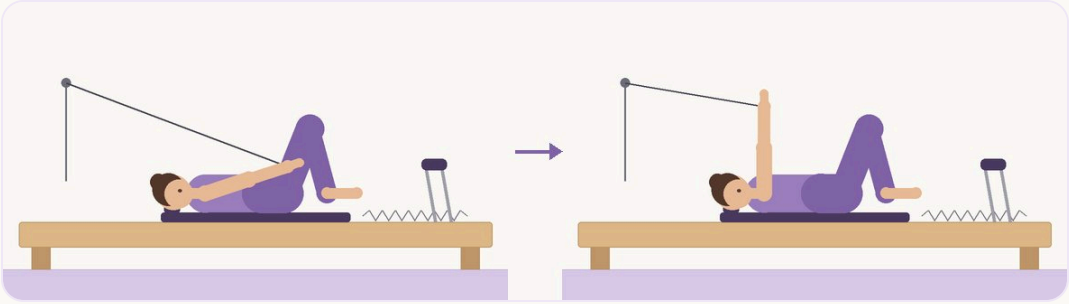
Cue
“Pump your arms and keep your belly scooped.”

Adaptation
Skip it after trimester one; keep the head down with neck strain.

Coordination

legs and arms together

Beginner | Reformer | V1-109



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie supine holding the straps, legs in tabletop, head and shoulders curled.
2. Exhale and extend the legs to a high diagonal.
3. Press the arms down toward the thighs.
4. Inhale and bring the legs back to tabletop while the arms return.

Focus
Combines leg extension, arm press and an abdominal curl to link the whole body.

Target muscles
Abdominals, hip flexors, triceps, shoulder stabilizers

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale as you extend the legs and press the arms, inhale to return.

Common faults
Letting the legs drop low, jerking the straps, tensing the neck.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep the head down. Harder: Hold the extended position for one breath.

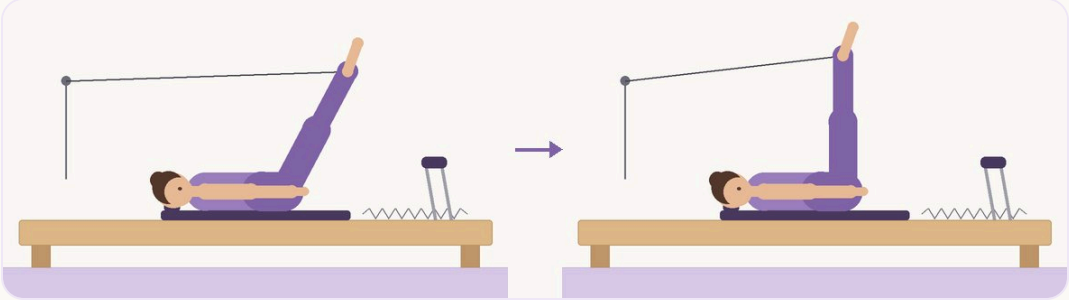
Cue
“Press your legs and arms out together in one long line.”

Adaptation
Skip the head lift; after trimester one, use an incline.

Leg Circles

feet in straps

Beginner | Reformer | V1-110



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie supine with both feet in the straps, legs toward the ceiling.
2. Keep the pelvis neutral and the back heavy.
3. Open the legs slightly and circle down.
4. Lift them back together, then reverse.

Focus
Mobilizes the hip joints while the pelvis stays still. Teaches stability with the leg moving freely.

Target muscles
Hip flexors, hip rotators, adductors, deep abdominals

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
5 circles each way · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to circle down and out, exhale to circle up and together.

Common faults
Rocking the pelvis, making circles too big, bending the knees.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Small circles with knees slightly bent. Harder: Larger circles with a slower tempo.

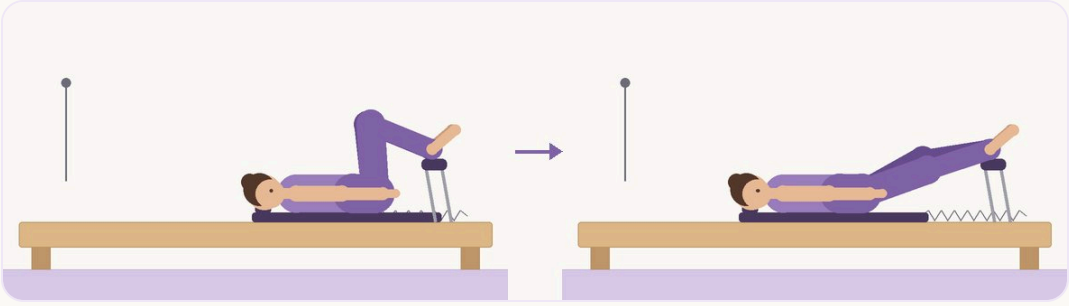
Cue
“Draw a small circle and keep your pelvis still.”

Adaptation
After trimester one, incline the torso; follow the care provider. With low back sensitivity, keep the range small and stop if symptoms increase.

Frog

heels together in straps

Beginner | Reformer | V1-111



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie supine, heels together in the straps, toes apart.
2. Bend the knees toward the chest, keeping the heels touching.
3. Exhale and press the legs out to a long line.
4. Inhale and bend the knees back in.

Focus
Builds hip and knee control with the legs in a turned-out position. A classic lower-body warm-up.

Target muscles
Hamstrings, gluteals, adductors, hip rotators

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale as the knees bend, exhale as the legs press out.

Common faults
Letting the knees drop in, arching the back, loosening the heels.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the range. Harder: Lift the head and curl up.

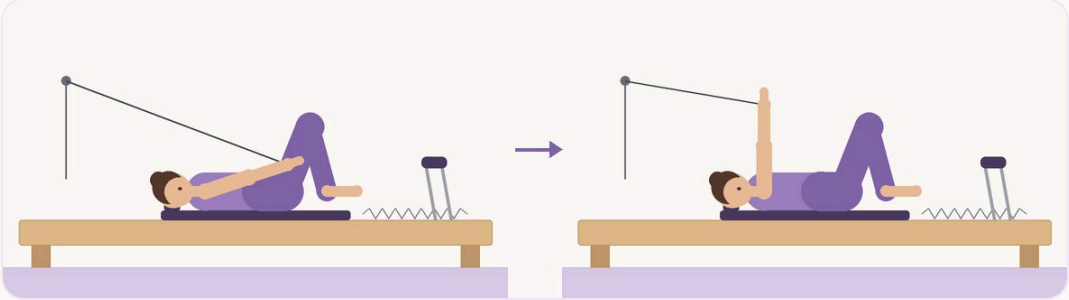
Cue
“Press out and squeeze your heels together.”

Adaptation
After trimester one, incline the torso; follow the care provider. Limit hip flexion with groin pain.

Supine Arms: Pulling Down

straps toward the hips

Beginner | Reformer | V1-112



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie supine holding the straps, arms reaching to the ceiling.
2. Keep the head and ribs relaxed.
3. Exhale and press the arms down toward the hips.
4. Inhale and float them back up.

Focus
Strengthens the back and shoulders while the abdominals stabilize the rib cage.

Target muscles
Latissimus dorsi, posterior deltoids, triceps, deep abdominals

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
8 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale as you press down, inhale as you return.

Common faults
Shrugging, flaring the ribs, locking the elbows hard.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Use lighter springs. Harder: Hold the arms down for two counts.

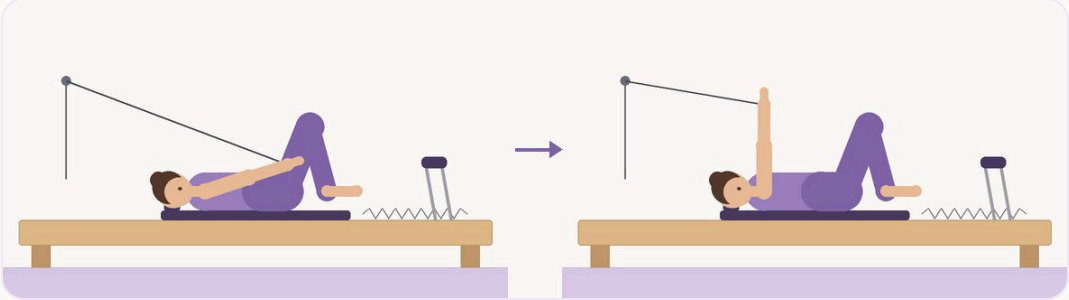
Cue
“Press your arms down and slide your shoulders away from your ears.”

Adaptation
After trimester one, incline the torso; follow the care provider. Reduce range with shoulder pain.

Supine Arms: Triceps Press

elbows bent in straps

Beginner | Reformer | V1-113



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie supine, holding the straps with elbows bent beside the ribs.
2. Anchor the upper arms to the carriage.
3. Exhale and extend the forearms toward the feet.
4. Inhale and bend the elbows back.

Focus
Targets the backs of the arms while the elbows stay close to the body.

Target muscles
Triceps, shoulder stabilizers, deep abdominals

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
8 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale as you straighten the arms, inhale as you bend.

Common faults
Flaring the elbows, arching the back, shrugging.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep a smaller range. Harder: Press with the arms slightly higher.

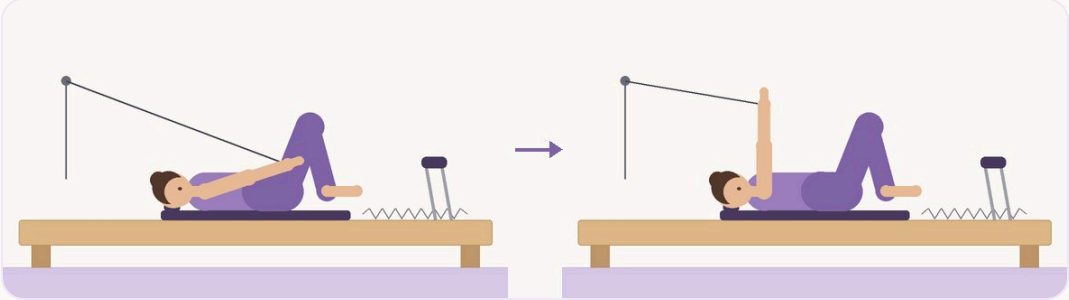
Cue
“Hold your elbows still and straighten your arms.”

Adaptation
After trimester one, incline the torso; follow the care provider. Reduce range with elbow or shoulder pain.

Supine Arms: Arm Circles

circles in straps

Beginner | Reformer | V1-114



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie supine with the straps in your hands, arms toward the ceiling.
2. Open the arms to the sides at shoulder height.
3. Press them down by your hips.
4. Circle back up together, then reverse.

Focus
Mobilizes the shoulders and trains stability as the arms move through space.

Target muscles
Deltoids, pectorals, rotator cuff, deep abdominals

Springs
1 light spring

Dosage
5 circles each way · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale as the arms open, exhale as they close.

Common faults
Letting the ribs lift, circling too wide, shrugging.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Smaller circles. Harder: Add a tempo count of four.

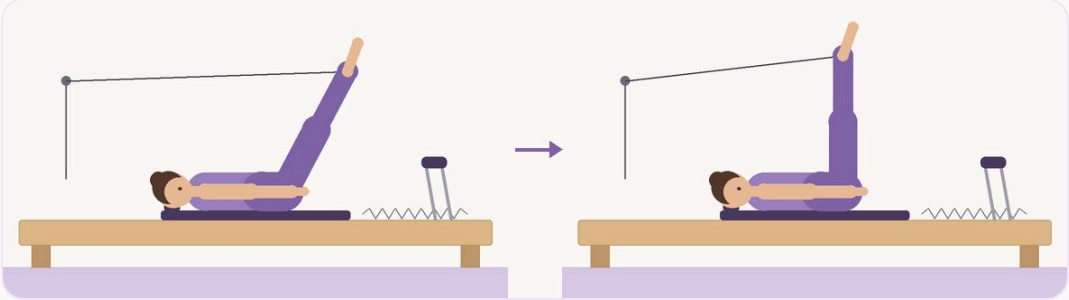
Cue
“Draw circles with your arms and keep your ribs down.”

Adaptation
After trimester one, incline the torso; follow the care provider. Keep circles small with shoulder pain.

Chest Lift with Straps

abdominal curl

Beginner | Reformer | V1-115



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie supine holding the straps, arms toward the ceiling, knees bent.
2. Exhale and nod the chin.
3. Curl the head and shoulders up.
4. Inhale and lower with control.

Focus
Introduces spinal flexion with the arms assisting. Builds the control needed for sit-up variations.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, obliques, hip flexors

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale as you curl up, inhale as you lower.

Common faults
Pulling on the neck, pushing the straps down hard, losing the pelvic position.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Lift just the head. Harder: Lift higher and hold for two counts.

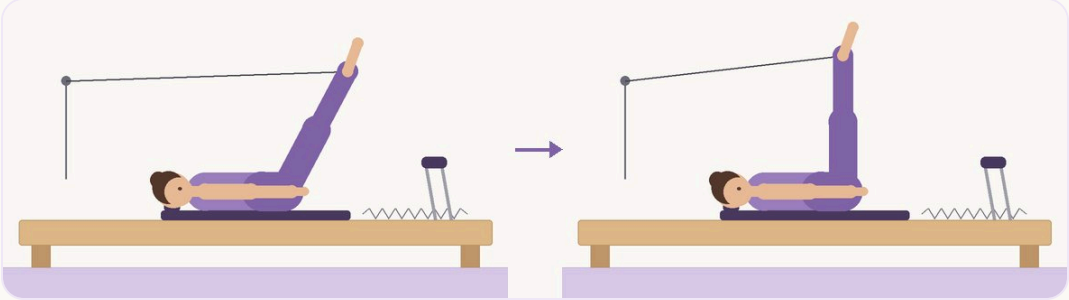
Cue
“Curl up one vertebra at a time and keep your chin soft.”

Adaptation
Avoid after trimester one; with neck strain, keep the head down.

Short Spine Prep

pelvic curl on the carriage

Beginner | Reformer | V1-116



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie supine with the feet on the bar and the arms by your sides.
2. Exhale and tilt the pelvis back.
3. Peel the spine up to the shoulder blades.
4. Inhale to stay, then exhale to roll down.

Focus
Teaches articulation of the spine and hip extension. Preps the full Short Spine Massage.

Target muscles
Spinal extensors, hamstrings, gluteals, abdominals

Springs
2 springs

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale as you roll up, inhale at the top, exhale as you roll down.

Common faults
Overarching the low back, tensing the neck, rushing the roll down.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Lift only a few inches. Harder: Lift higher and hold for one breath.

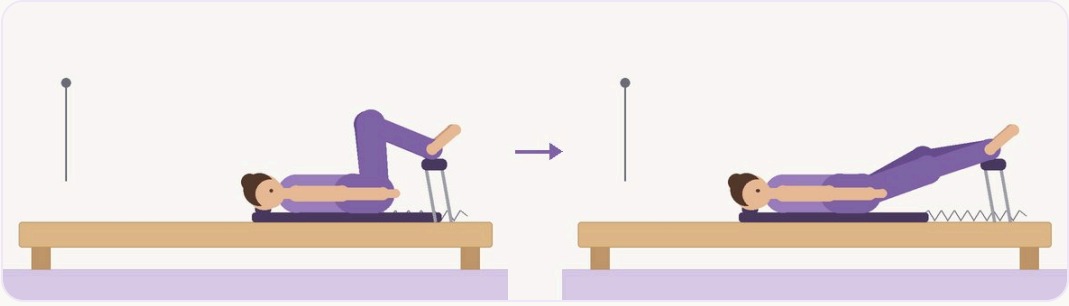
Cue
“Roll your spine up one bone at a time.”

Adaptation
After trimester one, incline the torso; follow the care provider. Avoid a long hold at the top.

Bridging

feet on the footbar

Beginner | Reformer | V1-117



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie supine with the feet on the bar, hip-width apart.
2. Exhale and tilt the pelvis, peeling the spine up.
3. Hold at the top, ribs soft.
4. Inhale to prepare, then roll down vertebra by vertebra.

Focus
Strengthens the glutes and hamstrings while the spine articulates. Eases the hips toward extension.

Target muscles
Gluteals, hamstrings, spinal extensors, deep abdominals

Springs
2–3 springs

Dosage
8 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale as you lift, inhale at the top, exhale as you lower.

Common faults
Pushing into the bar, arching the ribs, letting knees splay.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep the lift small. Harder: Lift one leg at the top.

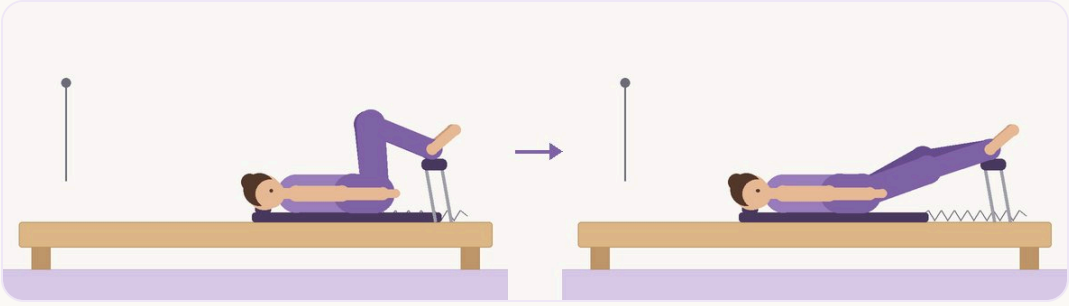
Cue
“Lift your hips and keep your knees pointing forward.”

Adaptation
After trimester one, incline the torso; follow the care provider. Keep the lift low.

Hamstring Curls

feet on the footbar

Beginner | Reformer | V1-118



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie supine with the heels on the bar, hips lifted into a small bridge.
2. Keep the pelvis level.
3. Exhale and curl the heels in, bringing the carriage forward.
4. Inhale and extend the legs.

Focus
Strengthens the hamstrings and stabilizes the pelvis while the carriage glides.

Target muscles
Hamstrings, gluteals, deep abdominals

Springs
2–3 springs

Dosage
8–10 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale as you curl in, inhale as you extend.

Common faults
Lifting the hips, locking the knees, dropping the pelvis.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Keep the hips on the carriage. Harder: Lift the hips into a bridge.

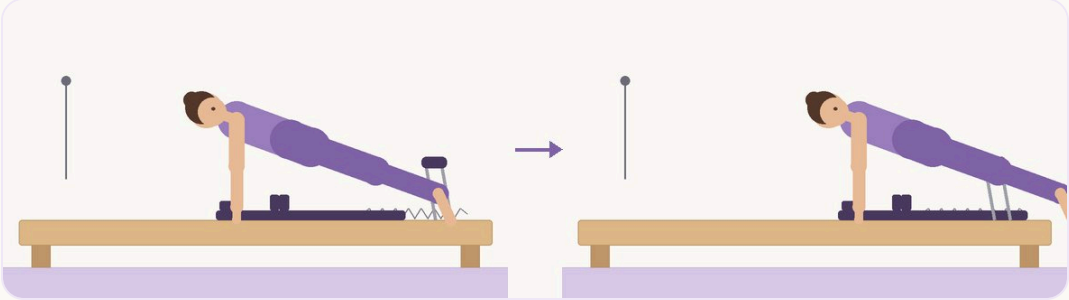
Cue
“Pull your heels toward your seat and keep your hips steady.”

Adaptation
After trimester one, incline the torso; follow the care provider. Keep the hips down.

Elephant

hands on the bar

Beginner | Reformer | V1-119



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand on the carriage with the heels on the platform and the hands on the bar.
2. Round the spine in a pike shape.
3. Exhale and push the carriage back with the heels.
4. Inhale and return, keeping the abdominals lifted.

Focus
Stretches the hamstrings and challenges the abdominals with the carriage moving. Teaches lengthening through the spine.

Target muscles
Hamstrings, abdominals, shoulder stabilizers, calves

Springs
2 springs

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale as the carriage goes in, inhale as it goes out.

Common faults
Rounding the spine, bending the knees, pushing the shoulders up.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Bend the knees slightly. Harder: Lift one heel and hold.

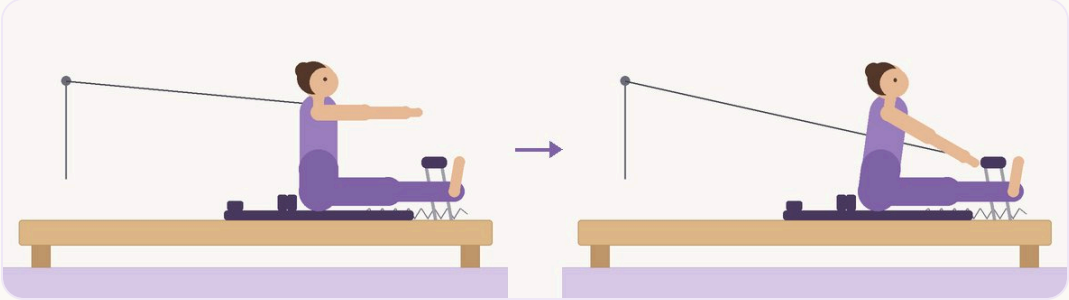
Cue
“Press your heels back and lift your belly.”

Adaptation
After trimester one, keep a flatter back and avoid belly pressure.

Stomach Massage: Round Back

seated on the carriage

Beginner | Reformer | V1-120



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall on the carriage, heels on the bar, hands behind you.
2. Round the spine into a C-curve.
3. Exhale and extend the legs.
4. Inhale and bend the knees to return.

Focus
Strengthens the abdominals and mobilizes the spine while the legs glide the carriage.

Target muscles
Abdominals, hip flexors, quadriceps

Springs
3 springs

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale as you extend the legs, inhale as you return.

Common faults
Collapsing the chest, gripping the shoulders, tipping behind the sit bones.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Place the hands behind you for support. Harder: Lift the hands.

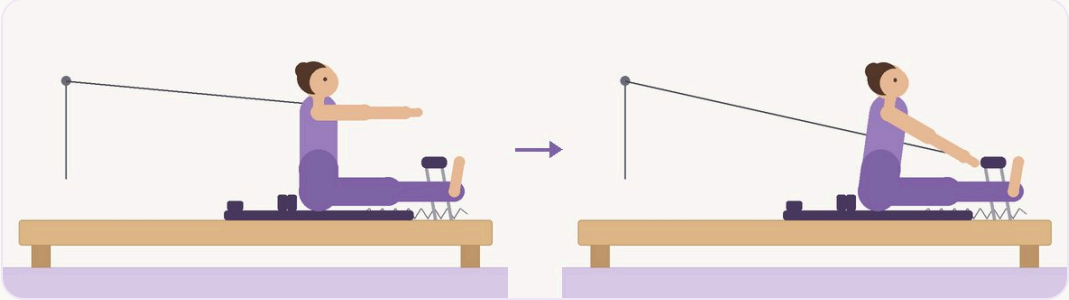
Cue
“Scoop your belly and press your heels away.”

Adaptation
After trimester one, avoid deep flexion with belly pressure.

Stomach Massage: Flat Back

long spine reach

Beginner | Reformer | V1-121



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit on the carriage with a long spine, heels on the bar.
2. Place your hands lightly on the carriage.
3. Inhale to grow tall.
4. Exhale and press the legs out, then return.

Focus
Builds postural endurance with a long spine while the legs press the carriage out.

Target muscles
Abdominals, spinal extensors, quadriceps

Springs
3 springs

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to lengthen the spine, exhale as you press out.

Common faults
Slouching, lifting the shoulders, leaning back.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the range. Harder: Lift the hands off the carriage.

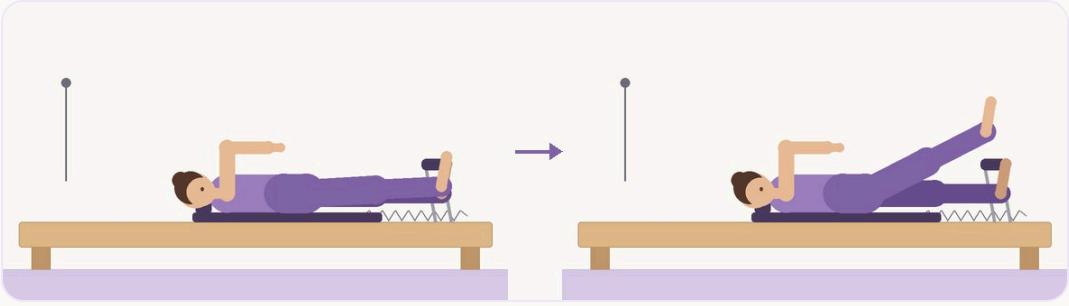
Cue
“Sit tall and press your heels away.”

Adaptation
Sit on a small cushion for low back support.

Side-Lying Leg Press

foot on the bar

Beginner | Reformer | V1-122



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your side with the head on your forearm.
2. Place the top foot on the bar.
3. Exhale and press the leg out.
4. Inhale and return, keeping the pelvis stacked.

Focus
Trains the glutes and legs in a side-lying position, building hip stability.

Target muscles
Gluteus medius, quadriceps, obliques

Springs
2 springs

Dosage
8 reps each leg · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale as you press, inhale as you return.

Common faults
Rolling the pelvis back, hunching the neck, locking the knee.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the range. Harder: Hold the leg out for a breath.

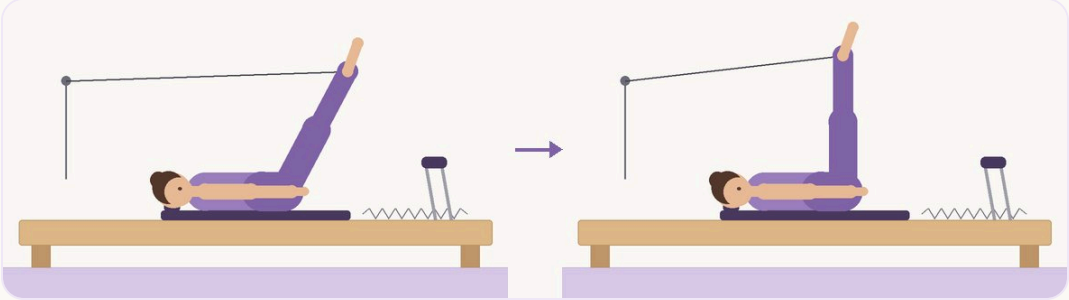
Cue
“Press through your top foot and keep your waist long.”

Adaptation
Use a pillow between the knees and under the head.

Side-Lying Leg Circles

top leg floats

Beginner | Reformer | V1-123



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your side with the top foot in a strap.
2. Lengthen both legs and keep the pelvis stacked.
3. Circle the top leg in small arcs.
4. Reverse the direction after five circles.

Focus
Mobilizes the hip with the pelvis steady. Strengthens the outer hip.

Target muscles
Hip abductors, hip flexors, obliques

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
5 circles each way · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale as you circle forward, inhale as you circle back.

Common faults
Rolling the pelvis, making large circles, dropping the top ribs.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Smaller circles. Harder: Lengthen the leg with a pointed foot.

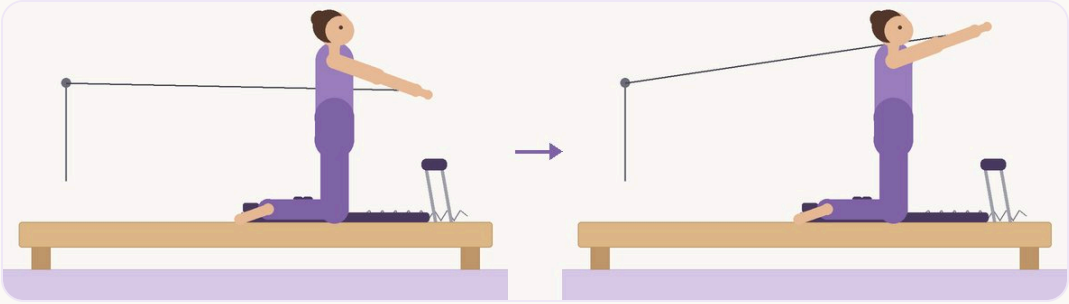
Cue
“Circle your leg and keep your waist lifted.”

Adaptation
Keep the circles small with hip discomfort; add a pillow.

Knee Stretches: Round Back

rounded spine

Beginner | Reformer | V1-124



HOW TO DO IT

1. Kneel on the carriage, feet against the shoulder rests, hands on the bar.
2. Round the spine into a C-curve.
3. Exhale and push the carriage back.
4. Inhale and return slowly.

Focus
Builds the abdominals and the legs while the carriage moves. Teaches maintaining the spinal curve.

Target muscles
Abdominals, quadriceps, hip flexors

Springs
3 springs

Dosage
8–10 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale as you push back, inhale as you return.

Common faults
Letting the hips sit back, tensing the shoulders, bouncing.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the range. Harder: Lift the knees slightly.

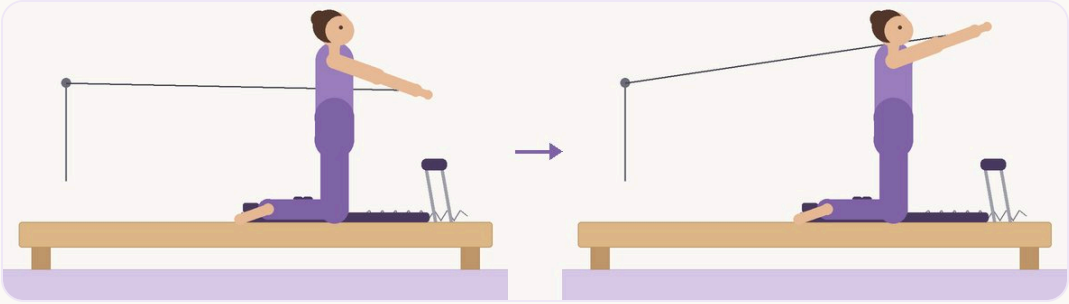
Cue
“Round your spine and slide the carriage back.”

Adaptation
After trimester one, avoid the round back; pad sensitive knees.

Knee Stretches: Flat Back

long spine

Beginner | Reformer | V1-125



HOW TO DO IT

1. Kneel on the carriage with the hands on the bar.
2. Keep the spine long and the head in line.
3. Exhale and press the carriage back.
4. Inhale and return.

Focus
Teaches a long spine with the legs working, improving trunk control.

Target muscles
Abdominals, spinal extensors, quadriceps

Springs
3 springs

Dosage
8–10 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale as you extend, inhale as you return.

Common faults
Arching the lower back, lifting the head, bouncing.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the range. Harder: Lift the knees an inch.

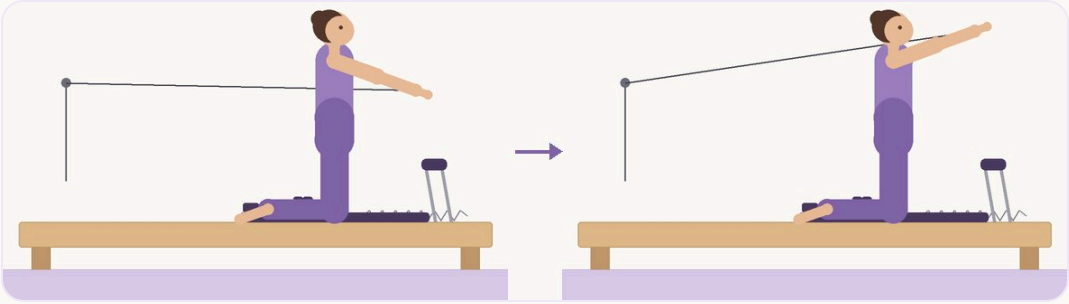
Cue
“Keep your spine long and slide your hips back.”

Adaptation
Keep the range small and pad sensitive knees.

Chest Expansion

kneeling with straps

Beginner | Reformer | V1-126



HOW TO DO IT

1. Kneel on the carriage facing the back, holding the straps.
2. Keep the spine tall.
3. Exhale and pull the arms back along the hips.
4. Inhale and float them forward.

Focus
Opens the chest and strengthens the upper back while the spine stays tall.

Target muscles
Posterior deltoids, triceps, rhomboids, abdominals

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale as you pull back, inhale as you return.

Common faults
Arching the back, shrugging, leaning backward.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Pull less far. Harder: Add a head turn.

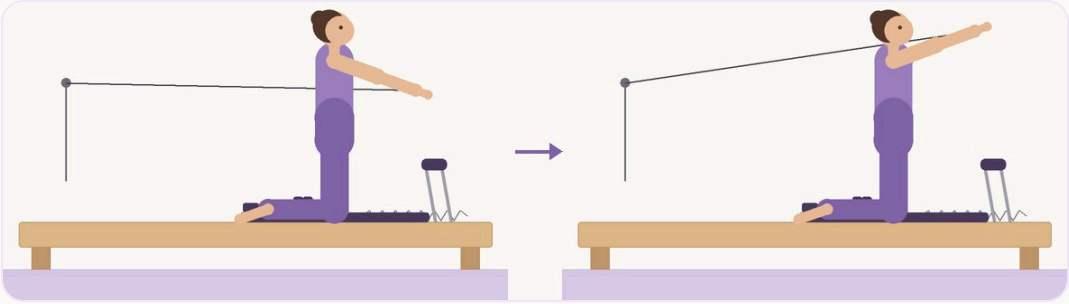
Cue
“Pull your arms back and open your chest.”

Adaptation
Keep the ribs closed and shoulders relaxed; pad the knees.

Hug a Tree

kneeling with open arms

Beginner | Reformer | V1-127



HOW TO DO IT

1. Kneel on the carriage facing the front, holding the straps.
2. Open the arms to the sides at chest height.
3. Exhale and bring them together in front.
4. Inhale and return.

Focus
Strengthens the chest and shoulders with a stable trunk.

Target muscles
Pectorals, anterior deltoids, serratus anterior

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
8 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale as the arms close, inhale as they open.

Common faults
Letting the ribs flare, rounding the shoulders, bending the elbows too much.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Lighter springs. Harder: Hold the arms closed for two counts.

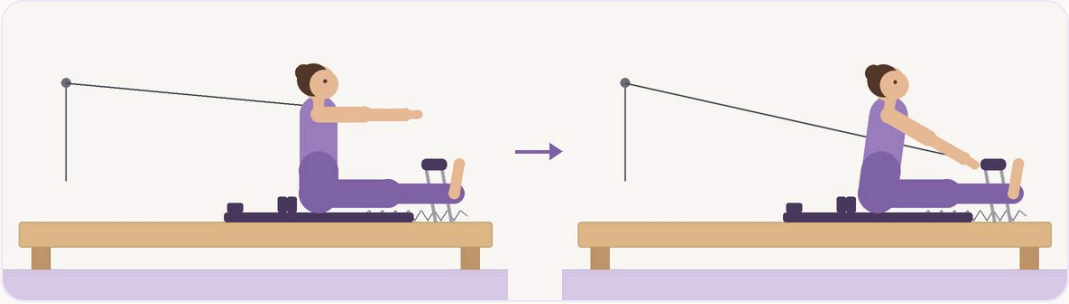
Cue
“Hug the tree and keep your ribs soft.”

Adaptation
Keep the movement smooth with shoulder pain.

Rowing: Into the Sternum

seated, straight back

Beginner | Reformer | V1-128



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall on the carriage, holding the straps.
2. Keep the legs together.
3. Exhale and pull the elbows back.
4. Inhale and release the arms forward.

Focus
Strengthens the back and posture with a straight spine and the legs supporting.

Target muscles
Latissimus dorsi, rhomboids, biceps, spinal extensors

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale as you pull, inhale as you return.

Common faults
Rounding the back, leaning backward, lifting the shoulders.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Pull a shorter range. Harder: Add a small lean back.

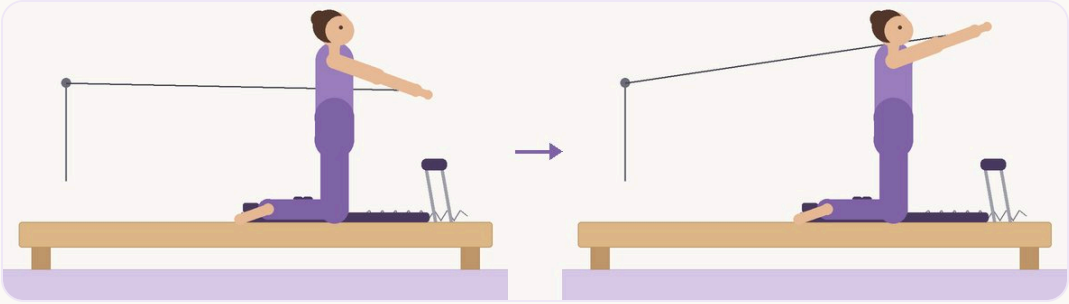
Cue
“Draw your elbows back and lift your chest.”

Adaptation
Sit on a cushion if the lower back is stiff.

Cat Stretch

on all fours

Beginner | Reformer | V1-129



HOW TO DO IT

1. Kneel on the carriage with the hands on the bar.
2. Start in a neutral spine.
3. Exhale and round the spine.
4. Inhale and return.

Focus
Mobilizes the whole spine and stretches the shoulders and upper back.

Target muscles
Spinal extensors, abdominals, shoulder stabilizers

Springs
2 springs

Dosage
6–8 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale as you round, inhale as you return to neutral.

Common faults
Letting the shoulders sink, locking the elbows, rushing.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the range. Harder: Press further.

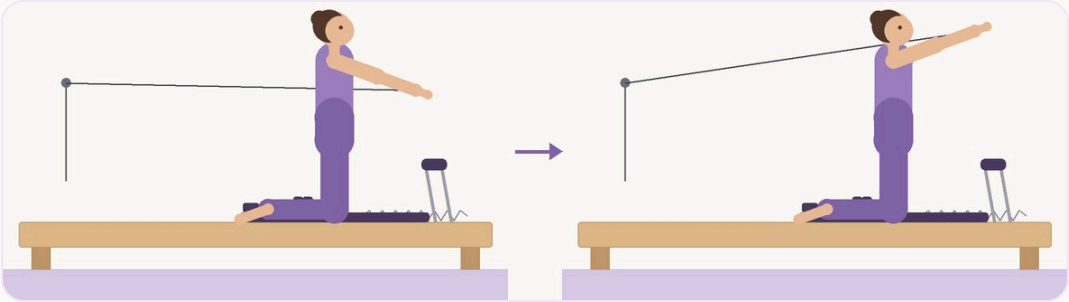
Cue
“Round your back like a cat and push the floor away.”

Adaptation
Suitable in pregnancy; reduce range with wrist pain.

Kneeling Lunge Stretch

hip flexor stretch

Beginner | Reformer | V1-130



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand with one foot on the floor and the other knee on the carriage.
2. Keep the pelvis tucked.
3. Slide the carriage back gently.
4. Hold, then switch sides.

Focus
Lengthens the front of the hip and quadriceps, improving the ability to extend the hip.

Target muscles
Hip flexors, quadriceps, gluteals

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
30 sec each side · about 2 min

Breathing
Breathe steadily, lengthening the exhale.

Common faults
Arching the low back, rotating the pelvis, overextending.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Shorten the range. Harder: Lift the arms overhead.

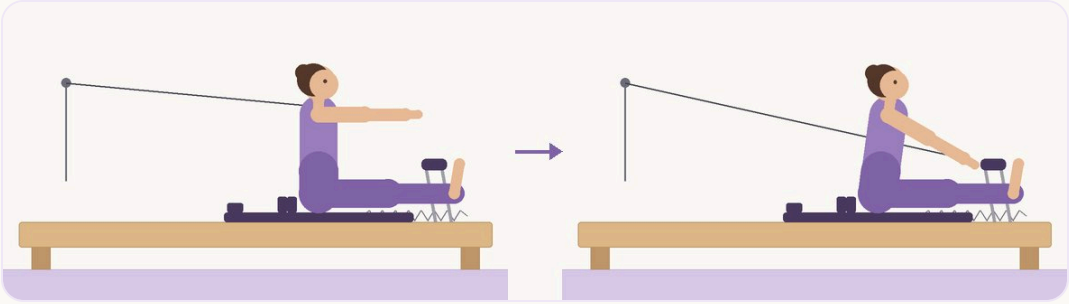
Cue
“Tuck your tailbone and lengthen the front hip.”

Adaptation
Pad the knee and keep the range small with knee pain.

Mermaid

side stretch

Beginner | Reformer | V1-131



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit sideways on the carriage with the legs folded.
2. Place one hand on the bar.
3. Inhale and reach the other arm up.
4. Exhale and bend sideways, then return.

Focus
Stretches the side of the trunk and shoulder, increasing lateral flexion.

Target muscles
Obliques, latissimus dorsi, quadratus lumborum

Springs
1 light spring

Dosage
4–5 reps each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to grow tall, exhale to bend sideways.

Common faults
Collapsing forward, shrugging, losing the sit bones.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Place the hand on the carriage. Harder: Reach the arm overhead.

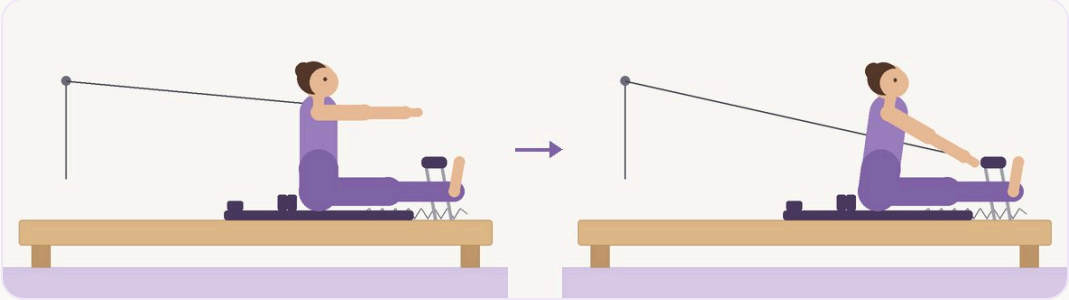
Cue
“Reach over and grow longer through the side.”

Adaptation
Keep the stretch gentle with shoulder pain.

Spine Stretch

seated forward

Beginner | Reformer | V1-132



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall on the carriage with the legs extended.
2. Hold the straps lightly or place hands on the thighs.
3. Exhale and round forward vertebra by vertebra.
4. Inhale and stack the spine back.

Focus
Lengthens the spine and the hamstrings while the abdominals curl the trunk forward.

Target muscles
Spinal extensors, hamstrings, abdominals

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
5–6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale as you roll forward, inhale as you stack up.

Common faults
Collapsing the chest, bending the knees, rushing.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Sit on a cushion. Harder: Reach further.

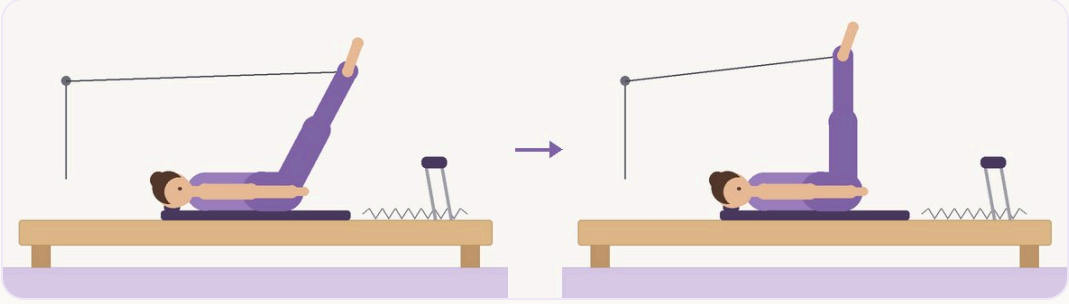
Cue
“Roll forward like a rolling wheel.”

Adaptation
Open the legs to make room for the belly.

Hamstring Stretch

leg in a strap

Beginner | Reformer | V1-133



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie supine with one foot in the strap.
2. Lift that leg toward the ceiling.
3. Keep the other leg long.
4. Hold, then switch.

Focus
Lengthens the back of the leg gently to improve hip flexion.

Target muscles
Hamstrings, calves, gluteals

Springs
1 light spring

Dosage
30 sec each leg · about 2 min

Breathing
Breathe slowly, lengthen on each exhale.

Common faults
Locking the knee, rounding the back, forcing the stretch.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Bend the knee slightly. Harder: Hold further out.

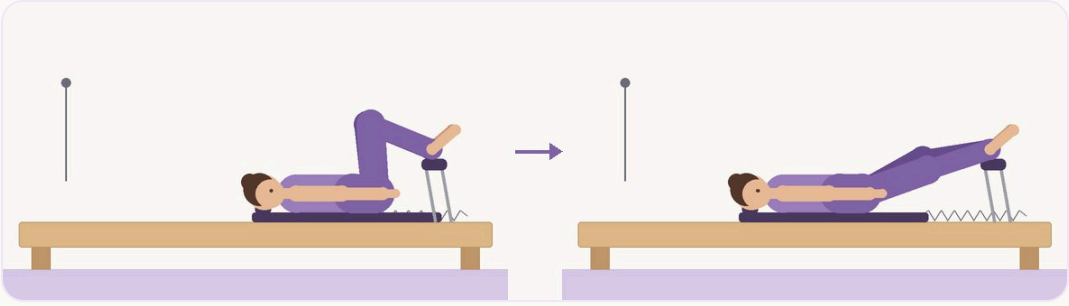
Cue
“Lift the leg and relax your hips.”

Adaptation
After trimester one, incline the torso; follow the care provider. Keep the knee soft.

Calf Stretch

heel drop

Beginner | Reformer | V1-134



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand on the platform with the ball of one foot on the bar.
2. Lower the heel gently.
3. Hold the stretch.
4. Switch sides.

Focus
Releases the calves and lengthens the back of the lower leg after footwork.

Target muscles
Gastrocnemius, soleus, Achilles tendon

Springs
2 springs

Dosage
30 sec each side · about 2 min

Breathing
Breathe slowly and steadily.

Common faults
Bouncing, collapsing the arch, locking the knee.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Reduce the heel drop. Harder: Press the heel further.

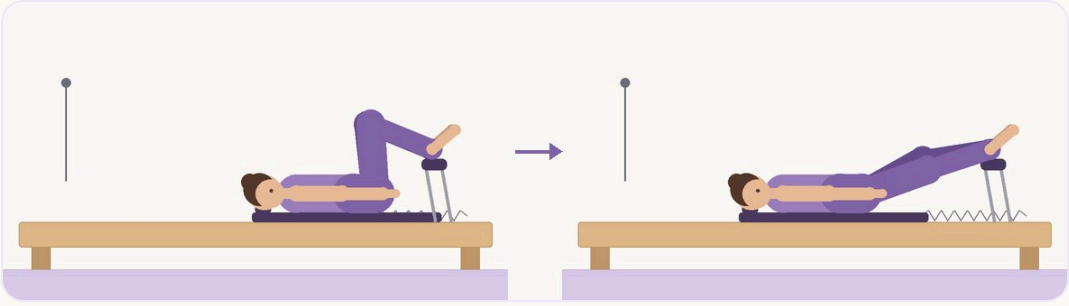
Cue
“Press your heel down and breathe long.”

Adaptation
Hold a frame for balance; stop with lower leg pain.

Skating

one foot in contact

Beginner | Reformer | V1-135



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand with one foot on the carriage and the other on the platform.
2. Hold the bar for balance.
3. Exhale and press the carriage out.
4. Inhale and bring it back.

Focus
Trains balance and leg stability with the carriage moving, linking the hips to the core.

Target muscles
Gluteals, quadriceps, adductors, deep abdominals

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
6–8 reps each leg · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale as you glide out, inhale as you return.

Common faults
Collapsing the standing knee, leaning, losing the pelvis.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Hold the bar for support. Harder: Reach the arms forward.

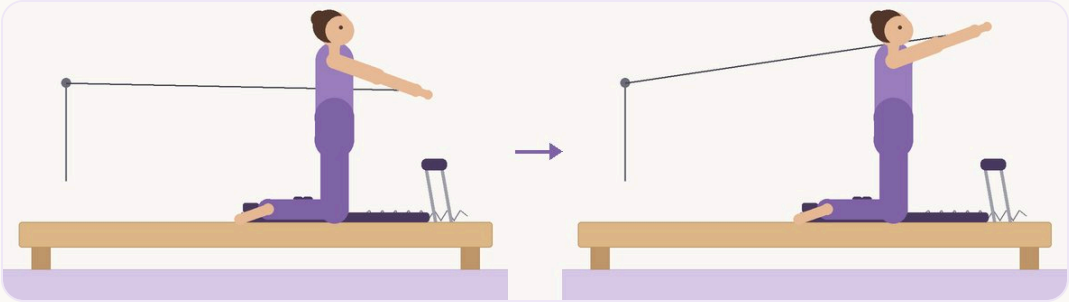
Cue
“Stand tall and glide your leg out.”

Adaptation
Hold a frame for balance; skip with knee pain.

Child's Pose

rest on the carriage

Beginner | Reformer | V1-136



HOW TO DO IT

1. Kneel on the carriage with the hands on the bar.
2. Slide the hips back toward the heels.
3. Rest the forehead.
4. Breathe slowly.

Focus
Gives the back a soft stretch and a place to rest after the class.

Target muscles
Spinal extensors, latissimus dorsi, hips

Springs
1 light spring

Dosage
5–6 breaths · about 1 min

Breathing
Breathe slowly into the back ribs.

Common faults
Straining into the stretch, lifting the hips, tensing the neck.

Progression / Regression
Easier: Place a cushion under the chest. Harder: Add arm reaches.

Cue
“Rest and breathe into your back.”

Adaptation
Open the knees wide to make space for the belly.

VOLUME 1 · BEGINNER

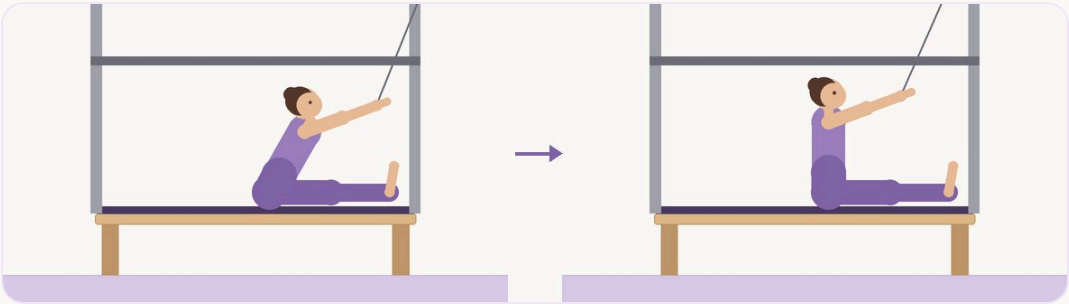
Cadillac

10 exercises

Roll-Down Bar

seated with the push-through bar

Beginner | Cadillac | V1-137



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall, hold the bar.
2. Tuck the pelvis.
3. Roll back.
4. Roll up.

Focus
Teaches articulation with the bar providing feedback.

Target muscles
Abdominals, spinal flexors

Springs
1 light spring

Dosage
6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to roll back; inhale to return.

Common faults
Pulling the bar, collapsing.

Progression / Regression
Easier: smaller range. Harder: heavier spring.

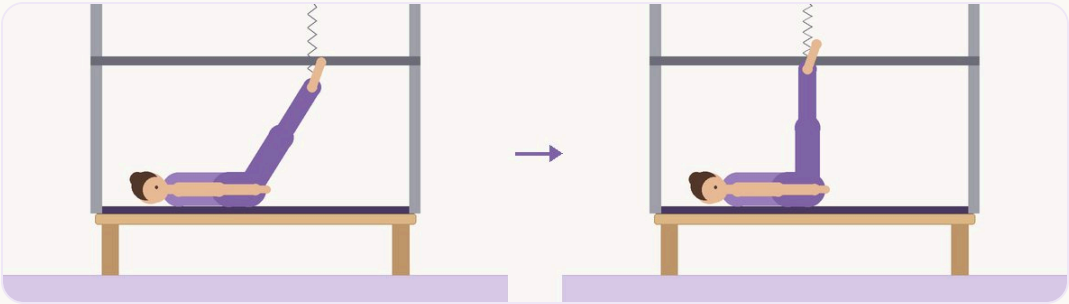
Cue
“Roll back and keep your belly scooped.”

Adaptation
Lower back pain: smaller range. Pregnancy: avoid deep flexion.

Leg Springs Frog

supine in straps

Beginner | Cadillac | V1-138



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back, feet in straps.
2. Heels together.
3. Bend the knees.
4. Press away.

Focus
Mobilizes the hips and trains pelvic stability.

Target muscles
Hip adductors, glutes, core

Springs
1 light spring

Dosage
8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to bend; exhale to press.

Common faults
Pelvis tilting, ribs flaring.

Progression / Regression
Easier: smaller range. Harder: heavier spring.

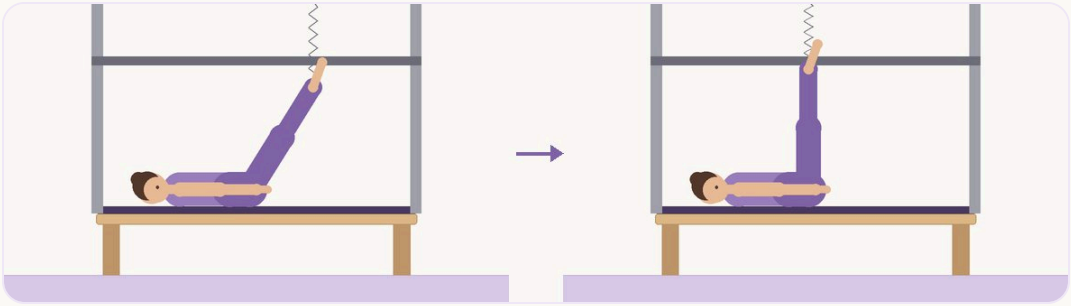
Cue
“Press out and keep your pelvis still.”

Adaptation
Hip pain: smaller range. Pregnancy: use a wedge.

Leg Springs Circles

small circles

Beginner | Cadillac | V1-139



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back in straps.
2. Legs lifted.
3. Draw circles.
4. Reverse.

Focus
Trains hip mobility and core stability.

Target muscles
Hip flexors, adductors, core

Springs
1 light spring

Dosage
5 each direction · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale up; exhale around.

Common faults
Moving the pelvis, circles too big.

Progression / Regression
Easier: smaller circles. Harder: bigger circles.

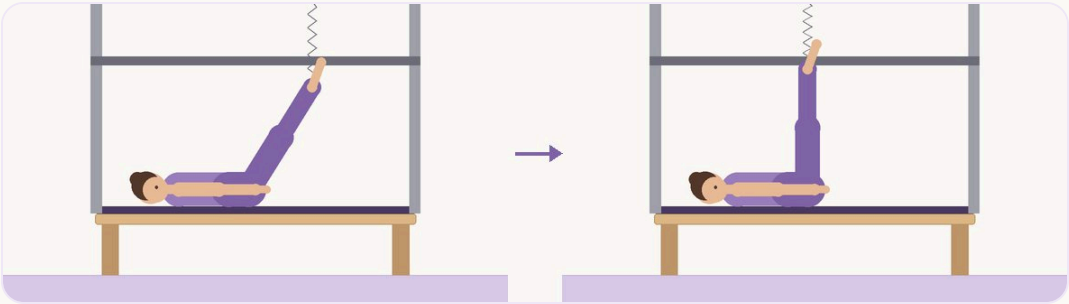
Cue
“Circle your legs while your pelvis stays still.”

Adaptation
Hip pain: smaller circles. Pregnancy: use a wedge.

Leg Springs Parallel

up and down

Beginner | Cadillac | V1-140



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie in straps.
2. Legs lifted.
3. Lower slowly.
4. Lift.

Focus
Strengthens the hip flexors with trunk control.

Target muscles
Hip flexors, hamstrings, core

Springs
1 light spring

Dosage
8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale down; inhale up.

Common faults
Back arching, knees locking.

Progression / Regression
Easier: bend the knees. Harder: heavier spring.

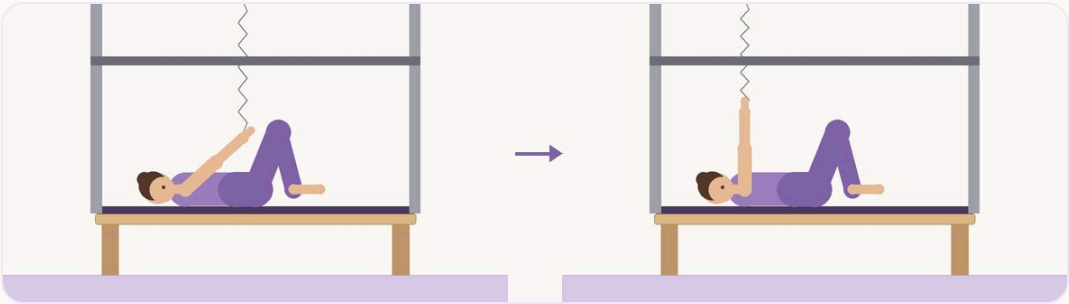
Cue
“Lower your legs while your belly stays flat.”

Adaptation
Lower back pain: bend knees. Pregnancy: use a wedge.

Arm Springs Biceps Curl

supine

Beginner | Cadillac | V1-141



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back holding the handles.
2. Arms by the sides.
3. Bend the elbows.
4. Lower.

Focus
Strengthens the biceps with the shoulders stable.

Target muscles
Biceps, shoulder stabilizers

Springs
1 light spring

Dosage
10 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to curl; inhale to lower.

Common faults
Elbows lifting, shoulders shrugging.

Progression / Regression
Easier: lighter spring. Harder: heavier spring.

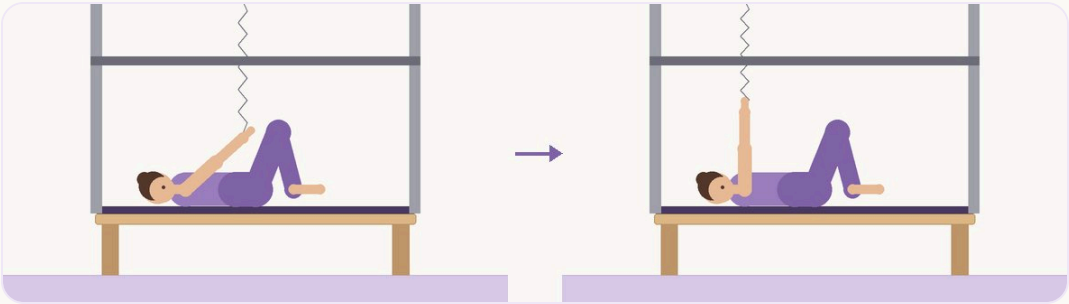
Cue
“Curl while your shoulders stay heavy.”

Adaptation
Shoulder pain: smaller range. Pregnancy: use a wedge.

Arm Springs Circles

supine

Beginner | Cadillac | V1-142



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back holding the handles.
2. Arms reach up.
3. Circle down.
4. Reverse.

Focus
Mobilizes the shoulders.

Target muscles
Deltoids, lats

Springs
1 light spring

Dosage
6 each direction · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale up; exhale down.

Common faults
Shoulders lifting, ribs flaring.

Progression / Regression
Easier: smaller circles. Harder: heavier spring.

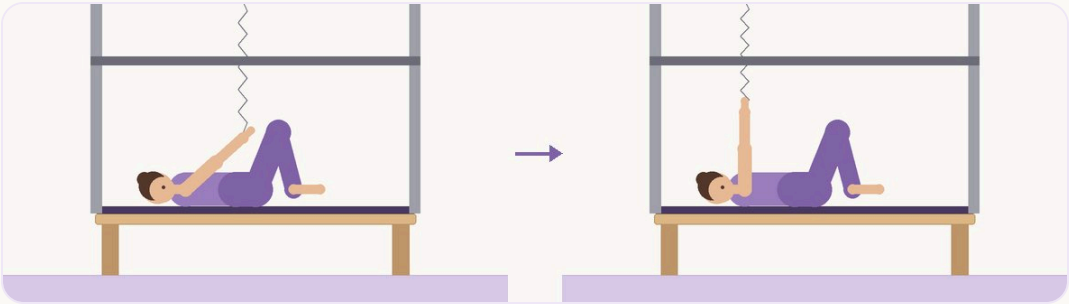
Cue
“Circle your arms and keep your shoulders away from your ears.”

Adaptation
Shoulder pain: smaller circles. Pregnancy: use a wedge.

Arm Springs Chest Press

supine

Beginner | Cadillac | V1-143



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back holding the handles.
2. Elbows bent.
3. Press up.
4. Lower.

Focus
Strengthens the chest and shoulders.

Target muscles
Pectorals, triceps, serratus anterior

Springs
1 medium spring

Dosage
8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to press; inhale to return.

Common faults
Elbows flaring, ribs arching.

Progression / Regression
Easier: lighter spring. Harder: heavier spring.

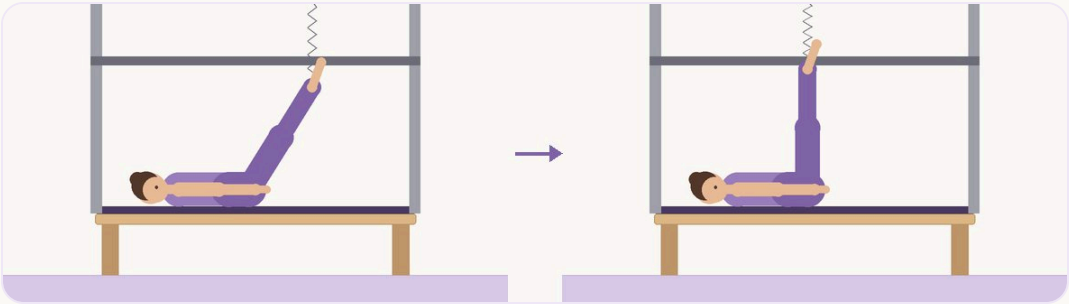
Cue
“Press up and keep your ribs down.”

Adaptation
Shoulder pain: smaller range. Pregnancy: use a wedge.

Supine Spinal Twist

legs in tabletop

Beginner | Cadillac | V1-144



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back.
2. Legs in tabletop.
3. Rotate to one side.
4. Return.

Focus
Mobilizes the spine and strengthens the obliques.

Target muscles
Obliques, deep rotators

Springs
1 light spring

Dosage
4 each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to rotate; inhale to return.

Common faults
Lifting the shoulders, twisting too far.

Progression / Regression
Easier: smaller range. Harder: legs straighter.

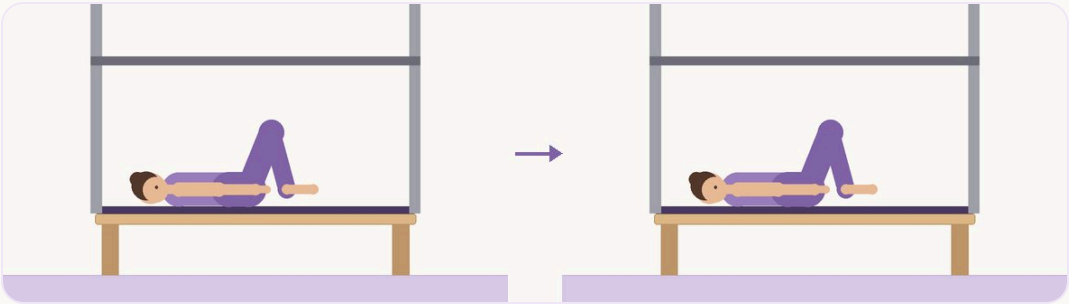
Cue
“Rotate your legs and keep your shoulders heavy.”

Adaptation
Lower back pain: small range. Pregnancy: avoid.

Pelvic Curl in Straps

feet in straps

Beginner | Cadillac | V1-145



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie with feet in straps.
2. Press the feet down.
3. Curl up.
4. Roll down.

Focus
Teaches the pelvic curl with spring assistance.

Target muscles
Glutes, hamstrings, core

Springs
1 light spring

Dosage
6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale up; inhale down.

Common faults
Overarching, feet gripping.

Progression / Regression
Easier: smaller lift. Harder: heavier spring.

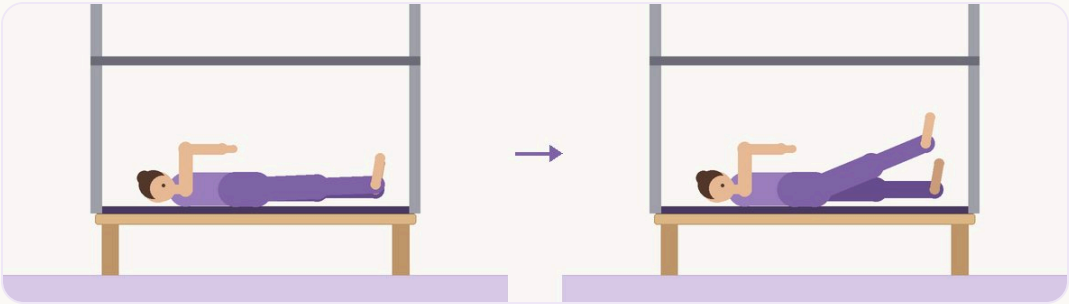
Cue
“Peel up through your spine one bone at a time.”

Adaptation
Lower back pain: small range. Pregnancy: avoid late in pregnancy.

Side Lying Leg Springs

kicks

Beginner | Cadillac | V1-146



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your side.
2. Top foot in the strap.
3. Kick forward.
4. Reach back.

Focus
Strengthens the hips and trunk.

Target muscles
Gluteus medius, hip flexors, obliques

Springs
1 light spring

Dosage
8 each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale forward; exhale back.

Common faults
Rolling the pelvis, lifting too high.

Progression / Regression
Easier: smaller range. Harder: heavier spring.

Cue
“Kick forward while your waist stays long.”

Adaptation
Hip pain: smaller range. Pregnancy: use pillow support.

VOLUME 1 · BEGINNER

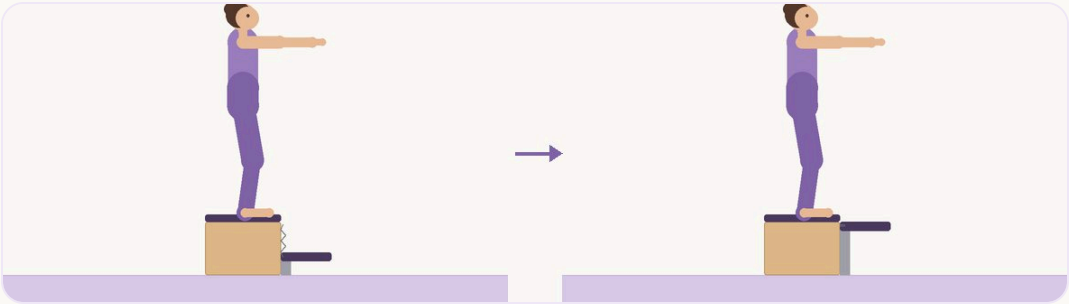
Wunda Chair

12 exercises

Chair Footwork

parallel, on the pedal

Beginner | Wunda Chair | V1-147



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall at the front edge of the chair, hands holding the sides.
2. Place the balls of the feet on the pedal.
3. Press the pedal down with control.
4. Return slowly without lifting the pelvis.

Focus
Warms up the legs and teaches alignment on the pedal.

Target muscles
Quadriceps, hamstrings, glutes, calves

Springs
1–2 lighter springs

Dosage
10 reps per position · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lift; exhale to press down.

Common faults
Gripping the toes, locking the knees, hips tilting.

Progression / Regression
Easier: lighter springs. Harder: heavier springs or single leg.

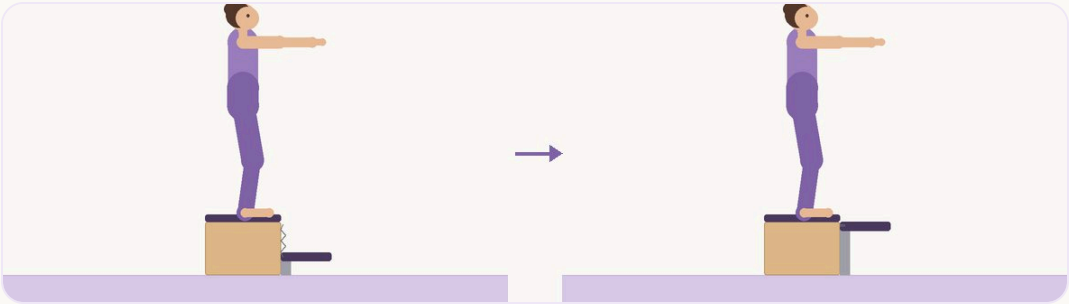
Cue
“Press the pedal down and lengthen through your spine.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: sit more upright. Knee pain: shorter range.

Chair Calf Raises

heels off the pedal

Beginner | Wunda Chair | V1-148



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall, balls of the feet on the pedal.
2. Press down with heels low.
3. Rise onto the toes with control.
4. Repeat smoothly.

Focus
Strengthens the calves and ankle stabilizers.

Target muscles
Gastrocnemius, soleus

Springs
1–2 lighter springs

Dosage
12 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale down; inhale up.

Common faults
Ankles rolling out, knees locking.

Progression / Regression
Easier: lighter springs. Harder: single leg.

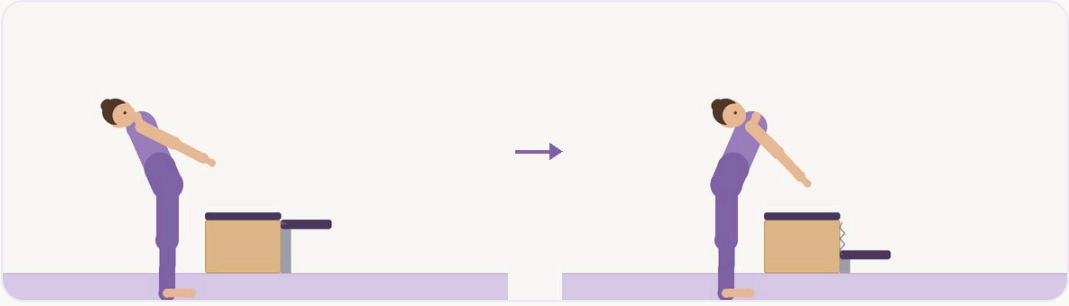
Cue
“Rise through the arch and lengthen your ankles.”

Adaptation
Ankle injury: shorten range. Older adults: sit upright.

Seated Triceps Press

hands on the pedal

Beginner | Wunda Chair | V1-149



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall on the edge, hands on the pedal.
2. Elbows point back.
3. Press the pedal down by straightening the elbows.
4. Control the return.

Focus
Trains the triceps with a stable trunk.

Target muscles
Triceps, shoulders, abdominals

Springs
1 medium spring

Dosage
8–10 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare; exhale to press down.

Common faults
Shoulders shrugging, wrists collapsing, back rounding.

Progression / Regression
Easier: lighter spring. Harder: heavier spring.

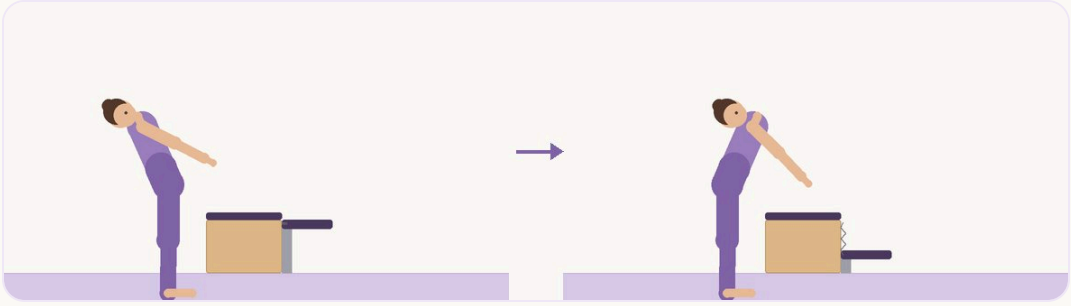
Cue
“Press the pedal down and keep your chest open.”

Adaptation
Wrist pain: reduce load. Shoulder pain: keep elbows close to the body.

Seated Spine Stretch

hands on the pedal

Beginner | Wunda Chair | V1-150



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit upright, legs extended, hands light on the pedal.
2. Curl forward through the spine.
3. Pause at the deepest point.
4. Roll up tall.

Focus
Teaches articulated forward flexion with support.

Target muscles
Spinal flexors, hamstrings, abdominals

Springs
1 light spring

Dosage
6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to curl forward; inhale to rise.

Common faults
Slumping, yanking the neck, hips lifting.

Progression / Regression
Easier: smaller range. Harder: longer reach.

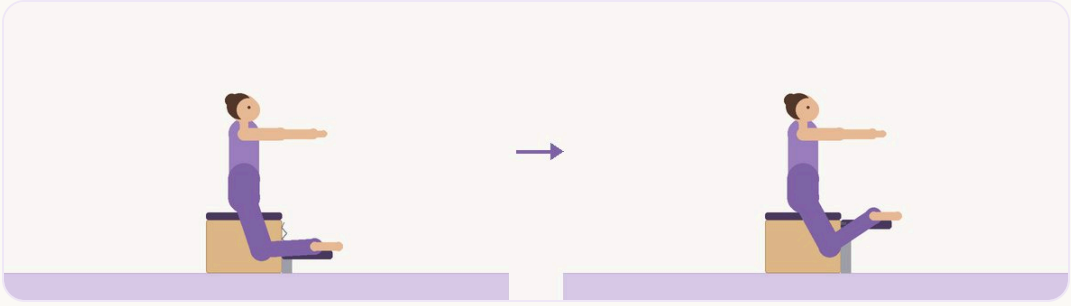
Cue
“Scoop forward and stack up bone by bone.”

Adaptation
Lower back pain: avoid deep flexion. Pregnancy: keep the legs wide.

Seated Mermaid

side stretch on the chair

Beginner | Wunda Chair | V1-151



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit sideways on the chair, one hand by the hip.
2. Raise the outside arm overhead.
3. Side bend over.
4. Return to center.

Focus
Improves lateral flexibility and rib mobility.

Target muscles
Obliques, quadratus lumborum, lats

Dosage
4 reps each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to reach; exhale to side bend.

Common faults
Collapsing forward, shoulders hiking.

Progression / Regression
Easier: smaller bend. Harder: add rotation.

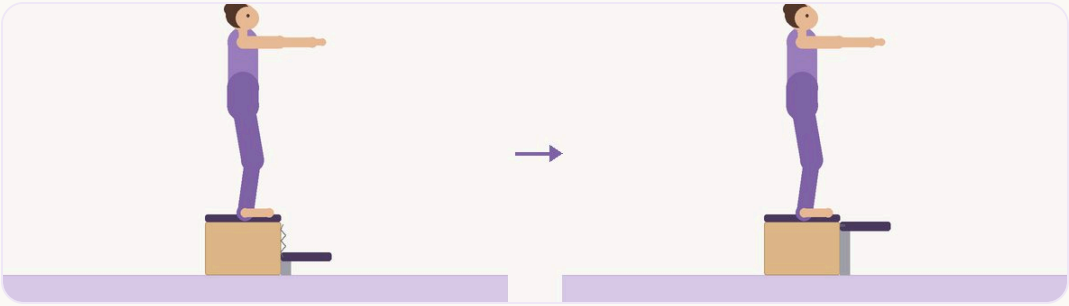
Cue
“Reach long, then arc over like a rainbow.”

Adaptation
Shoulder pain: lower the arm. Pregnancy: keep the sit bones heavy.

Pedal Bridge

feet on the pedal

Beginner | Wunda Chair | V1-152



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on a mat with feet on the pedal.
2. Press into the pedal.
3. Peel the spine up.
4. Roll down slowly.

Focus
Strengthens the glutes and hamstrings with the pedal giving feedback.

Target muscles
Glutes, hamstrings, core

Springs
1 light spring

Dosage
8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to lift; inhale to lower.

Common faults
Overarching, pedal slipping, knees opening.

Progression / Regression
Easier: shorter lift. Harder: single leg.

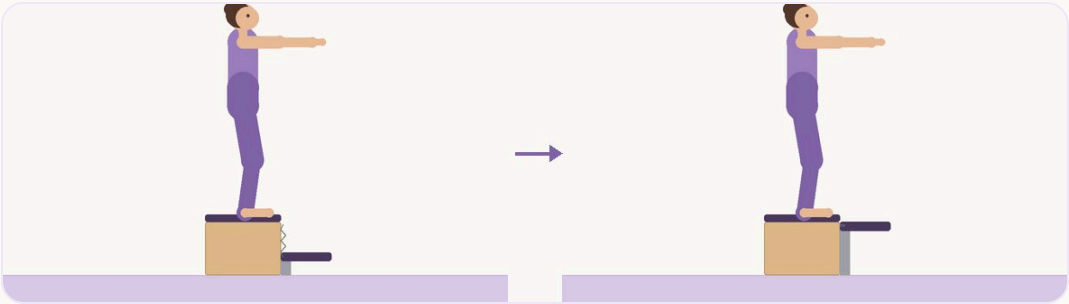
Cue
“Lift your hips while keeping the pedal steady.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: skip after the first trimester. Lower back pain: smaller range.

Standing Leg Press

foot on the pedal

Beginner | Wunda Chair | V1-153



HOW TO DO IT

1. Stand facing the chair, one foot on the pedal.
2. Support yourself on the frame.
3. Press the pedal down.
4. Return slowly.

Focus
Strengthens the leg and teaches balance.

Target muscles
Quadriceps, glutes, hip stabilizers

Springs
1–2 springs

Dosage
8–10 reps each leg · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lower; exhale to press.

Common faults
Hips shifting, knees collapsing.

Progression / Regression
Easier: hold a rail. Harder: heavier spring.

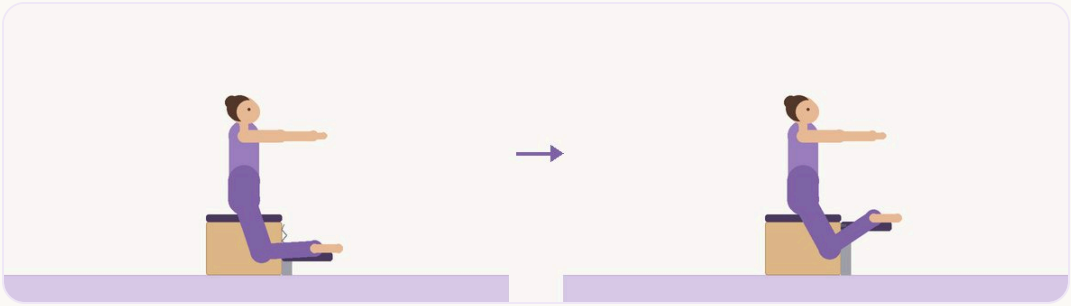
Cue
“Press down and keep your pelvis level.”

Adaptation
Older adults: use support. Knee pain: shorter range.

Seated Spinal Twist

hands crossed

Beginner | Wunda Chair | V1-154



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall.
2. Arms crossed or extended.
3. Rotate gently.
4. Return to center.

Focus
Mobilizes the thoracic spine and strengthens the obliques.

Target muscles
Obliques, deep rotators

Dosage
4 each side · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale to rotate; inhale to return.

Common faults
Leaning back, shifting hips.

Progression / Regression
Easier: small twist. Harder: arms extended.

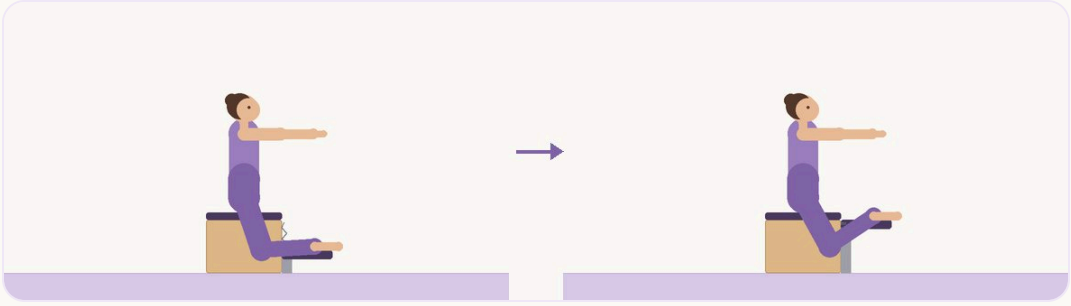
Cue
“Twist from your waist and keep your hips square.”

Adaptation
Lower back pain: gentle range. Pregnancy: open twist only.

Seated Hamstring Stretch

heel on the pedal

Beginner | Wunda Chair | V1-155



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall.
2. Place one heel on the pedal.
3. Hinge forward gently.
4. Hold, then switch.

Focus
Lengthens the hamstrings in a supported position.

Target muscles
Hamstrings, calves

Dosage
30 sec each leg · about 2 min

Breathing
Breathe slowly through the stretch.

Common faults
Rounding the back, locking the knee.

Progression / Regression
Easier: bend the knee. Harder: lean slightly forward.

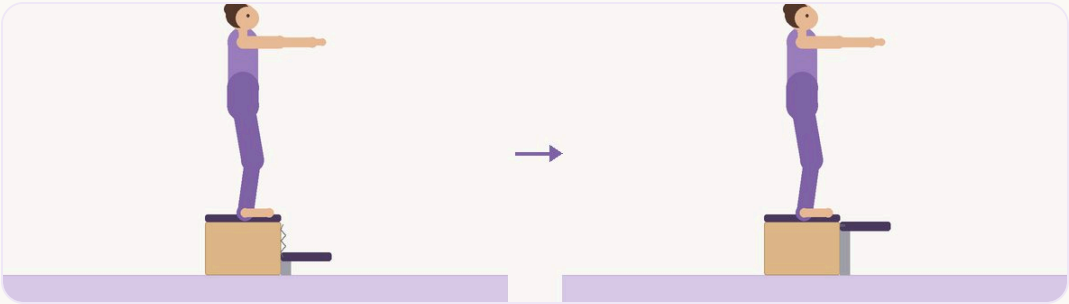
Cue
“Hinge from your hips and keep your spine long.”

Adaptation
Lower back pain: stay upright. Pregnancy: use a wide stance.

Seated Single Leg Press

one foot on the pedal

Beginner | Wunda Chair | V1-156



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall, one foot on the pedal.
2. Other foot on the floor.
3. Press the pedal down.
4. Return slowly.

Focus
Isolates each leg to address asymmetry.

Target muscles
Quadriceps, glutes, hip stabilizers

Springs
1 medium spring

Dosage
8 each leg · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to prepare; exhale to press.

Common faults
Hip shifting, knee locking.

Progression / Regression
Easier: lighter spring. Harder: heavier spring.

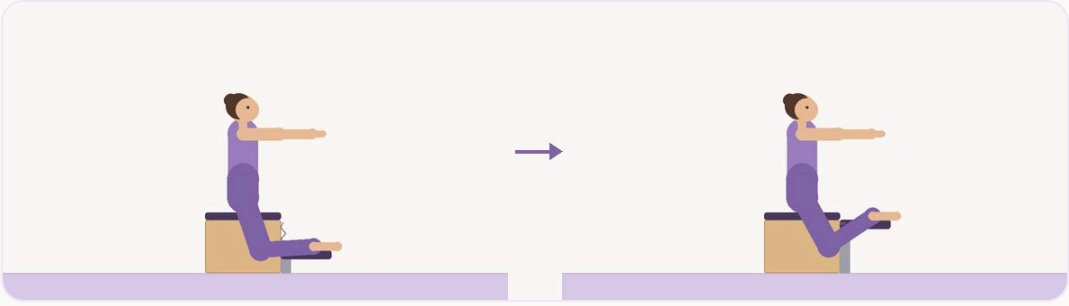
Cue
“Press down and keep both sit bones heavy.”

Adaptation
Knee pain: shorter range. Older adults: hold the sides.

Seated Roll Down

sitting on the chair

Beginner | Wunda Chair | V1-157



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall.
2. Tuck the pelvis.
3. Roll back slowly.
4. Roll up again.

Focus
Practices articulation and abdominal control.

Target muscles
Abdominals, spinal flexors

Dosage
6 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale to roll down; inhale to rise.

Common faults
Collapsing, rushing.

Progression / Regression
Easier: smaller range. Harder: slower tempo.

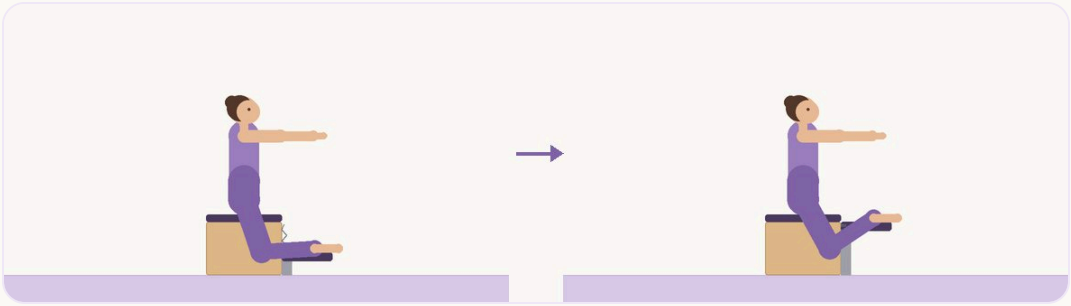
Cue
“Roll down and keep your belly scooped.”

Adaptation
Lower back pain: stop at mid-range. Pregnancy: widen the legs.

Seated Side Bend

hands behind the head

Beginner | Wunda Chair | V1-158



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall.
2. Hands behind the head.
3. Bend sideways.
4. Return to center.

Focus
Strengthens the obliques and opens the ribcage.

Target muscles
Obliques, quadratus lumborum

Dosage
6 each side · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to lengthen; exhale to bend.

Common faults
Leaning forward, hunching.

Progression / Regression
Easier: smaller range. Harder: longer lever.

Cue
“Lift your ribs and bend over a beach ball.”

Adaptation
Shoulder pain: hands on hips. Pregnancy: safe and useful.

VOLUME 1 · BEGINNER

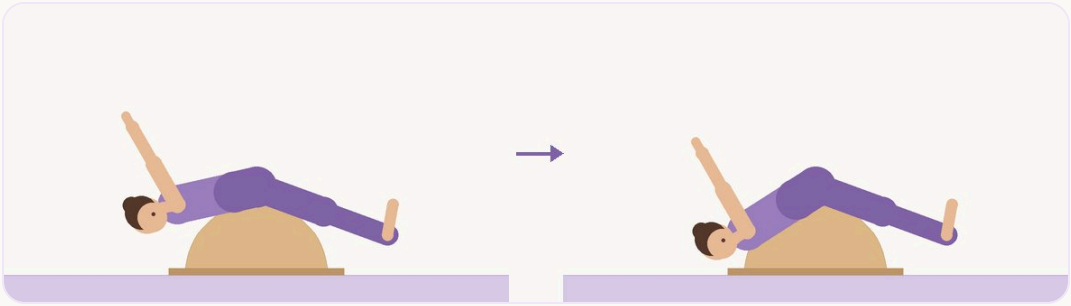
Barrel

12 exercises

Barrel Side Stretch

lying over the arc

Beginner | Barrel | V1-159



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie sideways over the barrel.
2. Top arm reaches overhead.
3. Feel the stretch.
4. Breathe and switch.

Focus
Opens the ribs and lateral spine on the barrel.

Target muscles
Obliques, intercostals, lats

Dosage
4 breaths each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale into the ribs; exhale to deepen.

Common faults
Rolling forward, shoulders hiking.

Progression / Regression
Easier: shorter hold. Harder: add an arm reach.

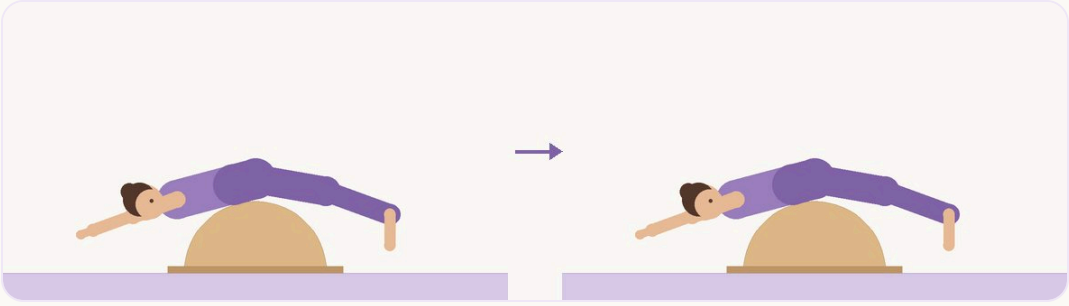
Cue
“Breathe into the side of your ribs.”

Adaptation
Shoulder pain: lower the arm. Pregnancy: avoid deep rotation.

Barrel Back Extension

prone over the barrel

Beginner | Barrel | V1-160



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie face down over the barrel.
2. Hands lightly on the floor.
3. Lift the chest slightly.
4. Lower slowly.

Focus
Strengthens the back extensors in a supported range.

Target muscles
Erector spinae, glutes

Dosage
6 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Inhale to lift; exhale to lower.

Common faults
Hyperextending the neck, lifting too high.

Progression / Regression
Easier: hands on the barrel. Harder: arms behind the back.

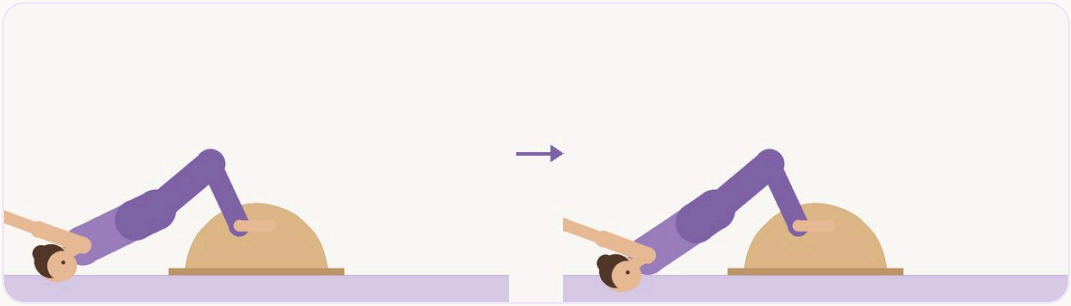
Cue
“Lengthen forward rather than lifting up.”

Adaptation
Lower back pain: smaller range. Pregnancy: skip prone positions.

Barrel Ab Curl

supine over the arc

Beginner | Barrel | V1-161



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back with the barrel under the lower ribs.
2. Knees bent.
3. Curl up.
4. Lower with control.

Focus
Trains abdominal flexion with support under the back.

Target muscles
Rectus abdominis, obliques

Dosage
8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to curl; inhale to lower.

Common faults
Pulling the neck, ribs flaring.

Progression / Regression
Easier: arms forward. Harder: hands behind the head.

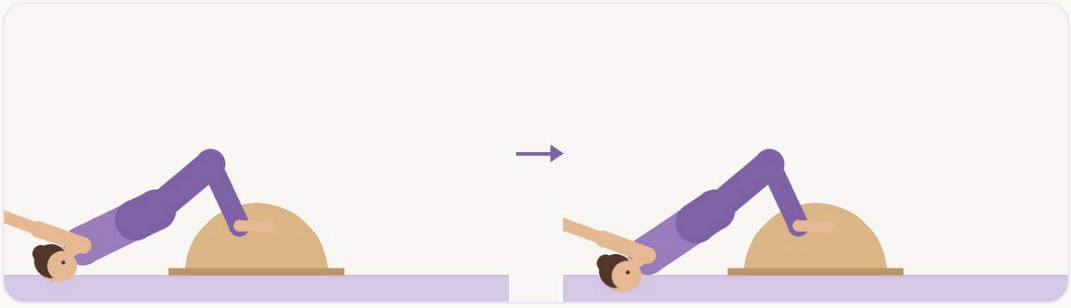
Cue
“Curl up and keep your ribs knitted.”

Adaptation
Neck pain: support the head. Pregnancy: avoid after the first trimester.

Barrel Chest Opener

arms in a T

Beginner | Barrel | V1-162



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your back over the barrel.
2. Arms out to the sides.
3. Let the chest open.
4. Hold and breathe.

Focus
Counters rounded posture by opening the chest.

Target muscles
Pectorals, anterior shoulder

Dosage
45 sec hold · about 3 min

Breathing
Slow, deep breaths.

Common faults
Lower back overarching, shoulders hiking.

Progression / Regression
Easier: arms lower. Harder: longer hold.

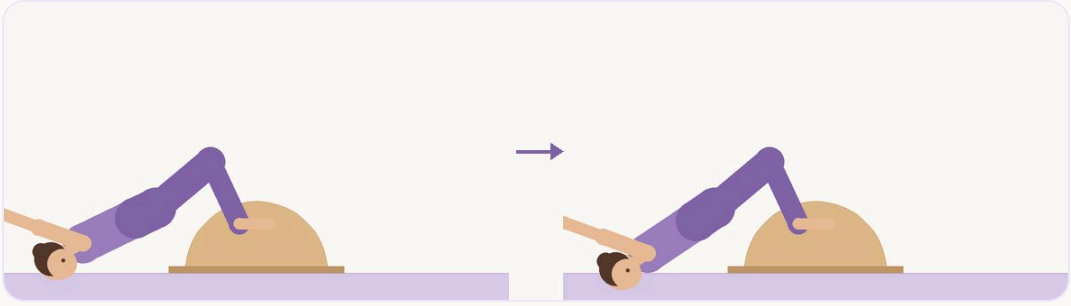
Cue
“Let your chest soften and open.”

Adaptation
Shoulder pain: keep the arms low. Pregnancy: avoid flat lying late in pregnancy.

Barrel Hip Flexor Stretch

kneeling lunge

Beginner | Barrel | V1-163



HOW TO DO IT

1. Kneel in a lunge near the barrel.
2. Hands on the barrel.
3. Shift forward gently.
4. Hold and switch.

Focus
Lengthens the hip flexors.

Target muscles
Iliopsoas, quadriceps

Dosage
30 sec each side · about 2 min

Breathing
Breathe slowly.

Common faults
Overarching the back, knee collapsing.

Progression / Regression
Easier: smaller range. Harder: reach overhead.

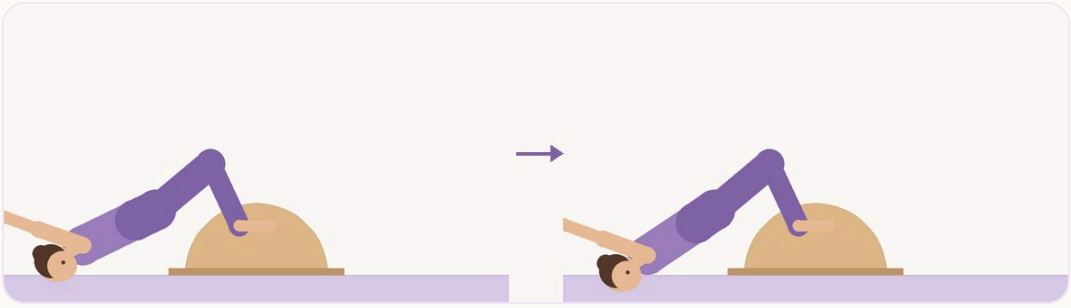
Cue
“Tuck your pelvis and sink forward.”

Adaptation
Knee pain: pad the knee. Pregnancy: use support.

Barrel Hamstring Stretch

heel on the barrel

Beginner | Barrel | V1-164



HOW TO DO IT

1. Place one heel on the barrel.
2. Stand tall.
3. Hinge forward slightly.
4. Hold and switch.

Focus
Gently lengthens the hamstrings.

Target muscles
Hamstrings, calves

Dosage
30 sec each side · about 2 min

Breathing
Breathe evenly.

Common faults
Rounding the back, locking the knee.

Progression / Regression
Easier: bend the knee. Harder: lean forward.

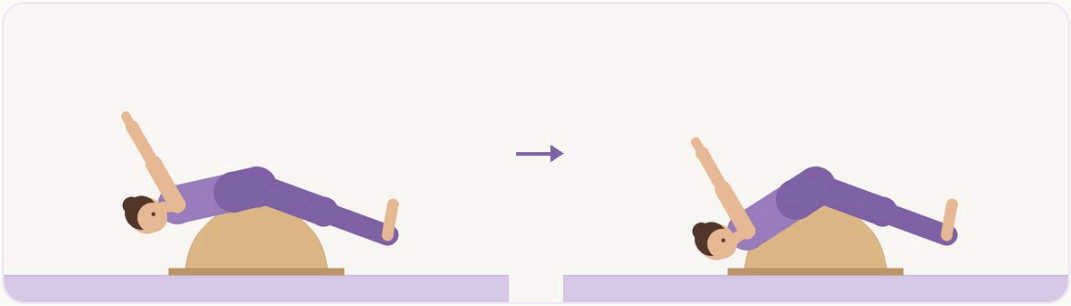
Cue
“Hinge from your hips with a long spine.”

Adaptation
Lower back pain: stay upright. Older adults: hold the barrel.

Barrel Side Lying Leg Lift

on the arc

Beginner | Barrel | V1-165



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie on your side over the barrel.
2. Bottom arm reaches down.
3. Lift the top leg.
4. Lower slowly.

Focus
Strengthens the outer hips with trunk support.

Target muscles
Gluteus medius, obliques

Dosage
10 each side · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale to lift; inhale to lower.

Common faults
Rolling back, lifting too high.

Progression / Regression
Easier: smaller lift. Harder: add small circles.

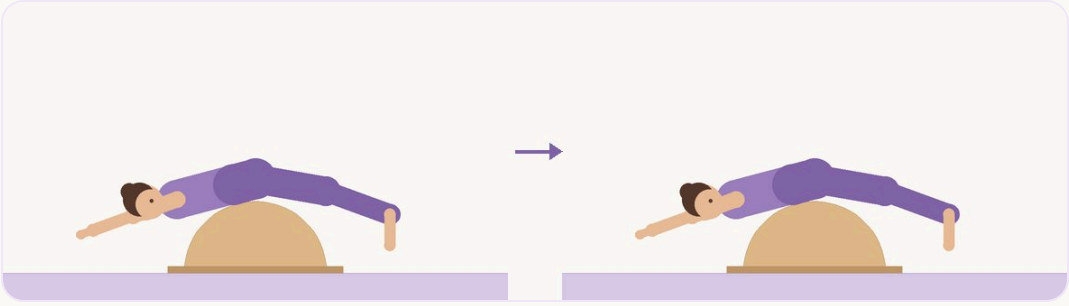
Cue
“Lift from your hip and keep your waist long.”

Adaptation
Hip pain: keep the lift small. Pregnancy: use pillow support.

Barrel Hug

sitting upright

Beginner | Barrel | V1-166



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit on the barrel.
2. Arms wide.
3. Hug them in.
4. Open again.

Focus
Opens the shoulders and chest in a seated position.

Target muscles
Pectorals, rhomboids

Dosage
8 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to open; exhale to hug.

Common faults
Shrugging, rounding forward.

Progression / Regression
Easier: smaller range. Harder: add light weights.

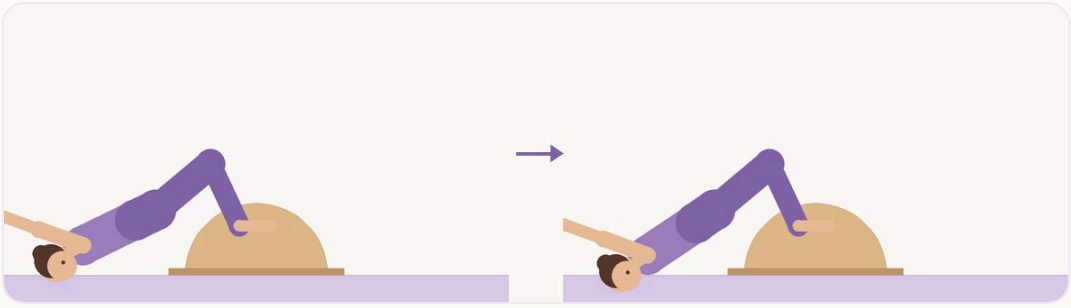
Cue
“Open your arms wide and hug the air.”

Adaptation
Shoulder pain: smaller range. Pregnancy: sit upright.

Barrel Arm Circles

lying supine

Beginner | Barrel | V1-167



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie over the barrel.
2. Arms reach up.
3. Circle forward.
4. Reverse.

Focus
Mobilizes the shoulders with support behind the back.

Target muscles
Deltoids, rotator cuff

Dosage
6 each direction · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale up; exhale down.

Common faults
Back arching, shrugging.

Progression / Regression
Easier: smaller circles. Harder: light weights.

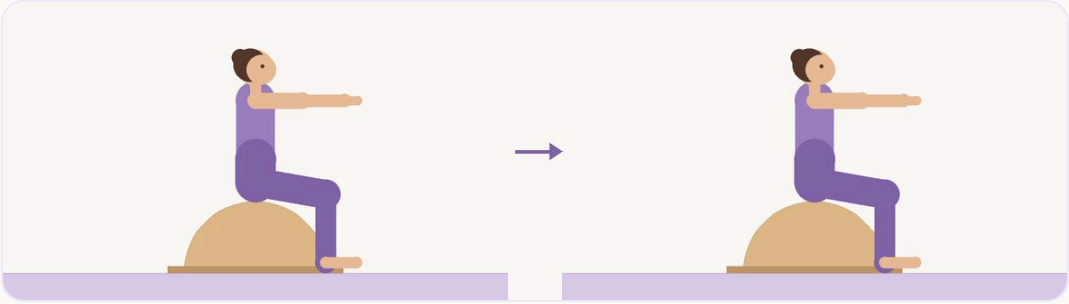
Cue
“Circle your arms and keep your ribs down.”

Adaptation
Shoulder pain: smaller circles. Pregnancy: avoid flat lying late.

Barrel Spine Stretch

seated on the barrel

Beginner | Barrel | V1-168



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit tall on the barrel.
2. Legs extended.
3. Curl forward.
4. Roll up.

Focus
Teaches seated flexion and hamstring length.

Target muscles
Spinal flexors, hamstrings

Dosage
6 reps · about 2 min

Breathing
Exhale forward; inhale up.

Common faults
Collapsing, pulling with the neck.

Progression / Regression
Easier: bent knees. Harder: reach farther.

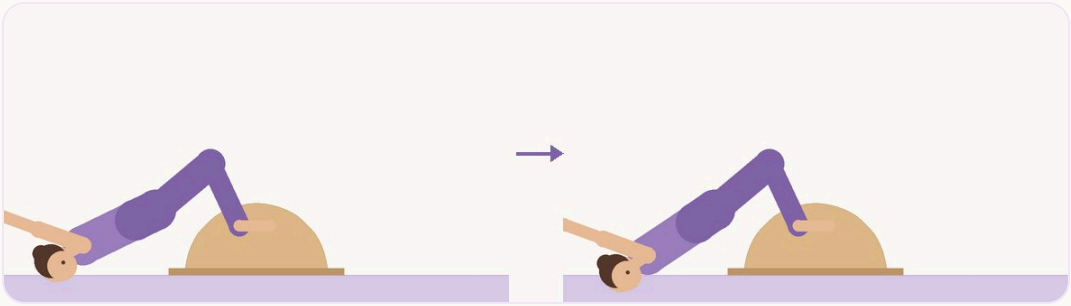
Cue
“Curl forward over your thighs.”

Adaptation
Lower back pain: smaller range. Pregnancy: widen the legs.

Barrel Bridge

feet on the floor

Beginner | Barrel | V1-169



HOW TO DO IT

1. Lie with the barrel under the back.
2. Feet flat.
3. Lift the hips.
4. Lower.

Focus
Strengthens the glutes with the barrel for support.

Target muscles
Glutes, hamstrings, core

Dosage
8 reps · about 3 min

Breathing
Exhale up; inhale down.

Common faults
Overarching, knees splaying.

Progression / Regression
Easier: shorter lift. Harder: single leg.

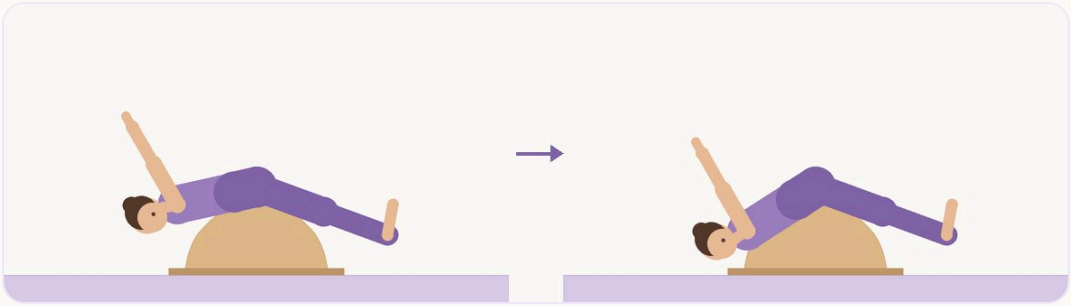
Cue
“Lift your hips and keep your knees parallel.”

Adaptation
Pregnancy: avoid late in pregnancy. Lower back pain: smaller range.

Barrel Mermaid

kneeling side bend

Beginner | Barrel | V1-170



HOW TO DO IT

1. Sit sideways on the barrel step.
2. Reach overhead.
3. Side bend.
4. Return.

Focus
Improves lateral flexibility.

Target muscles
Obliques, lats

Dosage
4 each side · about 2 min

Breathing
Inhale to reach; exhale to bend.

Common faults
Collapsing forward, shrugging.

Progression / Regression
Easier: smaller bend. Harder: add rotation.

Cue
“Reach long and arc over.”

Adaptation
Shoulder pain: lower the arm. Pregnancy: safe if comfortable.

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